



Digital SAT Writing Course

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Introduction to the Digital Writing Course

The SAT Reading and Writing Test consists of two 32-minute modules with 27 questions in each module for a total of 54 questions. In this Digital Writing Course, we will teach you everything you need to know for the Writing portion of the Reading and Writing Test.

On the Digital SAT, **all students complete the same 1st Reading and Writing module**, which has a mix of easy, medium, and difficult questions. The Digital SAT is adaptive, so your performance on the first module determines which 2nd module you get. **If you do well on the 1st module, the 2nd will have much more difficult questions. If you do not do well on the 1st module, the 2nd module will only have easy and medium questions.**

The breakdown of 5 types of questions on the Reading and Writing Test are below. In each module of the SAT, the questions always appear in the same order that they are listed below.

- | | | |
|--|---|-----------------------|
| • Words In Context (15-20%, 8-11 questions) | } | Reading |
| • Reading Comprehension (33-38%, 18-22 questions) | | |
| • Conventions of Standard English (22-25%, 12-14 questions) | } | Writing (this course) |
| • Transitions (7-13%, 4-7 questions) | | |
| • Notes (5-15%, 3-8 questions) | | |

The exact number of questions you see from each category varies based on test date and which module you complete for module 2.

Writing Questions

Of the 54 total questions in the Reading and Writing Test, 24-26 questions (around 45%) test you on Writing skills. These questions are broken down into 3 types: conventions of Standard English questions (part 1 of this course), Transitions questions (part 2 of this course), and Notes questions (part 3 of this course).

Part 1: Conventions of Standard English Questions (Grammar)

In part 1 of this course, we will teach you all the grammar rules that you need to know for the Conventions of Standard English questions. The Conventions of Standard English questions always look like this:

Scientists are able to approximate the age of a rock by studying the chemical composition and looking at the ratios of certain radioactive _____ have been used to estimate that limestone found in Arkansas to be 1.4 billion years old.

- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
 - isotopes, these
 - isotopes. These
 - isotopes, while these
 - isotopes and these

To answer these questions correctly, you need to know all the grammar rules tests on the SAT. We promise that **you will learn way more grammar in this course than you have learned in all of high school so far!** Grammar topics include sentence structure, commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, apostrophes, quotation marks, subject-verb agreement, verb tense, pronoun agreement, ambiguous pronouns, misplaced modifiers, parallel structure, and other miscellaneous grammar rules. Grammar

questions range from easy to very difficult, so they are the most important to master to achieve top SAT Reading & Writing scores.

Part 2: Transitions Questions

In part 2 of this course, we will teach you how to approach transitions questions. For transitions questions, you need to understand how to select the correct transition based on the context in the passage. Transitions questions always look like this:

Many species of predatory fish have developed a long, sleek body to cut through the water. _____ many species of eagles can tuck their wings to become very aerodynamic and dart through the air.

1. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A) Therefore,
B) For instance,
C) In contrast,
D) Similarly,

We will teach you how to best approach these questions and what to look for in the passage to be able to consistently select the most logical transition.

Part 3: Notes Questions

In part 3 of this course, we will learn how to handle notes questions. For notes questions, you are given a series of notes and asked to select which answer choice best accomplishes a certain goal a student wants to achieve. Notes questions always look like this:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- As engineered structures, many bird nests are uniquely flexible yet cohesive.
- A research team led by Yashraj Bhosale wanted to better understand the mechanics behind these structural properties.
- Bhosale's team used laboratory models that simulated the arrangement of flexible sticks into next-like structures.
- The researchers analyzed the points where sticks touched one another.
- When pressure was applied to the model nests, the number of contact points between the sticks increased, making the structures stiffer.

1. The student wants to present the primary aim of the research study. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?
A) Bhosale's team wanted to better understand the mechanics behind bird nests' unique flexible yet cohesive structural properties.
B) The researchers used laboratory models that simulated the arrangement of flexible sticks and analyzed the points where the sticks touched one another.
C) After analyzing the points where the sticks touched, the researchers found the structures became stiffer when pressure was applied.
D) As analyzed by Bhosale's team, bird nests are uniquely flexible yet cohesive engineered structures.

While notes questions may seem intimidating at first glance, they are usually fairly straightforward once you understand how to effectively approach the question and assess each answer choice.

Strategy For The Reading and Writing Test

When taking the Reading and Writing Test, skip the Reading Comprehension questions and answer them last. Reading comprehension questions take the longest, so saving them for last is the best time management strategy.

The order in which the question appear on the Reading and Writing Test are shown below.

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|---|-----------------------|
| 1. Words In Context | } | Reading |
| 2. Reading Comprehension | | |
| 3. Conventions of Standard English | } | Writing (this course) |
| 4. Transitions | | |
| 5. Notes | | |

For each Reading and Writing Module, you should complete the questions in the following order.

1. Words In Context
2. Conventions of Standard English
3. Transitions
4. Notes
5. Reading Comprehension

As you can see, you will answer the Reading Comprehension questions out of order.

Part 1:

Conventions of Standard English

On each SAT Reading and Writing Test, there are 18-22 questions that test you on properly using the Conventions of Standard English. These questions always ask you “Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English” and test you on grammar!

In Part 1 of this course, we will teach you every single grammar rule that appears on the SAT and how to spot which grammar rule you are being tested on.

Chapter 1: Sentence Structure

To conquer grammar questions on the SAT Reading & Writing Test, we first need to be able to identify the different parts of a sentence and know the rules for how they can and cannot be combined.

Clauses and Phrases

A **clause** is a group of words that contains both a subject and a verb. There are two types of clauses: **independent clauses** and **dependent clauses**.

An **independent clause** can stand as a sentence by itself. It always has a subject and a verb. The best way to identify an independent clause is to read the sentence and see if you can stop talking at the end. If you can stop, it is a complete sentence and an independent clause. Here are some examples of independent clauses:

The dog chased its tail.

Monique made some homemade peach scones for breakfast.

He picked it up.

The excited child opened his present.

A **dependent clause** cannot stand alone as a complete sentence. Most often, clauses become dependent by adding a subordinating conjunction to the front of the clause. The most common subordinating conjunctions are listed below

after
although
as
because
before
even though
if

in order to
once
since
though
that
unless
until

whatever
when
whenever
whether
where
while

Notice how in the examples below the subordinating conjunctions turn independent clauses into dependent clauses:

While the dog chased its tail...

Although Monique made some homemade peach scones for breakfast...

Since he picked it up...

The truth is although peacocks seem harmless...

A **phrase** lacks a subject or verb or both. A phrase does not express a complete thought and can never stand alone as a sentence. As a result, phrases provide additional descriptive information in a sentence.

Chasing its tail...

Making some homemade peach scones for breakfast...

Picking it up...

A new innovation in green energy,

These examples are all missing the subject. From the phrase alone, we do not know who is doing any of these actions.

TIP – Independent Clauses vs. Dependent Clauses vs. Phrases

To tell the difference between an independent clause, a dependent clause, and a phrase, **read the sentence out loud in your head. If you can stop talking at the end of the sentence, it is an independent clause.** If you feel like you need to keep talking, the sentence is a dependent clause or a phrase and cannot stand alone.

To tell the difference between a dependent clause and a phrase, cover the first word and read the rest of the sentence. If you then have a complete sentence, it is a dependent clause. If you do not have a complete sentence, it is a phrase.

Independent Clause:	My brother Adam eats cookies every day.
Dependent Clause:	<u>When</u> my brother Adam eats cookies every day...
Phrase:	Eating cookies everyday...

Independent Clauses and Reference Words

Sentences with the words listed below as subjects are still independent. We like to call these pronouns reference words because they are referring to something or someone in a previous sentence.

All	Few	Somebody
Another	He	Someone
Any	It	Something
Anybody	Many	That
Anyone	Nobody	These
Anything	None	They
Each	Nothing	This
Every	One	Those
Everybody	Several	Some
Everyone	She	What
Everything	Some	We

Many students commonly mistake these sentences as dependent because we do not know who or what the reference word is referring to if we just read the sentence itself. However, the previous sentence(s) will make it clear who or what is being referred to, so these are still independent clauses.

Correct: It is outside.

Correct: This is making me tired.

Correct: That is not the only way to make it to the top of the mountain.

When on the SAT, any sentence that has a reference word as the subject will have context, so you will know who or what the reference word is referring to.

Correct: I need to get my water bottle. It is outside.

Correct: I cannot hold the bucket much longer. This is making me tired.

Correct: Tourists usually follow the trail with the switchbacks. That is not the only way to make it to the top of the mountain.

Exercise: For each of the clauses or phrases below, identify if it is an independent clause (I), dependent clause (D), or phrase (P). Write I, D, or P next to each question.

- 1) A reference to Canadian politics in the 1980s
- 2) The new clothing brand that makes clothing entirely from recycled plastic bottles is popular
- 3) He created the new pair of shoes specifically for a special client with size 17 feet
- 4) Because the water bottle was manufactured with two layers of stainless steel
- 5) Illuminating the crime scene with a flashlight
- 6) Forgetting his calculator at home was a big mistake
- 7) Even though potted succulents grow far better in summer than winter
- 8) These even exist today
- 9) Running out of time to complete his sculpture for the spring art show
- 10) With no regard for his own health and safety
- 11) Some are prohibited from entering the competition due to an ongoing investigation
- 12) Rain is in the forecast for the next three days
- 13) The truth is that although the efficiency of electric cars has increased
- 14) Expertly kneaded bread will have air pockets
- 15) As the pine trees were exposed to polluted water over an extended period of time
- 16) Classified as both an evergreen tree and a member of the holly genus
- 17) Hiking fifteen miles in a single day with only three liters of water and a small bag of trail mix
- 18) While Manu was accused of cheating by both the teachers and all of the students
- 19) Where Stephanie's campaign for class president relied on donations from classmates
- 20) That is why I decided to leave

5 Types of Compound Sentences

Often on the SAT, you must deal with more complex sentences that have multiple clauses (more than one subject and verb). These are called compound sentences. On the SAT (and in English in general), multiple clauses must always follow one of the 5 rules below.

1. Two separate independent clauses joined with a period.

Mary loves dogs. Andrew loves cats.
Independent Independent

2. Comma + FANBOYS joining 2 independent clauses.

Mary loves dogs , and Andrew loves cats.
Independent Independent

3. Semicolon between 2 independent clauses.

Mary loves dogs ; Andrew loves cats.
Independent Independent

*** A semicolon is the same as a period on the SAT.**

4. Dependent clause followed by independent clause (comma).

While Mary loves dogs , Andrew loves cats.
Dependent Independent

5. Independent clause straight into dependent clause (no comma).

Mary loves dogs although Andrew loves cats.
Independent Dependent

TIP – FANBOYS

Memorize these 7 special words!

F or
A nd
N or
B ut
O r
Y et
S o

You need to memorize these 5 rules! The SAT will challenge you by putting sentences that may “look” or “sound” good on the exam that actually break one of our rules above. Next, we will cover the most common comma mistake students make with sentence structure.

Comma Splice

A comma by itself CANNOT be used to join two independent clauses. Joining two independent sentences with only a comma is called a comma splice and is always incorrect.

Incorrect: It is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red, they are actually colorblind.

Incorrect: I cannot believe you did not get the flowers, I left them at your front door.

Both of these sentences are comma splices. We can correct these comma splices using any of our 5 comma rules above. The first incorrect sentence is corrected below using all 5 rules.

Rule #1: It is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red. They are actually colorblind.

Rule #2: It is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red, but they are actually colorblind.

Rule #3: It is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red; they are actually colorblind.

Rule #4: While it is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red, they are actually colorblind.

Rule #5: It is believed that bulls are enraged by the color red although they are actually colorblind.

Compound Sentences Practice: Which answer choices are correct? For this exercise, multiple answer choices can be correct. **Select all answer choices that make the sentence correct.**

- 1) Hockey is my favorite _____ I cannot skate very well.
 - a. sport, although
 - b. sport, but
 - c. sport even though
- 2) While penguins are clumsy _____ amazingly graceful in water.
 - a. on land, they are
 - b. on land they are
 - c. on land; they are
- 3) Swimming is a great _____ works all the muscle groups in the body.
 - a. workout; it
 - b. workout because it
 - c. workout, for it
- 4) Tomato plants need full sunlight to grow to full _____ lettuce grows better in partial sunlight.
 - a. size, but
 - b. size; and
 - c. size;
- 5) _____ I still prefer it.
 - a. My friends say the extra hot salsa is too spicy,
 - b. Although my friends say the extra hot salsa is too spicy,
 - c. My friends say the extra hot salsa is too spicy, but
- 6) On my day off, I will go _____ go spearfishing.
 - a. surfing, or I will
 - b. surfing or I will
 - c. surfing, or will
- 7) The entire school loves chef _____ makes the best pulled pork.
 - a. Victoria because she
 - b. Victoria; because she
 - c. Victoria, she
- 8) Liz could not _____ she adopted the adorable golden doodle puppy.
 - a. resist, so
 - b. resist and
 - c. resist,

Sentence Fragments

A complete sentence must contain a subject and a verb. **Sentence fragments** are missing a subject or a verb or both or do not express a complete thought. In other words, **a sentence fragment cannot stand by itself**. To spot sentence fragments, read the entire sentence. The sentence will usually just sound plain wrong, and you will realize it is missing a subject or a verb.

Incorrect: The student running to get to class on time. (missing a verb – what did the student do?)

Correct: The student running to get to class on time dropped her water bottle.

Incorrect: Submitted the application just before the midnight deadline. (missing a subject – who is submitting the application?)

Correct: Shaun submitted the application just before the midnight deadline.

Sentence Fragment Practice:

- In the late 1960s, the “must-have” toy at the Cincinnati Toy _____ new type of diecast toy car that would later become the popular brand Hot Wheels.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) Fair a
B) Fair, a
C) Fair; a
D) Fair was a
- _____ noticed that a microwave can melt a chocolate bar.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) Spencer, who famously
B) Spencer famously
C) Spencer surprised famously
D) Spencer, who was famous for when he
- To clean all the windows on the tallest buildings, window _____ several 12-hour shifts over the course of a week.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) cleaners work
B) cleaners, who work
C) cleaners, working
D) cleaners who work
- After hummingbirds evolved long, thin beaks for reaching pollen in flowers, _____ evolutionary advantage allowed them to survive entirely on flower nectar, tree sap, and pollen.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) while this
B) since this
C) and this
D) this
- Her landmark doctoral thesis _____ Crohn’s disease has an underlying bacterial component.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) asserting that
B) asserted that
C) an assertion that
D) an assertion

6. _____ with the seasons, ranging from tomato basil loafs in the summer to olive rosemary focaccia in the fall, and always has a line around the block.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) While the bakery varies its types of bread
 B) Having various types of bread
 C) With the bakery having varied bread types
 D) The bakery varies its types of bread
7. Jellyfish have existed for millions of years. Pulsing along on our ocean currents, _____ nearly every type of ocean environment.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) these jelly-like creatures inhabiting
 B) these jelly-like creatures inhabit
 C) inhabiting
 D) inhabit

TIP – How to Spot Sentence Structure Questions

Sentence structure questions usually have at least one of the following characteristics:

1. **Periods, semicolons, commas, and FANBOYS are in the answer choices.** If you see answer choices with these, you are looking at a sentence structure question.
2. **Some answer choices have a subject or verb and others do not.** The presence of absence of a subject or verb can affect whether we have an independent clause, dependent clause, or a phrase. The verbs can also vary in their forms; for example, one answer choice can say “he drove,” which would be part of an independent clause, while another says “driving,” which is part of a phrase. For these questions, be on the lookout for comma splices and sentence fragments.

On the SAT, sentence structure questions commonly look like this:

Six Flag Magic Mountain’s newest ride, the Wonder Woman Flight of Courage, is the tallest and longer single-rail coaster on the planet. The roller coaster is opening next _____ wait time is expected to be over 4 hours long.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) week, the
 B) week; with the
 C) week and the
 D) week. The

Anytime you spot a sentence structure question, use the following approach:

1. **Focus only on the sentence that includes the underlined portion.** You do not need to read the full paragraph or consider the additional context.
2. **Find where the sentence is being “split.”** The split point is almost always where answer choices have a period, semicolon, or a comma.
3. **Look left and right of the “split” point and identify the clauses or phrases.**
4. **Apply the sentence structure rules.**

In the example above, the answer is D because we have two independent clauses. A is a comma splice. In B, the second half is not an independent clause. C is missing the comma with the FANBOYS.

Chapter 1 Practice:

1. Experts say that morning routines are an important way to get yourself prepared for a successful day. Most people drink coffee in the _____ prefer not to.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) morning, although I
- B) morning; while I
- C) morning; I
- D) morning and I

2. Sea turtles are known for swimming incredible _____ people do not know that female sea turtles journey back to their birthplaces to lay their eggs.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) distances, but many
- B) distances, many
- C) distances. While many
- D) distances many

3. Reorganizing the schedule after Jill called in sick is an _____ is also a logistical nightmare. Now, we do not have enough nurses to open the clinic on time.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) inconvenience, it
- B) inconvenience, also it
- C) inconvenience but it
- D) inconvenience. It

4. The pizza was guaranteed to be free if it was not delivered in 30 minutes or _____ delivery man still demanded money when he arrived late.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) less; but the
- B) less; the
- C) less, though the
- D) less but the

5. Redwood trees are one of the tallest types of trees in the _____ have grown as tall as 350 feet.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) world, some
- B) world; and some
- C) world and some
- D) world; some

6. The new mayor is cracking down on local businesses with a new set of rules focused on preventing corruption. The first warning given out to a business violating the new rules will not include a _____ a second violation will be a guaranteed \$1,000 fine.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) fine; while
- B) fine yet
- C) fine while
- D) fine and

7. While the ancient Egyptian pyramids were built over 4000 years _____ today and attract millions of tourists to Egypt each year.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) ago, still standing
- B) ago; they still stand
- C) ago, they still stand
- D) ago, they still standing

8. Bella wanted to make blueberry waffles for _____ her waffle iron was broken.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) breakfast, but
- B) breakfast, however
- C) breakfast but
- D) breakfast; but

9. Most restaurant owners have a security system installed at their _____ it helps protect them from theft.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) businesses, because
- B) businesses because
- C) businesses, since
- D) businesses; since

10. The eucalyptus tree is _____ is known not only for its flowers but also for the health benefits it can produce.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) unique, it
- B) unique and it
- C) unique; it
- D) unique it

11. The audience could not believe the incredible performance put on by the ten-year-old _____ once he finished his final flurry of perfectly struck notes, everyone stood together and applauded.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) pianist, they were enthralled,
- B) pianist; they were enthralled,
- C) pianist. They were enthralled;
- D) pianist, enthralled

12. Many houses in beach towns on the east coast have no basements. Instead, the houses sit on wooden beams that keep them out of the _____ that no damage will be done if hurricane flooding occurs.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) water, and ensure
- B) water to ensure
- C) water and these beams ensure
- D) water; ensuring

13. Although pesto, which is made of pine nuts, olive oil, basil leaves, and parmesan cheese, is mostly used in classic Italian _____ it on a variety of dishes and even offer different types of pesto featuring ingredients such as kale or cilantro.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) food; many restaurants now serve
- B) food, many restaurants now serve
- C) food, many restaurants serving
- D) food, but many restaurants now serve

14. The international commission was ecstatic over the release of the new _____ was little press given from major newspapers about the announcement.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) report, although there
- B) report; although there
- C) report, there
- D) report although there

15. Stonehorse Goemen, a Seneca artist, creates unique furniture out of hand carved wood and antlers. In 2007, Goemen created a 4-foot chair out of maple that used moose antlers as its _____ in 2012, he also crafted an entire chair out of antlers and then carved designs in the chair, including a shaman transforming into an eagle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) legs, later,
- B) legs and later,
- C) legs; later,
- D) legs later,

Chapter 2: Commas – 4 Types of Commas

Commas are the most common type of punctuation on the Reading & Writing Test. To successfully handle commas questions, you need to become familiar with the 4 types of commas that appear on the SAT.

So far, we have already discussed the first two types of commas.

1. Comma + FANBOYS

Use a comma with a FANBOYS (for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so) to join two independent clauses.

Correct: My alarm clock did not go off this morning, so I arrived late at school.

2. Dependent Clause Followed by Independent Clause

If a sentence has a dependent clause followed by an independent clause, you must link these with a comma.

Correct: While electronic music has become very popular, many people still prefer classic rock.

Next, we will learn the other 2 types of commas in English and on the SAT:

3. Unnecessary Information

Commas are used to separate unnecessary information from the rest of the sentence. Information is unnecessary if we can remove it without fundamentally changing the meaning of the sentence. Unnecessary information can be as short as a single word or as long as a lengthy phrase.

Example: Mrs. Ellison, who is known for giving pop quizzes, is my least favorite teacher.

Example: Olivia still needs to wax her snowboard, the one in the closet with no stickers on it.

Example: The basketball team, though, did not mount a comeback this week.

4. Listing

Commas are used when listing more than two items and with lists of multiple adjectives modifying the same noun.

Example: The group at the picnic table ordered coconut shrimp, hot wings, and onion rings.

Example: The old, limping dog still managed to complete the 3-mile hike.

Unnecessary Information Commas

The most common type of comma in English and on the SAT separates unnecessary information from the rest of the sentence. Information is unnecessary if we can remove the information from the sentence without fundamentally changing the meaning of the sentence. **Unnecessary information can be before a comma, after a comma, or between two commas.**

Sitting behind the table, Mark waited to jump out and surprise his mother.

Dale grabbed his favorite surfboard, the blue and green one, and paddled out.

Buddy the Elf handed his father a bag of spaghetti, his face covered in syrup.

The real winner, however, had yet to be revealed.

In the sentences above, the unnecessary information is underlined. Each of these sentences still works if we ignore unnecessary information. That's how we know it is unnecessary and the commas are correct!

TIP – The “Crossing-Out” Trick

For unnecessary information commas, you must be able to completely remove the unnecessary information from the sentence. After removing the unnecessary information, what remains must still be a complete sentence that can stand by itself.

To test if information is unnecessary, cross out the information and read the sentence without it. If you can cross out the information and the sentence still reads as a complete sentence, the information is unnecessary and needs to be set apart by a comma or commas. If you cannot cross out the information, it should not be set apart by any commas.

Let's test with the sentence below. All three versions are the same sentence, but the commas are in different locations.

The wooden beam set at an angle, created an optical illusion.

The wooden beam, set at an angle created an optical illusion.

The wooden beam, set at an angle, created an optical illusion.

For the first two sentences, a single comma must set apart the information either before or after it as unnecessary. Let's check if these work.

~~The wooden beam set at an angle~~, created an optical illusion.

The wooden beam set at an angle, ~~created an optical illusion~~.

The wooden beam, ~~set at an angle created an optical illusion~~.

~~The wooden beam~~, set at an angle created an optical illusion.

Well...none of those work for the first two sentences. Let's try the third. A pair of commas can either separate the information between them or the information before and after.

~~The wooden beam~~, set at an angle, ~~created an optical illusion~~.

The wooden beam, ~~set at an angle~~, created an optical illusion. (Yes, it works!)

Using this trick can be very helpful on unnecessary information commas questions.

Unnecessary vs. Necessary Information

At times, you need to determine if information is indeed unnecessary or not. These sentences are more challenging, but the trick is to delete the portion that may be unnecessary and see if the sentence loses any critical information. Consider the two sentences below:

Correct: The dresses that need to be hemmed are hanging in the closet.

Correct: Judith, who went to fashion school, designs dresses for a living.

Why do we have no commas in the first sentence and commas for the second? In the first sentence, the information is necessary. If we just say, “the dresses are hanging in the closet,” we do not know which specific dresses we are talking about. In the second sentence, we already know who designs the dresses, so the information about Judith going to fashion school is unnecessary.

The Names Rule

The SAT will ask you how to properly punctuate names. You have probably seen names written both with and without commas...so what’s the difference? Both versions below are correct: see if you can figure out why.

Correct: My friend Kelly recently moved to London.

Correct: My best friend, Andrew, is a certified scuba diver.

The names rule has to do with specificity. **If the identifier before the name is not specific to one person (friend, American physicist, Olympic gold medalist, high school principal), the name is necessary, and there is no comma between the identifier and the name.**

If the identifier is specific to one person (best friend, youngest sister, Amazon CEO), the name is unnecessary information, and there are commas around the name.

In the first sentence, Kelly is necessary because without her name we do not know which friend recently moved to London. In the second sentence, Andrew is unnecessary because a person can only have one best friend. We do not need the name Andrew to know exactly who we are talking about.

Names Rule Practice: Determine if the names below need commas or not.

1. Award-winning teacher Mrs. Saunders helped me become a much better writer.
2. Broadway producer Jeffrey Seller is best known for the huge hit Hamilton.
3. Eric’s youngest sister Louisa cheered from the bleachers.
4. Italian cyclist Marco Pantani won the Tour de France in 1998.
5. Famous American entrepreneur Elon Musk is a proponent of bitcoin.
6. The CEO of Tesla Elon Musk has revolutionized the car industry.
7. Grammy winner Arianna Grande is releasing a new album next month.
8. The oldest Hemsworth brother Luke Hemsworth starred in HBO’s Westworld.

“That” vs. “Which” Phrases

Phrases that start with “that” never get commas. Phrases that start with “which” always get commas. “That” phrases are always necessary information to the sentence, and “which” phrases are always unnecessary information.

Correct: The dogs that live down the street are always barking.

Correct: My neighbor’s dogs, which are always barking, love to play fetch.

Anytime you see “which,” there must be a comma right in front of it. The exception to this rule is when “which” is part of a prepositional phrase like “on which,” “in which” or “of which”. For any of these or other similar cases, you most commonly do not use a comma. However, if the information is unnecessary, a comma can be correct.

Correct: The picnic table on which the food was resting tipped over.

Correct: The donation box at the Kindergarten Library, in which over 30 books were being stored, mysteriously disappeared.

“Where” Phrases

Phrases can also start with “where” when the phrase is giving more information about location. “Where” phrases are more difficult on the SAT because they can be necessary information (no commas) and unnecessary information (with commas).

Correct: The town where I grew up is famous for its apple orchards.

Correct: The Little Italy Farmer’s Market, where I buy my favorite peanut butter, is only open on Saturdays.

In the first sentence, the phrase “where I grew up” is necessary because it helps to specify which town we are referring to, so we do not add commas. In the second sentence, the phrase “where I buy my favorite peanut butter” is unnecessary, as we already know exactly which market we are talking about, so we add commas.

City Names

When punctuating city names, **we always put a comma between the city and state AND a comma after the state.** For international cities, **we put a comma between the city and country AND a comma after the country.**

Correct: Monika’s family now lives in Bozeman, Montana, a hub of western culture and outdoor lifestyle.

Correct: Encinitas, a small city just north of San Diego, California, has beautiful beaches and a cute downtown with many great restaurants and shops.

Correct: We flew to Rome, Italy, to go see the Colosseum and visit the Vatican.

“ing” and “ed” Phrases

Phrases that start with “ing” and “ed” may or may not be separated with commas. To determine if these phrases, which are called participle phrases, get commas or not, determine if the information in the phrase is necessary to the sentence or not. **On the SAT, these phrases most commonly appear with commas and are unnecessary information.**

Correct: Excited for the car ride, Jane’s bulldog started to jump up and down.

Correct: Jane’s bulldog, excited for the car ride, started to jump up and down.

Correct: Marcus applied for the internship, hoping that he would get the position.

Correct: Judy laid down, exhausted from the long workout.

“ing” and “ed” phrases can also be necessary information when the phrase is helping to specify who or what the noun is. **If the phrase is necessary, there are no commas.**

Correct: The politician waving to the crowd is predicted to win the election.

Correct: The yoga pants advertised on the front page of the website were sold out.

In the first example, “waving to the crowd” is helping to specify which politician is predicted to win the election. In the second example, “advertised on the front page of the website” is specifying which yoga pants are sold out. Without these phrases, we would not know which specific politician or yoga pants are being referred to.

“ing” and “ed” Phrases Practice:

1. Inspiration is a funny thing. Drew Brophy, an artist based in Los Angeles, California, who specializes in surf art, points to his love of surfing and a deep interest in weather and physics as his main sources of _____ to his artwork being instantly recognizable because of its unique visual style.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) inspiration. Leading
- B) inspiration; leading
- C) inspiration, leading
- D) inspiration leading,

2. In the summer of 1984, Alexey Pajitnov, a young software engineer at the Soviet Academy of Science, had an idea that led to the creation of the popular computer game Tetris. _____ he remembered a childhood pastime involving puzzles with pentominoes, variously shaped polygons made up of 5 equally sized squares.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Tasked with designing videogames to test the capabilities of the Soviet Electronika 60 computer,
- B) Tasked with designing videogames to test the capabilities of the Soviet Electronika 60 computer;
- C) He was tasked with designing videogames to test the capabilities of the Soviet Electronika 60 computer,
- D) Since he was tasked with designing videogames to test the capabilities of the Soviet Electronika 60 computer;

Prepositional Phrases

Prepositional phrases are phrases consisting of a preposition and its object. Some of the most common prepositions on the SAT are listed below:

in	of	to	for	with	on	at
from	by	about	as	into	like	through
after	over	between	during	before	among	around

Prepositional phrases at the front of the sentence are always followed by a comma. We can think of these phrases as unnecessary information that we can cross out.

Correct: On my way to work, I listened to my new favorite podcast.

Correct: After cleaning the garage, Ralph started weeding the garden.

Prepositional phrases in the middle or end of a sentence almost never have commas around them. Most prepositional phrases contain essential information that helps specify the noun that the prepositional phrase is modifying and therefore is necessary.

Correct: The clothing on the bed is for vacation. The clothing on the floor is being donated.

Without the prepositional phrases, we would not know which clothing is for vacation and which is being donated. Here are some more examples:

Correct: The display of affection by Lewis to his prom date made her blush.

Correct: The bouquet of lilies in the vase is going to be displayed on the table.

On the SAT, most prepositional phrases do not have commas like the examples above, so in general you should not put commas around a prepositional phrase.

Prepositional phrases in the middle or end of a sentence only get comma(s) if they contain unnecessary information.

Correct: My mother, with her love of Easter, organized a massive Easter egg hunt.

Incorrect: The magician had a rabbit, in his hat.

Here, the first prepositional phrase is unnecessary because we already know which mother we are talking about. The second prepositional phrase is necessary since it specifies which rabbit we are talking about, so there should be no comma.

Prepositional Phrases Practice: Underline all prepositional phrases. Add commas if necessary.

1. Before the race began the team did a final check on the sparkplugs in the engine.
2. Donations for the campaign in Georgia broke records during the 2020 election.
3. The luxury dog bed with the ornate frame and supportive memory foam seems a bit excessive to me.
4. During the movie Davonta's mother after running out of candy went to the concession stand for some popcorn.
5. At the corner the host stood with a microphone in her hand.

Punctuation for Transitional Words and Phrases Like “However”

On the SAT, there are certain words and short phrases that often give students trouble on grammar questions. These words are technically called conjunctive adverbs (you do NOT need to know that). We prefer to just think of these as transitional words and phrases like “however.” Below is a list of the most commonly tested ones:

However	Though	Therefore
Instead	Likewise	Nevertheless
Regardless	Moreover	Subsequently
Furthermore	In addition	As a result
Of course	Otherwise	For example

There are 4 ways that these transitional words and phrases can appear in a correctly punctuated sentence.

1. At the front of the sentence followed by a comma.

Correct: However, the truth would not be revealed until next week.

Correct: As a result, the student was sent to the principal’s office.

This is another example of unnecessary information. For both of these sentences, we can cross out the transitional word or phrase and are left with a complete sentence.

2. Separated by commas in the middle of a sentence.

Correct: The truth, however, would not be revealed until next week.

Correct: The student, as a result, was sent to the principal’s office.

We can think of this as unnecessary information. We can cross out the transitional word or phrase and read the rest of the sentence as one complete sentence.

3. Separated by a semicolon and then a comma when between two independent clauses.

When connecting two independent clauses, we cannot use two commas, as this creates a comma splice.

Incorrect: I expected to pay over \$100 for my new hiking boots, however, I found a sale and got them for half of the original price.

Correct: I expected to pay over \$100 for my new hiking boots; however, I found a sale and got them for half of the original price.

If there is an independent clause before and after the transitional word or phrase, we can use a semicolon and then a comma for punctuation.

4. Separated by a comma and then a semicolon when between two independent clauses.

This rule is the most advanced. While this rule is similar to rule 3, the punctuation can switch to comma and then semicolon if the transitional word or phrase is referring to the sentence before and not the sentence after.

Correct: For over twenty years, Pete has been a great cook and important part of the restaurant. We do not think that Pete can keep working here, however; there must be consequences for showing up to work late every day.

Punctuation for Transitional Words and Phrases Like “However” Practice:

1. The teams had prepared extensively for the competition, honing their skills and perfecting their _____ they stepped onto the field, unforeseen challenges arose.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) strategy, nevertheless; as
- B) strategy. Nevertheless, as
- C) strategy, nevertheless, as
- D) strategy, nevertheless as

2. The chef’s culinary expertise was evident in every dish presented at the lavish dinner party. The guests savored each exquisite bite, marveling at the fusion of flavors that danced on their palates. Behind this gastronomic _____ years of dedication and passion for the art of cooking. The meticulous attention to detail and the use of premium ingredients were unmistakable, reflecting the chef’s unwavering commitment to culinary excellence.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) delight of course, is
- B) delight, of course, is
- C) delight, of course is
- D) delight; of course, is

3. When first studying male birds-of-paradise, it is easy to believe their super black feathers are a form of night _____ these super black feathers create a dazzling contrast to their bright blue feathers for courtship behavior. Ornithologist Florence Bailey suggests that the dazzling contrast of the feathers and intricate dances performed by male birds-of-paradise are designed to attract females.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) camouflage rather
- B) camouflage; rather,
- C) camouflage, rather;
- D) camouflage, rather,

4. Ecologist Siobhan Myers is a leading member of the governing board responsible with adding new wetlands to the California Wetland registry, which includes regions throughout nearly every county in the state. Myers doesn’t make such decisions _____ all wetlands added to the California Wetland registry must be approved unanimously by the board and receive a final stamp of approval by an EPA officer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) independently, however,
- B) independently; however,
- C) independently, however;
- D) independently however

5. In the history of the NCAA Men’s Basketball March Madness Tournament, less than 1% of 16th seeds win a single game. In rare _____ the 16th seed can advance. This anomaly defies expectations and injects an electrifying unpredictability into the tournament.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) instances; however,
- B) instances, however;
- C) instances, however,
- D) instances however

6. Nestled in the Italian countryside lies the tranquil havens of Parma and Modena, where visitors from the nearby city of Bologna can enjoy a relaxing getaway. Parma, famous for Parmigiano Reggiano and Prosciutto di Parma, is a sprawling farm town with a very small city center, _____ famous for its balsamic vinegar, is a more industrial city with a larger downtown.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) and on the other hand, Modena,
- B) and; on the other hand, Modena,
- C) and, on the other hand; Modena,
- D) and, on the other hand, Modena,

TIP – How to Spot Unnecessary Information Commas Questions

Unnecessary information commas questions always have two defining characteristics:

1. The words in all 4 answer choices are the exact same.
2. The only difference in the answer choices is where commas are located.

On the SAT, unnecessary information commas questions look like this:

Electric vehicles, _____ already on the road in America, are one of the fastest growing industries in the world. This surge in popularity reflects a larger shift in the mindset towards cleaner energy sources.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) thousands of them,
- B) thousands, of them
- C) thousands of them
- D) thousands of, them

Anytime we see a question like this, we are dealing with an unnecessary information commas question and should use the “crossing-out” trick. **Be sure to read the entire sentence and pay attention to any other commas that are not in the underlined portion!** Any commas that we cannot change are often important clues that we must use to find the correct answer. It is possible that other comma rules can be tested in questions like this as well, so make sure to read the entire sentence and look out for the sentence structure rules from Chapter 1.

In the example above, the answer is C because the phrase “thousands of them already on the road in America” is unnecessary information and is separated by two commas.

Backup Trick – Pauses and Commas

Read the sentence out loud (or “out loud” in your head on test day) to help identify where commas are necessary. If you need to take a short pause for a breath, then you likely need a comma. Read the example below out loud and put commas where you take a short pause:

Originally from Maine Mr. Johnson who has taught 8th grade biology for five years is not accustomed to winters in San Diego.

Pausing is not one of our 4 commas rules! Many students mistakenly put commas anywhere they pause in sentence. At times, this is a great trick. However, this can also lead to mistakes. **You should only using pausing as a backup trick when you have already used our other commas rules and still cannot tell which answer choice is correct.**

For the example above, the correct version is below:

Correct: Originally from Maine, Mr. Johnson, who has taught 8th grade biology for five years, is not accustomed to winters in San Diego.

Commas Practice: Add commas where necessary. The commas in the sentences below can be any of the first 3 types of commas we have learned so far.

1. Although James demanded pizza for dinner his mother decided to make grilled chicken and broccoli instead.
2. Mr. Alvin a very popular teacher among the students cancelled the final exam.
3. I could not believe that Deadpool was such a popular movie.
4. While my friend Mary thought that dolphins were the fastest animals in water she was surprised to learn it was actually a sailfish.
5. Owls notorious for their amazing night vision have fantastic hearing at night so they can actually hear their prey from hundreds of feet away even if they cannot see it.
6. On second thought the real reason that I did not like Scott was his lack of honesty.
7. Some cultures though enjoy bizarre foods like bugs or snakes.
8. After graduating Darren played for the San Diego Padres where he had a long career as a relief pitcher.
9. Because he was the best in Dallas award-winning head chef Phillip Small owned multiple very successful restaurants.
10. My favorite author is J.K. Rowling who is famous for writing the Harry Potter series.
11. The fisherman carrying their catch walked into the Seattle fish market a place famous for how the vendors throw fish to entertain customers.
12. At first glance the cuttlefish which can change colors to blend into its surroundings looked just like the brain coral behind it and I did not see it in the tank.
13. Last summer the local flooding caused by a breach in the Reynolds Dam caused over ten thousand dollars in damage to the children's park.
14. The basil plant for example needs full sunlight but cilantro grows best in partial sunlight.

Listing Commas

The easiest types of commas that appear on the Reading & Writing Test are listing commas. Listing commas can appear in a multiple item list and between a list of multiple adjectives describing the same noun.

Commas and Lists

Listing commas are used to separate the items in a list of 3 or more items.

Correct: I went to the grocery store to pick up chicken, cheese, and bread.

Correct: I went to the grocery store to pick up chicken, cheese and bread.

The final comma in a list of items in the top example is called the Oxford comma. Use of the Oxford comma is stylistic, so technically both lists with and without the Oxford comma are correct. As a result, the Oxford comma alone never makes an answer choice correct or incorrect on the SAT. **Most commonly, the SAT includes the Oxford comma** like the top example above.

Lists must have 3 or more items to include commas. **Be sure that you do not use commas in a list of just two items.**

Incorrect: The food was both incredibly savory, and overwhelmingly satisfying.

Correct: The food was both incredibly savory and overwhelmingly satisfying.

Incorrect: Mike cashed out his winnings, and then headed back to his hotel room for a nap.

Correct: Mike cashed out his winnings and then headed back to his hotel room for a nap.

TIP – FANBOYS vs. Lists

Be careful of the FANBOYS (and, but, nor, or) that can be used in lists. It is easy to confuse a two-item list (which does not need a comma) with a comma + FANBOYS between two independent clauses (which does need a comma). For a comma and a FANBOYS, make sure the second half of the sentence is an independent clause.

Incorrect: The debate team took first place in California, and then won the grand prize for the entire nation.

Correct: The debate team took first place in California and then won the grand prize for the entire nation.

Incorrect: Andrew needed to pick up his suit and he needed to go to the grocery store to pick up bread and eggs for breakfast.

Correct: Andrew needed to pick up his suit, and he needed to go to the grocery store to pick up bread and eggs for breakfast.

Commas and Adjective Lists

Listing commas are also used to separate a list of multiple adjectives modifying the same noun.

Correct: The wet, smelly dog was excited for the car ride home.

Correct: The narrow, winding, treacherous roads through the mountains are difficult to drive.

Adjective Lists with and without Commas

On more difficult questions, you will need to know when to use commas in lists of adjectives and when commas are not necessary. Take a look at the two correct examples below to learn the difference.

Correct: A cup of delicious, strong coffee is my favorite thing in the morning.

Correct: My mother has lots of bright floral furniture in her living room.

The rule is a simple one: **if you can switch the order of the adjectives without changing the meaning of the sentence, put a comma between the adjectives. If switching the order of the adjectives changes the meaning of the sentence or just makes no sense, there is no comma between the adjectives.** In short, if you can switch the adjectives, put a comma. No switch, no comma.

In the first sentence, the two adjectives “delicious” and “strong” are separated by a comma. Both adjectives describe the coffee on their own. We could switch the adjectives around to “strong, delicious coffee” without changing the meaning. Since we can switch the adjectives, we need a comma.

In the second sentence, the two adjectives “bright” and “floral” are not separated by a comma because they build on one another and together modify the noun. If we switch the adjectives to “floral bright furniture,” the meaning of the sentence is changed. Saying “bright floral furniture” makes sense because “floral” is describing the furniture and “bright” is describing the “floral furniture. Saying “floral bright furniture” does not because “floral” is supposed to be describing the “furniture” and not “bright.” Since we cannot switch the adjectives, we do not add a comma.

TIP – “The Switching Trick”

When you see multiple adjectives modifying a noun, switch the order of the adjectives to test if you need a comma between the adjectives. Let’s use these two sentences as examples:

The sweet cold ice cream was refreshing after a day at the beach.

Elliot had to take off his stainless steel necklace before the swim meet.

To test whether these adjectives need a comma between them, switch the order and see if the sentences still make sense.

The cold sweet ice cream was refreshing after a day at the beach.

Elliot had to take off his steel stainless chain before the swim meet.

In the first sentence, switching “cold” and “sweet” does not change the meaning, so we need a comma. In the second sentence, “steel stainless chain” does not work, so we do not need a comma. The correct versions of both sentences are below:

Correct: The sweet, cold ice cream was refreshing after a day at the beach.

Correct: Elliot had to take off his stainless steel chain before the swim meet.

Adjectives Lists With and Without Commas Practice: Add commas where necessary. Commas may or may not be necessary.

1. Scientists are trying to determine what animal the newly discovered fossilized bones are from.
2. The white fluffy clouds floated quickly by in the crisp evening wind.
3. The big sun bear is known for climbing the fence and swimming in the heated community pool in the spring.
4. The cunning sneaky foxes got into the chicken coop again last night.
5. The powerful liquid detergent makes my dirty sweaty clothes smell so much better.
6. My car engine made an annoying rattling sound right before breaking down.
7. The local hot air balloon company specializes in making colorful creative designs.
8. Laura placed an order for Italian coffee beans and three expensive ceramic coffee mugs.

Commas Practice: Which answer choices are correct? **Select all that apply.**

1. The diners _____ sat down.
 - a. ordered food and
 - b. ordered food, and
 - c. ordered food, and they

2. _____ will pre-order the tickets to Coachella.
 - a. Claire, Elizabeth or Bella
 - b. Claire, Elizabeth, or Bella
 - c. Claire, Elizabeth, or Bella,

3. The _____ forced the commander to declare war.
 - a. invasion by the rebel forces
 - b. invasion, by the rebel forces
 - c. invasion, by the rebel forces,

4. The _____ was given first prize by the judges.
 - a. bright pink hot air balloon
 - b. bright, pink hot air balloon
 - c. bright, pink, hot air balloon

5. Nancy laid down in the _____.
 - a. hammock and immediately fell asleep.
 - b. hammock, and she immediately fell asleep.
 - c. hammock, and immediately fell asleep.

6. I will need a _____ to drink after the race.
 - a. sweet cold lemonade
 - b. sweet, and cold lemonade
 - c. sweet, cold lemonade

7. It is important to _____ shelter.
 - a. keep calm during an earthquake, and seek
 - b. keep calm, during an earthquake, and seek
 - c. keep calm during an earthquake and seek

Commas, Sentence Structure, and Unnecessary Information

Now that we have learned about sentence structure and commas, let's see the most common ways that a sentence can be structured using commas or when no commas are necessary. We will add on to the 5 rules we already learned in Chapter 1 (p. 8).

1. Comma + FANBOYS joining 2 Independent Clauses

The researchers changed their approach, and they created a new medical procedure in the process.

Independent clause

Independent clause

2. Independent Clause followed by Unnecessary Information Phrase (comma)

The researchers changed their approach, creating a new medical procedure in the process.

Independent clause

Unnecessary information

3. Unnecessary Information Phrase before Independent Clause (comma)

Determined to find a cure, the researchers changed their approach.

Unnecessary information

Independent clause

4. Dependent Clause followed by Independent Clause (comma)

Since they were determined to find a cure, the researchers changed their approach.

Dependent clause

Independent clause

5. Unnecessary Information Phrase, Independent Clause, Unnecessary Information Phrase (2 commas)

Determined to find a cure, the researchers changed their approach, creating a new medical

Unnecessary information

Independent clause

Unnecessary

procedure in the process.

information

6. Independent Clause with Necessary Information (no comma)

The researchers changed their approach by creating a new medical procedure.

Independent clause

Necessary information

7. List with 2 items (no comma)

The researchers changed their approach and created a new medical procedure in the process.

*this sentence functions as one big independent clause.

8. Unnecessary Information Phrase, Unnecessary Information Phrase, Independent Clause (2 commas)

Despite the company's efforts, which included offering a 75% refund and a replacement purse,

Unnecessary information

Unnecessary information

Claire was still disappointed with her Chanel purse.

Independent clause

9. Dependent Clause, Independent Clause, Unnecessary Information (2 commas)

As the curtains closed, the crowd stood and applauded, many with tears in their eyes.

Dependent clause

Independent clause

Unnecessary information

These 9 sentence structures cover the most common ways that complex sentences appear on the SAT, but **this is not a complete list**. Unnecessary information can appear in the middle of clauses or in the middle of other unnecessary information, so **there can be many more possible sentences structures than the 9 listed on the previous page**. However, if you understand the 9 most common sentence structures, you will be very well prepared to deal with even the most difficult sentences on the SAT.

TIP – The “1-Comma” Rule

This brings us to our final sentence structure and commas rule: **when a sentence has only one comma in the middle, there must be an independent clause before or after the comma but not both and not neither. The only exception to this rule is a comma + FANBOYS linking two independent sentences.** If before and after are both independent, we have a comma splice. If neither is independent, we have a sentence fragment.

Type #1: Independent, Not Independent

For the first type of the “1-Comma” rule, the sentence can be independent before the comma and not independent after the comma. In this situation, the second half of the sentence is always unnecessary information.

Correct: The pillows are filled with down feathers, the most expensive type of pillow filler.

Independent Clause Unnecessary Information

Type #2: Not Independent, Independent

For the second type of the “1-Comma” rule, the sentence can be not independent before the comma and independent after the comma. In this situation, the first half of the sentence can be a dependent clause or unnecessary information.

Correct: Since they were stored in a moist area, the potatoes are now moldy and unsafe to eat.
Dependent Clause Independent Clause

Correct: Stored in a moist area, the potatoes are now moldy and unsafe to eat.
Unnecessary Information Independent Clause

How To Spot Questions With The “1 Comma” Rule

When we see a sentence with a comma in the middle that is testing you on sentence structure, use the “1 Comma” rule.

On Monday afternoon, after the 1995 Michigan State Golf Championships had already been delayed 2 days due to rain, the golfers gathered to decide whether or not the tournament should be cancelled. Before making a final decision, tournament organized wanted to see tomorrow's weather report. As the 5pm news report started, the room was silent. _____, the meteorologist on channel 5 predicted a 76 percent chance of rain this afternoon due to the incoming low pressure system.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) The news report was disappointing to the golfers in the tournament
- B) The golfers in the tournament were disappointed by the news report
- C) To the disappointment of golfers in the tournament watching the news report
- D) There was a disappointing news report for the golfers in the tournament

The second half of the sentence “the meteorologist on channel 5...” is independent, so the first half must not be independent. A, B, and D are all independent. C is not independent (it is a phrase and unnecessary information), so C is correct.

Chapter 2 Practice:

1. Before graduating from _____ out to start his own company.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) college William, a computer science major, dropped
- B) college, William, a computer science major dropped
- C) college William a computer science major, dropped
- D) college, William, a computer science major, dropped

2. Although his research was not _____ his bone cancer treatment was the next big breakthrough.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) finished, Dr. Bates hoped to prove that
- B) finished, Dr. Bates hoped to prove, that
- C) finished Dr. Bates hoped to prove that
- D) finished, Dr. Bates, hoped to prove that

3. Despite growing up in a small town in rural Wisconsin, Sandra has always had a passion for representing her community and wants to dedicate her life to being a professional politician. She has big plans for her career in politics, including _____ and getting elected to Congress.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) running for Mayor and serving as state Governor,
- B) running for Mayor, serving as state Governor,
- C) running for Mayor, and also serving as state Governor
- D) running for Mayor serving as state Governor,

4. Edouard Manet is famous for his artworks that commonly feature people, often with harsh contours and abrupt contrasts of light and shadow that help highlight his subjects; on the other hand, Monet is known for his _____ paintings of natural landscapes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) incredible detailed oil
- B) incredibly and detailed oil
- C) incredible, detailed, oil
- D) incredible, detailed oil

5. My grandpa used to be a biology teacher, but his limited knowledge about animals always surprises me. For example, a group of lions is called a _____ my grandpa insists on calling it a herd instead.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) pride, however,
- B) pride; however,
- C) pride however
- D) pride however,

6. The biology teacher assigned the _____ and asked the students to review the basics of genetics.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) chapter in the textbook, on photosynthesis, for homework
- B) chapter, in the textbook, on photosynthesis for homework,
- C) chapter, in the textbook on photosynthesis for homework,
- D) chapter in the textbook on photosynthesis for homework

7. The cover page noted the impressive achievements of _____ breakthrough in the new radiology techniques that a team from Korea discovered.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) scientist William Dubrovsky and the
- B) scientist, William Dubrovsky, and the
- C) scientist William Dubrovsky, and the
- D) scientist (William Dubrovsky), and the

8. My youngest sister, Kate, was so determined to win the pinewood derby race that she hid weights inside of her _____ disqualified.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) car, so she, consequently, was
- B) car, so she; consequently, was
- C) car; so she, consequently was
- D) car, so she consequently, was

9. United States _____ is best known as the first man to walk on the moon although some people believe that the moon landing was a hoax.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) astronaut Neil Armstrong
- B) astronaut, Neil Armstrong
- C) astronaut, Neil Armstrong,
- D) astronaut Neil Armstrong,

10. The _____ building is scheduled to be completed by the end of next summer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) new ten-story luxury apartment
- B) new, ten-story luxury apartment,
- C) new, ten-story, luxury, apartment
- D) new ten-story, luxury apartment,

11. Claire chose to attend Cedar Brook _____ that does not assign letter grades but instead emphasizes the academic growth of its students.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) University, which has a unique curriculum
- B) University, with a unique curriculum,
- C) University which has a unique, curriculum
- D) University which has a unique curriculum,

12. _____ together to design the new greenhouse at the Miami Botanical Gardens.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) English architect Andrew Rollins, and Swiss engineer Melissa Voss worked
- B) English architect, Andrew Rollins, and Swiss engineer, Melissa Voss, worked
- C) English architect Andrew Rollins and Swiss Engineer Melissa Voss worked
- D) English architect Andrew Rollins and Swiss engineer Melissa Voss, worked

13. In 1866, Ramses Burnett, a member of English royalty, established a theater that involved the crowd in his plays. Ramses split the crowd into small _____ lines and positions to selected people within each group, making every play unique and often comical.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) groups; assigning
- B) groups, he assigned
- C) groups, and assigning
- D) groups, assigning

14. The silent movie era in Hollywood was followed by the talkies. The introduction of sound in movies allowed for new genres to be created, such as _____ era was followed by the Golden Era that introduced iconic Hollywood stars.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) horror; this
- B) horror, this
- C) horror this
- D) horror and this

15. After making the diving touchdown _____ into the stands to celebrate with the fans, injured his ankle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) catch, Keenan Allan jumped
- B) catch, Keenan Allan, jumped
- C) catch, Keenan Allan jumping
- D) catch, Keenan Allan, jumping

16. For the kite surfing competition, twenty identical kites were brought to the _____ to ensure that they all worked properly, and given out to each competitor.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) beach tested
- B) beach, testing them
- C) beach, tested
- D) beach to test them

17. The key to retaining information _____ to study for recall rather than recognition.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) properly, psychologists believe is,
- B) properly psychologists believe is
- C) properly, psychologists believe is
- D) properly, psychologists believe, is

18. It was a long-held belief that the first hamburger was invented 100 years ago when a _____ a meat patty accidentally onto a slice of bread, had a brilliant idea.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Danish immigrant dropped
- B) Danish immigrant, dropped
- C) Danish immigrant, dropping
- D) Danish immigrant was dropping

19. When the _____ in 1983, fairgoers across the country were offered a thrill ride that they had never experienced before.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Gravitron, which debuted
- B) Gravitron debuted
- C) Gravitron that debuted
- D) Gravitron, debuting

20. Science is constantly discovering new species of microscopic organisms. _____ identified each year, the vast majority are found in agricultural fields.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) There are thousands of new bacteria
- B) Scientists say there are thousands of new bacteria
- C) Of the thousands of new bacteria
- D) Bacteria in the thousands are

21. Retail merchandise buyers for global brands have the challenging job of predicting what pieces of clothing will _____ to decide in what countries the products will be sold.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) appeal to customers, in order
- B) appeal, to customers in order,
- C) appeal to customers in order
- D) appeal, to customers, in order

22. In order to survive, the Remora, also called a suckerfish, starts a symbiotic relationship with the _____ onto the shark for free rides across the ocean.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) shark, latching
- B) shark; latching
- C) shark. Latching
- D) shark and latching

23. The personal _____ decided to put an advertisement for his business at the finish line.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) trainer, organizing the 5K run
- B) trainer organizing the 5K run
- C) trainer organizing the, 5K run
- D) trainer, organizing the 5K run,

24. Creole cuisine has many distinctive qualities; however, professional chefs say the cuisine's real identifying _____ blend of West African, French, and Southern foods.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) quality, the
- B) quality, that is the
- C) quality is the
- D) quality, which is the

25. The infamous graffiti _____ who in 2017 completed a full mural with his signature caricatures of the city's most prominent individuals, is always finding new ways to attract attention to issues that he cares about.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) artist, Josh Bridgewater,
- B) artist (Josh Bridgewater),
- C) artist Josh Bridgewater
- D) artist Josh Bridgewater,

26. Sun exposure plays an important role in snakes' abilities to regulate their body _____ snakes survive in both warmer and cooler climates.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) temperatures; in effect, helping
- B) temperatures, this helps
- C) temperatures; therefore, helping
- D) temperatures, helping

27. Falconry is considered by many to be the oldest sport known to man. Its participants, called falconers, train birds of prey to hunt game, and the peregrine _____ and one of the easiest to train, is currently the most popular falconry bird in the United States.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) falcon; the fastest species of falcon in the world,
- B) falcon, the fastest species of falcon in the world,
- C) falcon, the fastest species of falcon in the world
- D) falcon the fastest species of falcon in the world,

28. The construction crew finished the _____ runners to pass over the river and use the paths on the western side of the river as well.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) bridge enabling
- B) bridge; enabling
- C) bridge and this enabled
- D) bridge; this enabled

29. In 2017, Raul began his first internship prior to medical school at the repudiated labs of Dr. Holmer in San _____ in exchange for a modest salary, Raul helps the scientists to find applications for their research.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Diego, where,
- B) Diego; where,
- C) Diego, where;
- D) Diego where

30. With much at stake for _____ if their products don't sell, inventory managers carefully analyze consumer preferences and use analytics to forecast demand to optimize their inventory levels.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) their companies,
- B) their companies;
- C) their companies
- D) their companies.

31. In 2018, German researchers Julianne Bräuer and Julia Belger conducted a study to learn more about dogs' powerful olfactory capabilities for search and rescue teams. The study _____ needed just five footsteps to determine by smell which direction a person had walked on a given trail.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) concluded that, dogs
- B) concluded, that dogs
- C) concluded that dogs,
- D) concluded that dogs

32. A 2005 study by Dr. Kelly Jaakola established that dolphins were able to demonstrate that they grasp relative numerosity. This insight proposes that dolphins may also be able to engage in numerical _____ intellectual trait formerly attributed only to humans and certain primates.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) categorization an
- B) categorization, an
- C) categorization; an
- D) categorization. An

Chapter 3: Semicolons, Colons, Dashes, Apostrophes and Quotation Marks

Semicolons

Semicolons are used to separate two independent clauses. On the SAT, just remember that:

Semicolon = period

If you can replace a semicolon with a period, then it is used correctly! In other words, everything before the semicolon must stand as a complete sentence on its own, and everything after the semicolon must stand as a complete sentence on its own.

Incorrect: My boss called me; asking that I pick up coffee for him.

(2nd half of the sentence is not an independent clause)

Incorrect: After my boss called me; he asked that I pick up coffee for him.

(1st half of sentence is not an independent clause)

Incorrect: My boss called me, he asked that I pick up coffee for him.

(comma splice – cannot connect two independent clauses with a comma)

Correct: My boss called me; he asked that I pick up coffee for him.

(two independent clauses separated by a semicolon)

Semicolons Practice:

1. Exposure to sunlight is important for the human body (, / ;) sunlight stimulates the production of vitamin D.
2. Although the President refused to negotiate directly with the Chinese government (, / ;) the deal was still completed before the deadline.
3. The dining room table was hand-crafted by Terry (, / ;) so he was able to sell it for over four thousand dollars.
4. I used to think that houseplants can live both outside and inside (, / ;) some only survive indoors.
5. Known best for his role in Forrest Gump (, / ;) Tom Hanks has been in many other famous movies (, / ;) including Cast Away and Toy Story.
6. Completing a marathon is (, / ;) according to my friend Joe (, / ;) an incredible feat (, / ;) he could not even finish the half-marathon.
7. Strawberries are supposed to be easy to grow (, / ;) however (, / ;) the ones in my garden die every year.
8. Arctic animals are some of the most highly adapted to their environments. Take the arctic fox (, / ;) for example (, / ;) the fox is entirely white and blends in seamlessly to its snowy surroundings.

Semicolons and Lists (Advanced Rule)

There is one special situation where a semicolon is not the same as a period. **Semicolons are used to separate items in a list where using commas alone makes the list unclear or confusing.** To see how this works, let's consider the following example:

Incorrect: The skills necessary for success as a biology professor at Stanford University are mentoring, teaching, and supporting the students in your class, providing an open environment for discussion, and conducting research involving microbiology, biotechnology, or biochemistry.

Correct: The skills necessary for success as a biology professor at Stanford University are mentoring, teaching, and supporting the students in your class; providing an open environment for discussion; and conducting research involving microbiology, biotechnology, or biochemistry.

In the incorrect example, it is unclear exactly how many items are being listed and what the items in the list are. Using semicolons in the list clarifies that the list is made up of 3 items: (1) "mentoring, teaching, and supporting the students in your class," (2) "providing an open environment for discussion," and (3) "conducting research involving microbiology, biotechnology, or biochemistry."

On the SAT, semicolons and lists questions more commonly have a semicolon in the middle of the sentence that is clearly incorrect with our original semicolon = period rule.

Incorrect: The Soetdoing Dam Nature Reserve and the Mount Sheba Nature Reserve are two nature reserves in South Africa dedicated to fostering a protected habitat for many endangered species, such as the Samango monkey and the black rhinoceros, providing outdoor recreation activities, such as hiking and fishing, and protecting indigenous lands.

Correct: The Soetdoing Dam Nature Reserve and the Mount Sheba Nature Reserve are two nature reserves in South Africa dedicated to fostering a protected habitat for many endangered species, such as the Samango monkey and the black rhinoceros; providing outdoor recreation activities, such as hiking and fishing; and protecting indigenous lands.

As with our first example, the incorrect sentence is unclear that the items are being listed. Once the semicolons are added, the sentence now clearly has a list of 3 items.

***Test-Taking Tip: If you see a semicolon before the word "and" or "or," you are looking at a semicolon list questions.**

Semicolons and Lists Practice:

1. Like many musicians, Trent Reznor took on many roles early in his career to support himself. In addition to singing, songwriting, and playing over ten instruments, Reznor worked as an assistant _____ janitor, and children's guitar teacher.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) engineer;
- B) engineer:
- C) engineer
- D) engineer,

2. During a trip to New York, Shandra went to Broadway to see _____ visited The Statue of Liberty and Times Square; and saw a basketball game at Madison Square Garden.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Cats, Little Shop of Horrors, and Hamilton,
- B) Cats; Little Shop of Horrors, and Hamilton,
- C) Cats, Little Shop of Horrors, and Hamilton;
- D) Cats; Little Shop of Horrors; and Hamilton;

3. During the three-year culinary program, students learn to cut with proper _____ kitchens, and seating charts; and manage inventory.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) technique, season food, plate beautifully; construct plans for menus,
- B) technique; season food; plate beautifully; construct plans for menus,
- C) technique; season food; plate beautifully; construct plans for menus;
- D) technique, season food; plate beautifully, construct plans for menus,

4. The Pacific Crest Trail Association is a nonprofit dedicated to protecting one of the most beautiful trails in the _____ include fire and camping permits; and petitioning government agencies for financial resources.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) United States, helping hikers get required permits, which,
- B) United States, helping hikers get required permits, which
- C) United States; helping hikers get required permits, which
- D) United States; helping hikers get required permits; which

5. Andy Warhol was inspired by much of Marcel Duchamp's art, including what Duchamp called readymades, which were ordinary objects that he designated as works of art. Warhol proceeded to select Campbell's soup for his most famous piece and carefully _____ to mimic the look of Campbell's 32 varieties, producing cans that were uniform except for the label.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) selected colors, canvasses, and stamps
- B) selected colors, canvasses; and stamps
- C) selected colors; canvasses; and stamps
- D) selected colors; canvasses and stamps

6. There are currently two ways to take the SAT: with a pencil and paper, which has been the standard for over 50 _____ is being introduced for the first time for international students in 2023.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) years, or with a computer, which
- B) years, or with a computer; which
- C) years; or with a computer; which
- D) years; or with a computer which

Colons

A colon can be used to introduce a list of multiple items, a list of one item, an example, an explanation, a clarification, or a definition. Examples of all of these are below:

Correct: I went to the grocery store to pick up some items for dinner: chicken, cheese, and onions.

Correct: I went to the market to get lunch: a turkey sandwich.

Correct: He got what he deserved: a one-week suspension without pay.

Correct: Chocolate milk is a great recovery drink after a hard workout: it has the carbohydrates and proteins that muscles need to recover.

In order for a colon to be correct, we must follow three basic rules:

- 1. The part of the sentence before a colon must be an independent clause.** If the part of the sentence before the colon cannot stand as a complete sentence by itself, it is always incorrect.

Incorrect: The slide showing the most popular car colors in 2018: white, gray, and black.

Correct: The slide shows the most popular car colors in 2018: white, gray, and black.

Incorrect: The hairstylist excelled in: cuts, coloring, and highlights.

Correct: The hairstylist excelled in cuts, coloring, and highlights.

- 2. Everything after a colon must consist of only the items in the list, an example, an explanation, a clarification, or a definition.** The sentence cannot continue to other topics.

Incorrect: Will brought his lunch to the beach: a roast beef sandwich, and he brought his friend Joey a turkey club.

Correct: Will brought his lunch to the beach: a roast beef sandwich. He brought his friend Joey a turkey club.

- 3. Colons are NEVER used with “including,” “such as,” and “for example.”** If you ever see a colon before or after any of these, it is always incorrect!

Incorrect: I went to the grocery store to pick up some items for dinner, including: chicken, cheese, and onions.

Incorrect: I went to the grocery store to pick up some items for dinner: including chicken, cheese, and onions.

Incorrect: Certain plants grow well in winter: for example garlic, leeks, radishes, and potatoes.

Incorrect: My favorite dishes to cook: such as chicken parmesan, cheesesteaks, and mac-and-cheese, always include cheese.

Incorrect: The study relied on techniques such as: direct observation and surveying.

If a list is introduced by “including” or “for example,” use a comma. This works because the list now is unnecessary information. **For “such as,” you can use a comma or not use a comma depending on the sentence.**

Correct: I went to the grocery store to pick up some items for dinner, including chicken, cheese, and onions.

Correct: Certain plants grow very well in winter, for example garlic, leeks, radishes, and potatoes.

Correct: My favorite dishes to cook, such as chicken parmesan, cheesesteaks, and mac-and-cheese, always include cheese.

Correct: The study relied on techniques such as direct observation and surveying.

TIP – Colons and Clauses

A colon can join two independent clauses if the second clause after the colon acts as a definition, an example, an explanation, or a clarification of the first clause. This is an advanced grammar rule that appears on the SAT.

Correct: Buddy got what he worked for: he really deserved that promotion.

Correct: My father gave me one rule to live by: honesty is always the best policy.

Since we are connecting two independent clauses, the examples above also would be correct with a semicolon, a period, or a comma + FANBOYS. However, sometimes the colon is the only correct option given in the answer choices.

Semicolons, Colons, and Commas Practice: Select which punctuation is correct. Some questions may have multiple correct answers.

1. James knew exactly how to make spaghetti (, / ; / :) boil water, add salt, and then add the pasta.
2. There’s only one way to truly get a dog’s attention (, / ; / :) food.
3. On her college application, Leann listed some of her extracurricular activities (, / ; / :) such as horseback riding, debate team, and volunteer work.
4. Honda’s new compact cars are known for being fuel efficient (, / ; / :) each one gets more than 25 miles per gallon.
5. The order was requested six weeks ago (, / ; / :) we expected the sofa, chairs, and table to have arrived by now.
6. The Italian flag has three colors (, / ; / :) green, white, and red.
7. The directions were clear (, / ; / :) place cookie dough onto the tray, place in the oven, and cook for ten minutes.
8. In order to examine how old the artifacts were (, / ; / :) the scientists turned to the most reliable dating method (, / ; / :) carbon dating (, / ; / :) which uses the properties of radiocarbon to determine the precise age of an object containing organic material.
9. The harmonica is an easy instrument to play (, / ; / :) but it is notoriously hard to master (, / ; / :) only true experts know how to hit all of notes on a harmonica.

Colons Practice:

1. I have always found surfing difficult, but it can be broken down into three simple _____ and the ride the wave.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) steps paddle hard, stand-up,
- B) steps: paddle hard, stand up,
- C) steps, including: paddle hard, stand up
- D) steps paddle hard stand up,

2. In a groundbreaking study published in 2020, physicist Sharon Saunders presents a fresh explanation for the origin of dark _____ material, which could take the form of weakly interacting particles (cold dark matter) or high-energy randomly moving particles (hot dark matter).

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) matter nonluminous
- B) matter. Nonluminous
- C) matter; nonluminous
- D) matter: nonluminous

3. Since solar power generates most of its electricity during the day and provides very little power at night, new methods such as Compressed Air Energy Storage (CAES) are beginning to be implemented around the world. Currently, only two power plants use _____ in Indio, California, and another in Milan, Italy.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) CAES; one
- B) CAES, one:
- C) CAES: one
- D) CAES. One

4. Consumer Psychologist Melissa Filteau studies the relationship between linguistic structures and musicality. After analyzing, 25 years of Billboard's Hot 100 music charts, Filteau _____ songs that heavily featured repetition in their lyrics had the best chance of reaching the top 10.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) found; that
- B) found, that
- C) found that
- D) found: that

5. Porsche has begun to advertise on social media platforms with 15 second ads, which means they have to focus on one aspect of their car. Emphasizing the car's acceleration delivers a clear and compelling _____ fast.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) message, it's
- B) message. It's:
- C) message: it's
- D) message, it's

6. 19th century plays would only include women for very menial _____ the baker who only has two minutes of stage time and has no spoken lines.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) roles, such as,
- B) roles: such as
- C) roles: such as,
- D) roles, such as

Dashes

Dashes can function like unnecessary information commas, parentheses, or colons.

Most commonly on the SAT, 2 dashes function like unnecessary information commas or parentheses to separate unnecessary information in the middle of a sentence.

Correct: Residents of Washington D.C. – the capital of the United States – are still trying to get representation in Congress.

Correct: Glazed donuts – even if they are unhealthy – are my favorite.

Keep an eye out for pairs of dashes setting apart unnecessary information. **Anytime you see a dash in the answer choices, look for a second dash earlier or later in the sentence.** A pair of dashes sets apart unnecessary information in the same way that a pair of commas does. It is important to remember that you cannot mix punctuation! It must be a pair of commas, a pair of dashes, or a pair of parentheses.

Incorrect: Deep-dish pizza – a famous meal in Chicago, does not exist in Italy.

Correct: Deep-dish pizza, a famous meal in Chicago, does not exist in Italy.

Correct: Deep-dish pizza – a famous meal in Chicago – does not exist in Italy.

Correct: Deep-dish pizza (a famous meal in Chicago) does not exist in Italy.

On more difficult questions, a single dash can act as a colon introducing a list of multiple items, a list of one item, an example, an explanation, a definition, or a clarification. When acting as a colon, a dash must follow the same 3 colon rules we just covered on page 38.

Correct: You will need the following ingredients – milk, butter, flour, and eggs.

Correct: In order to establish his dominance, the male lion relied on one thing – his thunderous roar.

Correct: The study declared that the results were conclusive – mice will complete the maze faster if they are given soda instead of water.

Challenge – Single Dash Acting Like Parentheses

A single dash in the middle of the sentence can also separate information at the end of the sentence just like a pair of parentheses would.

Correct: After three weeks, the patient was fed up with his doctor's plan (or lack of a plan).

Correct: After three weeks, the patient was fed up with his doctor's plan – or lack of a plan.

This rule is one of the difficult questions on SATs, so it is an important one to know, especially for students aiming for very high scores.

Important Rule for a Single Dash: For a single dash to be correct, there must be a complete sentence (independent clause) before the dash. If the part of the sentence before a single dash is not a complete sentence, the sentence is not grammatically correct.

Incorrect: In the season finale, revealing that two of the characters were a younger and older version of the same person – my mind was blown.

Correct: In the season finale, it was revealed that two of the characters were a younger and older version of the same person – my mind was blown.

Dashes Practice:

1. In the future, I would not recommend the moving company that we hired. All of Tommy's favorite _____ lost during the move.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) toys, his toy cars, his marbles, and his Legos – were
- B) toys – his toy cars, his marbles, and his Legos were
- C) toys – his toy cars, his marbles, and his Legos – were
- D) toys: his toy cars, his marbles, and his Legos were

2. Thailand is famous for its tourist _____ beaches, fantastic food, and crystal-clear water.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) attractions: including beautiful
- B) attractions including beautiful
- C) attractions including: beautiful
- D) attractions – beautiful

3. Known best for the amazing ability to change its colors to blend into its surroundings, the cuttlefish – one of evolution's great mysteries (scientists still have no idea how the cuttlefish can perfectly match its body pattern to its _____ also famous for having three hearts.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) background) is
- B) background – is
- C) background) – is
- D) background), is

4. The true breakthrough occurred _____ capuchin monkeys learned that the silver discs had value and could be used to buy food.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) when, surprisingly enough to the researchers, the
- B) when, surprisingly enough to the researchers the
- C) when – surprisingly enough – to the researchers, the
- D) when – (surprisingly enough to the researchers) –

5. _____ incredible complexity of flavor – is often cited as why certain dishes are so delicious.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Umami: an
- B) Umami, an
- C) Umami – an
- D) Umami which is an

6. Like generations of Montanan ranchers before him, John Medley starts his workday before dawn, feeding horses and tending to cattle. Then, however, he must turn his attention to the ranch's _____ the tourists.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) other, less conventional occupants—
- B) other, less conventional occupants,
- C) other, less conventional, occupants
- D) other less conventional occupants;

Apostrophes

Apostrophes on the SAT have two functions: possession and contractions. Let's first start with the more commonly tested and more difficult possession rules.

Possession Rules

Apostrophes are used show possession. **For singular nouns, add an apostrophe and the letter "s" to the end of the word to show possession.**

Correct: Terrence's bike is much faster than my brother's roller blades.

For singular words that end in the letter "s," such as "bus," we can add an apostrophe and the letter "s" or just add an apostrophe. Both are technically correct. The SAT has not tested this specific rule yet, but it is good to know just in case.

Correct: The bus's driver asked us to sit down.

Correct: The bus' driver asked us to sit down.

For plural nouns that end in "s," we add the apostrophe after the "s" to show possession.

Correct: The boys' jerseys were all covered in mud after the game.

Correct: The chef owns four restaurants, and all the restaurants' menus are updated weekly.

Some plural nouns do not end in the letter "s." For these, add an apostrophe and the letter "s" to the end of the word to show possession.

Correct: Our women's basketball team won the championship last year.

TIP - Possessive vs. Plural

The SAT asks you to pick between singular possessive, plural possessive, and non-possessive, plural words. The challenge is that the words sound very similar, as you can see here:

Correct: I accidentally stepped on the dog's bone. (singular possessive)

Correct: The dogs' collars are in the basket by the door. (plural possessive)

Correct: I watched as the dogs played in the yard. (non-possessive plural)

Before adding an apostrophe, make sure the next word is actually being possessed by the noun. In the first example, the dog is possessing the bone. In the second example, the dogs are possessing the collars. In the third example, the dogs are not possessing the played, so there is no possession.

Apostrophes Practice:

1. The (witch's/witches'/witches) magic broom allowed her to fly.
2. Mary had three children, and all of the (kid's/ kids'/kids) heights were marked on the garage door.
3. The earthquake knocked all the (door's/doors'/doors) off their hinges.
4. The lawyer demanded that his (client's/clients'/clients) testimony be removed from the record.
5. It should be illegal to steal (eagle's/eagles'/eagles) eggs from their nests.

Advanced Singular vs. Plural Possession

For some apostrophes questions, we need to read for context to determine if we need singular or plural possession. The context may be from earlier in the sentence, earlier in the paragraph, or from the word that is being possessed.

In the computer lab yesterday, each student was asked to replace the background of his or her computer with a picture of roses. Now, the _____ are various colors of roses.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) computer's background
- B) computers backgrounds
- C) computers' background
- D) computers' backgrounds

If we read only the final sentence, we cannot tell if there is one computer or multiple computers. If there is one computer, A would be correct since it shows one computer possessing one background. If there are multiple computers, D would be correct since it should multiple computers possessing multiple backgrounds. So, we need to read for context. In the sentence before, we see there are multiple computers, so D is correct.

Advanced Singular vs. Plural Possession Practice:

1. The art critic's review focused on the largest painting on display and was most critical of the (painting's/paintings'/paintings) controversial subject matter.
2. The company reduced the amount of plastic used in the (bottle's/bottles'/bottles) caps by 23%.
3. After the remodel, the (townhouse's, townhouses', townhouses) value increased.

Compound Possession (Possession with Multiple Items in a List)

The most advanced and difficult possession rule tested on the SAT has to do with how to properly show compound possession. **When all the items in a list are separately possessing the noun, we add apostrophes to each item in the list. When the items in the list are all jointly possessing the noun, we only add an apostrophe to the last item in the list.**

Correct: Cesar's, Millie's and Marisol's presentations are on Tuesday.

Correct: Cesar, Millie, and Marisol's presentation is on Tuesday.

In the first sentence, there are 3 separate presentations. The apostrophe shows that Cesar's presentation, Millie's presentation, and Marisol's presentation are on Tuesday. In the second sentence, there is 1 joint presentation by Cesar, Millie, and Marisol on Tuesday.

Correct: The dog's and cat's foods are in bins in the basement.

Correct: The dog and cat's food is in a bin in the basement.

In the first sentence, there are 2 separate types of food (dog food and cat food). The apostrophe shows that the dog's food and the cat's food are in bins in the basement. In the second sentence, there is 1 type of shared food (the dog and cat's food) that both the dog and cat eat.

Possession with Multiple Items in a List Practice:

1. (Theodora and Melody's/Theodora's and Melody's) chocolate chip cookie recipe is the best on the website.
2. The Vatican Museum houses one of the most impressive art collections in the world. The most famous paintings are (Michaelangelo's and Rafael's/Michaelangelos and Rafael's).
3. (Lemon and lime's/Lemon's and lime's) sourness make them versatile cooking ingredients.

Apostrophes Practice:

1. After showing up late to field hockey practice and being benched for the game, Victoria had to wash all of her _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) teammates jerseys
- B) teammates' jerseys
- C) teammate's jerseys
- D) teammates' jersey's

2. Over the past twenty years, one of the rap industry's biggest secrets has become slightly more well-known to those outside of the industry. The use of ghostwriters, professional musicians who are paid to write other _____ is more widely known thanks to a dispute between Drake and Meek Mill about ghost writing that led to two platinum singles.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) artist's lyrics,
- B) artists lyric's,
- C) artists lyrics,
- D) artist's lyric's,

3. In his groundbreaking book *Emigrate and Exiles: Ireland and the Irish Exodus to North America*, Kerby miller uses census records, ships' logs, personal journals, and memoirs to tell the _____ who made North America their home in the 1800s.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) story's of the Irish immigrants'
- B) story's of the Irish immigrants
- C) stories of the Irish immigrants
- D) stories' of the Irish immigrants

4. Ralph Mcquarrie and Joe Johnston were tasked by George Lucas to create an aesthetic for *Star Wars*. _____ aesthetic emerged as a blend of mythology and technology.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Mcquarrie and Johnstons'
- B) Mcquarrie's and Johnston's
- C) Mcquarrie and Johnston's
- D) Mcquarries and Johnstons

5. A recent study from consumer reports measured the amount of lead and cadmium contained in popular dark chocolate bars. Tunde Akinleye, one of the _____ says, "there are risks for people of any age, but they are greatest for pregnant people and young children because the metals can cause developmental problems."

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) studies scientists
- B) studies' scientists
- C) study's scientists
- D) study's scientist's

6. Minor inconsistencies in the data, whether on purpose or by accident, ultimately mattered little in the end, for the project was more about learning how to run the experiment than gathering accurate measurements of the _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) car's tire's pressure's
- B) cars' tire's pressures
- C) car's tires pressure
- D) car's tires' pressures

Possessive Pronouns

Possessive pronouns (his, hers, its, theirs, ours, yours) end in an “s” and do not use an apostrophe to show possession. The difficulty is that words like “yours” and “ours” may look like they may need an apostrophe.

The correct and incorrect versions of possessive pronouns are shown below:

Correct	Incorrect	
Its	It's	Its'
Hers	Her's	Hers'
Yours	Your's	Yours'
Ours	Our's	Ours'
Theirs	Their's	Theirs'

Contractions

For a contraction, add an apostrophe. For example, “it’s” is a contraction for “it is” and “they’re” is a contraction for “they are.”

TIP – Possessive Pronouns vs. Contractions

If you need to pick between a conjunction and a possessive pronoun, plug in the complete phrase and see if it works.

The cat loves playing with (its/it's) new toy. (plug in “it is”)

The cat loves playing with it is new toy. (well that is wrong)

So the answer is:

Correct: The cat loves playing with its new toy.

Let's practice with the most commonly featured contractions on the SAT:

“its” (possessive) vs. “it’s” (it is)

I cannot believe that (its/it's) not butter!

The dog keeps chasing (its/it's) tail.

“your” (possessive) vs. “you’re” (you are)

Please keep (your/you're) feelings to yourself.

(Your/you're) not going to believe what happened on Game of Thrones!

“their” (possessive) vs. “they’re” (they are)

The gold medal winners all held up (their/they're) medals for the picture.

(Their/They're) going to the opera despite the bad reviews.

“whose” (possessive) vs. “who’s” (who is)

I do not know (whose/who's) socks these are.

Honestly, (whose/who's) going to pay fifteen dollars for a burrito?

Quotation Marks

Quotation marks are most commonly used for direct quotes.

Direct quotes that are spoken are offset by a comma. Anytime the quote is actually being spoken in some way (said, yelled, whispered, exclaimed, etc.), there is a comma before or after the quotation.

Correct: Abigail said, "I will not pay until the painting is completed."

Correct: "The thunderstorm last night woke me up," Paul whispered.

Direct quotes that are not spoken have no commas. If the quote is not being spoken and is just a phrase or part of the sentence, there is no punctuation.

Incorrect: My grandfather described the shells as, "beautiful souvenirs from a past life."

Correct: My grandfather described the shells as "beautiful souvenirs from a past life."

Here, the quotation marks show "beautiful souvenirs from a past life" are the grandfather's words and not the writer's words. Since the words are not actually being spoken by the grandfather, there is no comma before the quotation marks.

Quotation marks can be used to show a word is being used as a technical term, used in an unusual or slang way, or used as another expression that varies from standard usage.

Correct: Having defined the term "contact variance," Dr. Chen continued his lecture.

Correct: Sven refers to himself as a "professional" influencer.

Correct: This "revolutionary" program has left thousands of children without a basic education.

Correct: Allie could smell the "fresh" fish from across the room.

Quotation Marks Practice:

1. The approaching hurricane was so powerful and was forecasted to bring such an unprecedented amount of rain that it was _____ by the news reporter.
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) called, "the storm of the century"
B) called "the storm of the century"
C) called, "the storm of the century,"
D) called "the storm of the century,"
2. After the teacher saw the two boys quarreling for the second time that _____ "what is going on with you two?"
Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
A) day, she asked,
B) day she asked,
C) day, she asked
D) day she asked

Question Marks

A question mark is placed at the end of a sentence that is a direct question. If there is no direct question, no question mark is needed. If you have a question that has some answer choices with a question mark and others without, make sure you check to see if a question is being asked.

Incorrect: Since the museum closes in 20 minutes, Alicia was wondering if she could still go inside?

Correct: Since the museum closes in 20 minutes, Alicia was wondering if she could still go inside.

Incorrect: Since the museum closes in 20 minutes, Alicia asked the security guard, "can I still go inside."

Correct: Since the museum closes in 20 minutes, Alicia asked the security guard, "can I still go inside?"

In the first sentence, there is no question, so we do not need a question mark. Alicia "wondering if she can still go inside" is a statement not a question. In the second sentence, Alicia is asking the security guard a direct question, so we use a question mark.

Question Marks Practice:

1. Marketing analyst Emily Chen was asked by a home goods company to identify how much _____ Through market research and customer surveys, she discovered that there was no singular perfect price: consumer willingness to pay varied based on factors like smell, packaging, and brand perception.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) do most people willing to pay for laundry detergent?
- B) do most people willing to pay for laundry detergent.
- C) are most people willing to pay for laundry detergent?
- D) are most people willing to pay for laundry detergent.

2. The Earth's atmosphere is the bane of astronomers. Cloudy and misty nights make observation impossible, and the atmosphere absorbs portions of the ultraviolet and infrared spectrum, which in turn interferes with star light data. What could we see if _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a telescope could be placed outside of our atmosphere?
- B) a telescope could be placed outside of our atmosphere.
- C) we to get a telescope outside of our atmosphere.
- D) we to get a telescope outside of our atmosphere?

Chapter 3 Practice:

1. Jerry's cafe is famous for its breakfast _____ , blueberry pancakes, and French toast.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) dishes: eggs benedict
- B) dishes – eggs benedict –
- C) dishes, including: eggs benedict
- D) dishes, my favorites are eggs benedict

2. As a young boy, Raheem became enthralled with pro soccer _____ signature moves.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) player's and their
- B) players' and their
- C) players
- D) players'

3. Everyone knew that Arya Stark was still _____ would not be revealed until the next season.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) alive, but the fate of John Snow – though
- B) alive, but the fate of John Snow – though –
- C) alive – but the fate of, John Snow though –
- D) alive but the fate of John Snow, though,

4. The Turing test, originally called the imitation game by Alan Turing in 1950, is used to assess _____ an artificial intelligence program is.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) how, "human"
- B) how "human"
- C) how "human,"
- D) how, "human,"

5. The curriculum went beyond the _____ it highlighted some of the most advanced rules.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) basics
- B) basics and
- C) basics:
- D) basics,

6. The few words remaining on the antique _____ *Coffe Haus...Main Street Bakery...Menagerie* – were barely legible.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) signs
- B) signs –
- C) signs,
- D) signs:

7. In 2023, the National Women's Soccer League announced a new television _____ \$240 million over four years – a huge leap in value for the league that just years ago was struggling to survive.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) deal for
- B) deal; for
- C) deal: for
- D) deal, for

8. After another fantastic performance at the 2012 Summer Olympics, Michael Phelps – having won 22 Olympic medals – became the _____ swimmer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) world's most popular mens
- B) world's most popular men's
- C) worlds' most popular men's
- D) worlds most popular mens'

9. The 4th of July fireworks display down at the harbor was _____ were launched from 10 different ships while an orchestra played the Star-Spangled Banner.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) revolutionary, fireworks
- B) revolutionary, with fireworks
- C) revolutionary: fireworks
- D) revolutionary; and fireworks

10. Hammocks are fantastic for relaxing on a sunny _____ the comfort of a couch with the swaying of a swing.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) day, they combine
- B) day: because they combine
- C) day; they combine
- D) day; combining

11. At the board meeting, the owner and CEO, Maria Gonzales, finally unveiled the plan for the new manufacturing _____ ten-thousand square foot building that will be completed in 2024 and will create 950 new jobs.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) facility; a
- B) facility – a
- C) facility. A
- D) facility (a

12. To better serve immigrant families in El Paso Texas in the 1920s, local activist Linda Agurto conducted meetings in both English and Spanish, an uncommon _____ celebrated el día de los Muertos, an important community holiday; and put on plays dramatizing Mexican folktales.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) practice, at the time
- B) practice at the time;
- C) practice, at the time;
- D) practice at the time,

13. A group of Peruvian and international botanists discovered a new species of plant in the Peruvian Andes while looking for a rare flower in the Arequipa _____ new species, named “Viola ornate,” is a perennial herb that grows in rosettes with small flowers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) region; the
- B) region the
- C) region and the
- D) region, the

14. At the science fair, Jimmy’s project proved that Coca-Cola breaks down teeth faster than either sugar _____ does alone.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) water – or lemon juice –
- B) water, or lemon juice,
- C) water, or lemon juice
- D) water or lemon juice

15. Although many experts believed that cryptocurrency would be the future, Dhruv believed the _____ would quickly die out.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) opposite, it
- B) opposite; because it
- C) opposite – it
- D) opposite it

16. We decided to do a weeklong backpacking trip on a 50-mile portion of the Pacific Crest Trail, ending at the start of the Sierra Nevada Mountain range. After a long and exhausting journey, we could finally see the _____ final rest stop.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) mountains peaks at the hike's
- B) mountains' peaks at the hike's
- C) mountain's peak's at the hike's
- D) mountains peaks at the hikes

17. As the driver approached, the crossing guard said to _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) herself, "who would buy a purple car?"
- B) herself, "who would buy a purple car."
- C) herself "who would buy a purple car?"
- D) herself "who would buy a purple car."

18. When the law firm Finnegan LLP asked their staff what changes they would like to see at the office, workers said that dressing casually would help them most _____ "being productive, being comfortable, and being happy," said human resources director Shepard Robinson.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) with:
- B) with,
- C) with;
- D) with

19. In Bogota, the names of the different neighborhoods are derived _____ a piece of Colombian political history. For example, Usaquen, which means "under the pole," comes from the tribal chieftain Usaque, who was ruling the region when the first Spanish conquistador arrived.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) from:
- B) from,
- C) from
- D) from –

20. The committee tasked with decreasing the budget is using some uncommon tactics, such as pressuring local businesses to provide discounted good and services, to achieve _____ goal.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its'
- B) their
- C) it's
- D) its

21. Samantha convinced the hostess that the phone found by the waiter was _____ by stating it had a “pink and white case with her initials scratched on the side.”
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) hers
 - B) hers’
 - C) her’s
 - D) theirs
22. The whale shark – so large that it is commonly confused for a _____ is best known for its huge size, gentle nature, and long migrations.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) whale – or a great white shark,
 - B) whale or a great white shark –
 - C) whale or a great white shark,
 - D) whale: or a great white shark
23. Seaweed farming is a potential sustainable replacement for many coastal fishing communities, where overfishing is a financial and ecological problem. Many governmental agencies and non-governmental agencies concerned about both coastal communities and the _____ must convince commercial fishing operations to replace fishing with seaweed farming.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) oceans ecosystems
 - B) oceans ecosystems’
 - C) oceans’ ecosystems
 - D) oceans’ ecosystems’
24. When the children were playing a game of tag in the park, the oak tree _____ a safe space to avoid being tagged.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) was a “home base”
 - B) was a, “home base”
 - C) was a, “home base,”
 - D) was a “home base,”
25. The swimming _____ commonly found in brackish, marine, and freshwater bodies of water – were among the first observed by microscopists.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) habits of paramecium, single celled organisms –
 - B) habits of paramecium – single celled organisms
 - C) habits – of paramecium, single celled organisms,
 - D) habits, of paramecium, single celled organisms,
26. Darwin's theory of evolution, introduced in his seminal work "On the Origin of Species," proposed natural selection as the driving force behind _____ and survival, yet it left unanswered questions about the origin of life itself and the mechanisms governing genetic variations.
- Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?
- A) species’s adaptation’s
 - B) species’ adaptations
 - C) species adaptation
 - D) species’ adaptations’

27. As many classical varieties of winter wheat that thrived in the eastern United States struggled in the midwestern states of Kansas and Nebraska, new varieties such as Turkey Red wheat, from southern Russia, were introduced in the 1880s. Farmers quickly adopted this variety, which would eventually account for 99 percent of all winter _____ in the United States in the early twentieth century.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) wheat planted:
- B) wheat planted,
- C) wheat; planted
- D) wheat planted

28. Daytime pollinators, such as hoverflies and butterflies, have many well-known threats, such as climate change, pesticides, and pollution. Therefore, ecologists are now interested in investigating a potential threat to nocturnal _____ light.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) pollinators, artificial
- B) pollinators artificial
- C) pollinators; artificial
- D) pollinators — artificial

29. Renowned for his thought-provoking storytelling, Gabriel Garcia Marquez's remarkable literary repertoire features *One Hundred Years of Solitude*, a magnum opus that delves into the complex tapestry of Latin American history and familial _____ a timeless tale of enduring love set amidst the backdrop of an epidemic-ravaged Caribbean town; and *Chronicle of a Death Foretold*, a gripping narrative exploring the consequences of collective guilt and honor in a small Colombian village.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) sagas; *Love in the Time of Cholera*;
- B) sagas; *Love in the Time of Cholera*,
- C) sagas, *Love in the Time of Cholera*;
- D) sagas, *Love in the Time of Cholera*:

Chapter 4: Advanced Sentence Structure and Punctuation

On more difficult questions, the SAT includes longer and more complex sentences to challenge you to use the sentence structure and punctuation rules we learned in Chapters 1-3 correctly. In this chapter, we will learn the common ways the SAT tries to trick you and some tips you can apply to answer these questions correctly on test day.

Hidden Independent Clause

The SAT loves to hide independent clauses at the end of longer sentences. This is one of the many reasons why **it is important to always read the entire sentence**, no matter how long it is. If you don't read the entire sentence, you will not recognize the independent clause at the end and answer the question incorrectly.

To see how this can appear on the SAT, let's consider the example below:

Collagen, the most abundant protein in the body, is essential for the human body's ability to _____ fiber-like structure is used to make connective tissue, collagen is a major component of bone, skin, muscles, tendons, and cartilage.

1. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?
- A) heal because its
- B) heal, its
- C) heal. Because its
- D) heal; its

In this example, the hidden independent clause at the end of the sentence is "collagen is a....cartilage." Most students select A, but this is incorrect, as it creates a comma splice since the comma after "tissue" links two independent clauses. When we notice the hidden independent clause and the comma after "tissue," we know that we must split the first sentence in some way to avoid creating a comma splice.

The correct answer is C. The first independent clause has a period after "heal." The second sentence is a dependent clause ("Because its...tissue") followed by comma and then an independent clause ("collagen is...cartilage").

Answer choice B has 3 independent clauses all connected with commas, so it has 2 comma splices. Answer choice D uses a semicolon after the first independent clause, but "its...tissue" is an independent clause. Therefore, the comma after "tissue" is a comma splice, as it incorrectly links two independent clauses with a comma.

Sneaky FANBOYS

We know the Comma + FANBOYS rules already from Chapter 1, but FANBOYS can also be used in more complex sentences. **For Comma + FANBOYS to be correct, the entire part of the sentence before the comma and entire part of the sentence after the FANBOYS must both be complete sentences.** A complete sentence can be more than just an independent clause. For example, a dependent clause followed by comma and then an independent clause is a complete sentence.

Below are the 2 most common ways the SAT structures sentences with sneaky FANBOYS:

1. Complete Sentence, FANBOYS Dependent Clause, Independent Clause

Example: Efficient market theory states better products win out over time, so although an unknown but better product may not be successful at launch, the better product overtakes the inferior product over a long enough time period.

2. Complete Sentence, FANBOYS, Unnecessary Information, Independent Clause

Example: Taylor Swift's 2023 The Eras Tour is the highest grossing concert in history, and, according to a recent article from Forbes, Swift is estimated to be personally earning between \$10 million and \$13 million for each performance.

Anytime you see a comma + FANBOYS, make sure that you read the entire sentence. To see how this can appear on the SAT, let's consider the example below:

Average household retirement income varies widely across the _____ the average households in high-income states make more than twice as much as the average households in the lowest income states, the amount of money that an individual needs to retire depends on local variations in wages, cost of living, tax rules, and other factors.

1. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) States, and since
- B) States and since
- C) States since
- D) States, since

Double Unnecessary Information

On challenging sentences, multiple pieces of unnecessary information can be next to each other in the sentence. We call this double unnecessary information. To see what we mean by this, take a look at the example below:

Example: The Tesla Model Y, which has a range of 330 miles on a full charge, 20 more miles than the range for the Tesla Model X, is one of the most practical electric cars on the market today.

In this example, there is unnecessary information inside other unnecessary information. The first unnecessary information is "which has...charge." The second unnecessary information is "20 more...Model X." The second piece of unnecessary information is giving more information about car's range, which is in first piece of unnecessary information. Using the "crossing-out" trick, we can cross out both pieces of unnecessary information. The challenge here is recognizing that both pieces of information are unnecessary.

To see how this can appear on the SAT, let's consider the example below:

Despite his small stature, Barry Sanders is widely regarded as one of the best running backs in NFL History and is one of two players in history to rush for over 1,000 yards in his first 10 _____ Patriots and Jets running back Curtis Martin, who matched Sanders' record in week 11 of the 2004 season when he surpassed 1,000 yards.

1. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) seasons; the other being
- B) seasons, the other being
- C) seasons, the other was
- D) seasons and the other was

In this example, the double unnecessary information is at the end of the sentence. "the other being...Martin" is the first piece of unnecessary information, and "who matched...yards" is the second piece of unnecessary information. We can remove all of this unnecessary information, so we need a comma after "seasons." The correct answer is B.

Answer choice C is incorrect because "the other was" creates an independent clause, so the comma after "seasons" is a comma splice incorrectly linking 2 independent clauses. Answer choice D also creates 2 independent clauses, so we need a comma before the and to follow the commas + FANBOYS rule.

Answer choice A is incorrect because the second half of the sentence with “the other being” is not a complete sentence.

Splitting Sentences

When the answer choices split the sentences at different points, we need to apply reading comprehension skills to find where the sentence should be split. Be sure to **read the entire paragraph when answering these questions**.

Most commonly, there is going to be an “ing” phrase or a prepositional phrase in the middle of the sentences. Your job is to identify which sentence the phrase should be a part of.

To see how this can appear on the SAT, let’s consider the example below:

Social media platforms, including Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, have become essential tools for communication and _____ connecting with a wide audience or sharing instantaneous updates was much more challenging, often requiring traditional media channels like television and radio.

1. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?
 - A) marketing before the widespread use of these platforms,
 - B) marketing, before the widespread use of these platforms,
 - C) marketing before the widespread use of these platforms;
 - D) marketing. Before the widespread use of these platforms,

We need to determine if “before the widespread use of these platforms” should be part of the first sentence or the second sentence. Here, “before the widespread use of these platforms” must be part of the second sentence, as it sets up how connecting with a wide audience was difficult before social media existed. Answer choices A and C are incorrect because “before the widespread use of these platforms” is describing the communication and marketing, which makes no sense. Since we have 2 complete sentences, we need a semicolon or a period, so the D is correct. The comma after “marketing” in answer choice B incorrectly connects 2 independent clauses and creates a comma splice.

Chapter 4 Practice:

1. Even though consumers of solar-power systems may prioritize saving money over helping the environment, developments in the solar-power industry ensure that both occur. Consumers are not the only one for whom solar power is a win-win _____ of their own efforts, industry employees help provide a more environmentally friendly service while also making a good living for themselves.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) scenario, though, as a result,
- B) scenario, though: as a result,
- C) scenario, though: as a result
- D) scenario: though, as a result

2. Jacob Thompson graduated from MIT before receiving a Master's in education from Columbia. Thompson had always been interested in the _____ and when he was commissioned by a venture firm from Palo Alto, California, to develop digital learning platforms, he leaped at the chance to combine his interests in his next start up.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) intersection of technology and education,
- B) intersection of technology and education
- C) intersection, of technology, and education,
- D) intersection, of technology, and education

3. Peruvian artist Jade Rivera, who was born in Huancaayo, Peru, in 1983, gained international acclaim for his murals and street _____ his use of pictorial realism and his empirical development, art critic James Hoffman has compared Rivera's worldwide recognition to that of Colombian artist Fernando Botero.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) graffiti. Commending
- B) graffiti commending
- C) graffiti, commending
- D) graffiti and commending

4. Only recently, scientists discovered that the Giant River Otter (*Pteronura brasiliensis*), an endangered species living in South America, is capable of hunting adult _____ a member of the subfamily Caimaninae, one of two primary lineages within the Alligatoridae family, the other being alligators.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) caiman an alligatorid being
- B) caiman, an alligatorid that is
- C) caiman; an alligatorid that is
- D) caiman and an alligatorid that is

5. In 1956, Althea Gibson became the first African American to win a Grand slam in tennis. Born to sharecroppers in the town of Silver, South Carolina, Gibson first began playing paddle tennis in the streets after moving to New York _____ three years of boxing, playing basketball, and running away from home, Althea took her first tennis lesson, which she detested at first, and the rest is history.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) City. After
- B) City after
- C) City, after
- D) City and after

6. While cold fusion became an incredibly popular theory in the early 1990s, _____ believed the results of their initial experiment could only be explained by a nuclear process, the reality was the electrochemists had been using a piece of faulty equipment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) and electrochemists
- B) electrochemists
- C) therefore, electrochemists
- D) even though electrochemists

7. Computer-aided design, more commonly known as CAD, is used for printing 3D models as well as designing pieces used in the construction of airplanes and many other commercially produced _____ to the development of SKETCHPAD, the first CAD system, changing a design required an engineer and a designer to hand draw a model, a process that could take days.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) objects and prior
- B) objects, prior
- C) objects prior
- D) objects. Prior

8. While the Amazon fascinates people passionate _____ that inhabit the region are some of the most beautiful and unique on the planet, the diseases and the bugs scare most from ever wanting to spend a night in the jungle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) about wildlife, the animals
- B) about wildlife, additionally, the animals
- C) about wildlife; the animals
- D) about wildlife, and the animals

9. The Watson-Crick model, proposed by James Watson and Francis Crick in 1953, revolutionized our understanding of DNA's structure, unraveling the double helix _____ it raised further questions about the mechanisms behind DNA replication and protein synthesis.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) molecule yet
- B) molecule, yet
- C) molecule, and while
- D) molecule,

10. The limericks of Oliver Wendell Holmes, which often deal with matters of theology and psychology, earned praise and laughter from many of his contemporary _____ them Henry Wadsworth Longfellow and James Russell Lowell, who both attended Harvard with Wendell Holmes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) poets. Among
- B) poets among
- C) poets; among
- D) poets, among

11. In the 1960s, an experiment about the psychology of pricing was conducted by Harvard professor Sharon Ramsey using chocolates. The number of chocolates that participants could pick from _____ some participants had 12 different options, others had 4 different options. The range of the prices stayed the same. Interestingly, the participants with fewer options consistently chose cheaper chocolates.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) varied;
- B) varied,
- C) varied; while
- D) varied while

12. *Astyanax mexicanus* is a fascinating fish since it comes in two forms: one with eyes and one without eyes. Although the two forms of the *Astyanax mexicanus*, also known as the Mexican Blind Cavefish or Blind Cave Tetra, look nearly _____ eyeless form has inhabited caves for centuries, and its eyes atrophied over generations.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) identical, and the
- B) identical that the
- C) identical, the
- D) identical the

13. Scottish artist Katie Paterson creates conceptual art projects that invite viewers to consider their relationship to nature. Paterson has long wanted to develop a project exploring the connection between writing and the natural _____ hired by a group from Oslo, Norway, to create a public art exhibit for the area around the city's harbor, she saw an opportunity to realize her vision.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) world, she was
- B) world, and she was
- C) world, and when she was
- D) world; she was

14. For Arctic foxes, the availability of small rodents and lemmings is crucial to their diet, but when the rodent population declines during cyclic fluctuations, the crafty foxes resort to opportunistic hunting, scavenging on bird eggs, carrion, and marine _____ their nutritional needs are met despite the variability of their primary food source.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) creatures, ensuring
- B) creatures, that ensure
- C) creatures, they ensure
- D) creatures they ensure

15. Typically, the previous owner of a piece of art has little to no determination on an artwork's _____ when the provenance demonstrates the prior owner was a celebrity, royalty or an esteemed art collector, the artwork's value can increase significantly.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) value
- B) value,
- C) value but
- D) value, but

16. Theodore Geisel is best known for his work writing and illustrating books under the pen name Dr. Seuss, but he also had a successful career in the advertising _____ more than 50 advertisements for Flit (a common bug spray at the time), Standard Oil, Ford Motor Company, and NBC Radio Network, he provided the same whimsical perspective and unique visuals to his advertisements that made his children's book so popular.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) business; he produced
- B) business. Producing
- C) business producing
- D) business, producing

17. In 2002, playwright Suzan-Lori Parks embarked on a mission to write one short play every day for an entire _____ the collection of 365 impeccably crafted pieces, each with its own distinctive characters, is a testament to artistic commitment.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) year, at the end of the year,
- B) year. At the end of the year,
- C) year at the end of the year,
- D) year. At the end, of the year

18. Continuous exposure to high-stress environments can affect the brain's amygdala and _____ people who have experienced prolonged periods of stress, the hypothalamus releases a consistent excess of corticotropin-releasing hormone, which signals the adrenal glands to release cortisol, making individuals feel consistently stressed and overwhelmed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) hypothalamus for
- B) hypothalamus, for
- C) hypothalamus; for
- D) hypothalamus and for

Chapters 5: Punctuation & Sentence Structure Problem Set

When taking the SAT, one of the most important skills is pattern spotting. **When looking at the question and differences in the answer choices, you should be able to recognize exactly what you are being tested on.** Simply recognizing, “okay, this is a punctuation question” is not good enough. Instead, you want to be able to identify exactly what the question is testing you on!

In this chapter, we have a mixed problem set that includes all the rules that we have learned so far in chapters 1-4. As you look at each question, try to identify exactly what you are being tested on and what rule(s) you should apply.

- The hanging plants, which were overflowing with _____ in the wind.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - flowers, swayed back, and forth
 - flowers, swayed back and forth
 - flowers, which swayed back and forth
 - flowers swayed back, and forth
- In the first ancient civilizations, it was much more difficult to move heavy rocks from place to _____ of the wheel quickly solved that problem.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - place; but the invention
 - place but the invention
 - place; the invention
 - place, however, the invention
- My neighbor Drew is certainly one of the most adventurous people that I have met. _____ one of his favorite hobbies.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - Spelunking, commonly known as caving, is
 - Spelunking, commonly known as caving, which is
 - Spelunking, commonly known as caving – is
 - Spelunking: commonly known as caving, is
- Most museums charge for _____ museums on the National Mall in Washington, D.C. are all free.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - admissions, however,
 - admissions; however
 - admissions; but
 - admissions, but
- In 1970, Conny Plank was a young sound engineer in Germany who was questioning whether he made the right career choice. Nevertheless, when he heard that world renowned composer Duke Ellington was rehearsing in _____ Conny immediately said yes when offered the chance to help record the session.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - Berlin, Germany
 - Berlin, Germany,
 - Berlin Germany
 - Berlin, Germany:
- To reach the peak, climbers need to _____ that end at the rock scrambling portion.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - utilize two of the three paths
 - utilize, two of the three, paths
 - utilize two, of the three, paths
 - utilize, two of the three paths

7. At the annual leadership _____ announced that she would be retiring next year.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) conference board member, Maria Gonzales,
- B) conference, board member Maria Gonzales
- C) conference, board member, Maria Gonzales,
- D) conference board member Maria Gonzales

8. Extreme patience and attention to detail are two important skills _____ or a botanist.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) necessary, for success as a watchmaker
- B) necessary for success as a watchmaker,
- C) necessary for success, as a watchmaker
- D) necessary for success as a watchmaker

9. Shigeru Ban is a Japanese architect known for his innovative work with recycled cardboard tubes. His most famous project is the Japanese pavilion building in Hanover, Germany, that _____ crisscrossing cardboard tubes and colored tiles create a geometric pattern.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) resembles a cylindrical checkerboard in,
- B) resembles a cylindrical checkerboard
- C) resembles: a cylindrical checkerboard
- D) resembles a cylindrical checkerboard:

10. After falling asleep in the _____ with a serious sunburn and some very funny tan lines.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sun, my younger sister Lydia woke up
- B) sun my younger sister Lydia woke up
- C) sun, my younger sister, Lydia, woke up
- D) sun, my younger sister, Lydia, woke up,

11. On September 25, 1890, President Benjamin Harrison signed legislation designating a portion of California as Sequoia National Park, _____ the regions giant Sequoia trees from logging.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) he protected
- B) protected
- C) has protected
- D) protecting

12. In 1946, Willard Libby proposed an innovative method for dating organic materials by measuring their content of a newly discovered radioactive isotope of carbon, _____ and won the Nobel Prize in Chemistry in 1960.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) carbon-14, (¹⁴C),
- B) carbon-14 (¹⁴C),
- C) carbon-14, (¹⁴C)
- D) carbon-14 (¹⁴C)

13. _____ Tamara's mom after finding out her daughter lied about her report card.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) "Tamara Angela Newton" screamed
- B) "Tamara Angela Newton," screamed
- C) "Tamara Angela Newton" screamed,
- D) "Tamara Angela Newton," screamed,

14. _____ 700 different types of eucalyptus trees, only 15 types are native to countries outside of Australia.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) There are over
- B) Arborists say there are
- C) There are upwards of
- D) Of the

15. The logging company chopped down the entire forest of pine _____ the trucks with over one million tons of wood.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) trees and loaded
- B) trees and loads
- C) trees, and loaded
- D) trees loading

16. The Richard C. Smith House is a small Usonian home designed by Frank Lloyd Wright and constructed in Jefferson, Wisconsin, _____ is one of Wright's diamond module homes, a form he used in the Patrick and Margaret Kinney House, the E. Clarke and Julia Arnold House, and a number of other homes he designed in the late 1940s and early 1950s.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) in 1950 and it
- B) in 1950; it
- C) in 1950 it
- D) in 1950, it

17. Chocolate-covered strawberries are a _____ summer treat.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sweetly, delicious
- B) sweet, and delicious
- C) sweet, deliciously
- D) sweet, delicious

18. Yara transformed the simple bowl of ramen by focusing on its most important _____ tare (the seasoning).

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) element, it's the
- B) element; the
- C) element: the
- D) element the

19. Gwen Ifill was a pioneer for African Americans in journalism. She became the first African American woman to host a political talk show on television in 1999. Ifill led the way for a new generation of journalists. CNN reporter Tanzina Vega _____ "a beacon for so many of us journalists, women of color especially."

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) says that Ifill was
- B) says, that Ifill was:
- C) says, that Ifill was,
- D) says that, Ifill was:

20. Sigmund Freud's psychoanalytic theory, developed in the late 19th century, provided groundbreaking insights into the unconscious mind and human _____ it neglected the influence of societal factors and cultural differences on psychological development.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) behavior, however
- B) behavior
- C) behavior, but
- D) behavior but

21. Due to increasing environmental concerns, material scientist Teng Li, keystone professor of mechanical engineering at the University of Maryland in College Park, manufactured _____ chemically treated wood that dissolves away the lignin in the wood, which is then soft and can be easily molded and pressed into a desired shape so that it can be used in place of metals.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) "super wood—" a
- B) "super wood;" a
- C) "super wood." A
- D) "super wood," this is a

22. The first team to decipher all the clues and find its treasure wins \$1,000. Each _____ own unique spot.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) groups' treasure is hidden in it's
- B) groups treasure is hidden in its
- C) group's treasure is hidden in it's
- D) group's treasure is hidden in its

23. Arborist James Altucher argues that the _____ are outweighed by their fire risk.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) benefits of eucalyptus trees to the animals
- B) benefits, of eucalyptus trees, to the animals
- C) benefits – of eucalyptus trees – to the animals
- D) benefits of eucalyptus trees, to the animals

24. The first time you lay eyes on the _____ you are shocked that someone actually lives inside.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) famous "boat houses"
- B) famous "boat, houses"
- C) famous "boat houses,"
- D) famous, "boat houses"

25. During her _____ Marsha discovered a direct correlation between water pollution and the presence of invasive species in the Sydney Harbor.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) extensive, field, research
- B) extensive field research
- C) extensive, field research,
- D) extensive field research,

26. John's business consultant estimates that identifying inefficiencies in the production line, such as outdated machines and inadequately trained workers, for example, should increase the business' profit by hundreds of thousands of dollars in the next three _____ more than the \$15,000 the consultant cost.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) years. Significantly
- B) years; significantly
- C) years – significantly
- D) years, this is significantly

27. Most of the American population does not drink the recommended amount of water each _____ when participants in a study were given smart water bottles that tracked their intake, over 75% of the participants were able to consume at least the recommend quantity of water.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) day
- B) day,
- C) day, but
- D) day but

28. Across Earth's biomes, there are five types of deserts—subtropical, coastal, rain shadow, interior, and polar. The Sahara Desert in northern Africa is a subtropical _____ it is third largest desert in the world and makes up approximately 25% of Africa.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) desert, for example,
- B) desert: for example,
- C) desert, for example;
- D) desert, for example

29. Even though consumers of solar-power systems may prioritize saving money over helping the environment, developments in the solar-power industry ensure that both occur. Consumers are not the only one for whom solar power is a win-win _____ of their own efforts, industry employees help provide a more environmentally friendly service while also making a good living for themselves.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) scenario, though, as a result,
- B) scenario, though: as a result,
- C) scenario, though: as a result
- D) scenario: though, as a result

30. One of the most important steps to complete after water damage is to _____ wiring since it poses a serious fire risk.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) identify moldy, damaged
- B) identify, moldy, damaged
- C) identify moldy damaged
- D) identify, moldy damaged,

31. Acclaimed science fiction author Isaac Asimov's impressive body of work comprises *Foundation*, an epic series that charts the rise and fall of civilizations in a futuristic _____ a collection of groundbreaking short stories exploring the ethical complexities of artificial intelligence; and "The Caves of Steel," a riveting detective novel that seamlessly blends human drama with the intricacies of futuristic urban life.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) galaxy; *I Robot*,
- B) galaxy; *I Robot*:
- C) galaxy, *I Robot*,
- D) galaxy, *I Robot*:

32. While James loves making his own puff pastry, the head chef told him it was too _____ and to instead purchase puff pastry dough from the local bakery.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) expensive, laborious, and time-intensive
- B) expensive, laborious, and time intensive,
- C) expensive, laborious and time intensive,
- D) expensive laborious and time intensive

33. In the 1990s, _____ the effects of cognitive dissonance, a mental conflict that occurs when ones beliefs do not align with ones actions.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Professor Wu's study on
- B) while Professor Wu studied
- C) Professor Wu to study
- D) Professor Wu studied

34. Many cured _____ became very popular breakfast staples in the 1980s.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) meats, like scrapple, Canadian bacon, and smoked salmon,
- B) meats, like scrapple, Canadian bacon, and smoked salmon
- C) meats like scrapple, Canadian bacon and smoked salmon,
- D) meats – like scrapple Canadian bacon, and smoked salmon –

35. Korean-American _____ is known for his rule-breaking ways and has some of the most creative dishes in New York City.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) chef, David Chang,
- B) chef David Chang,
- C) chef David Chang
- D) chef, David Chang

36. Astronomers have long suspected that there was water on Mars at some point in time. Recent surveying from Nasa's Curiosity rover suggests that although rippled rocks indicate the presence of liquid on Mars billions of years _____ on the surface that darken during the warm seasons and fade during the cool season indicate the presence of water on Mars currently.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) ago, streaks
- B) ago, but streaks
- C) ago; streaks
- D) ago streaks

37. The _____ impressed with one Chinese chef's rendition of blood sausage (a northeast Chinese specialty), claim its the most delicious smoked meat they had ever eaten.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) judges, immensely
- B) judges were immensely
- C) judges who were immensely
- D) judges had been

38. Due to the length of time required, 400 days to be _____ is one of the most expensive cured meats.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) exact, Prosciutto Di Parma, once finished
- B) exact Prosciutto Di Parma once finished
- C) exact Prosciutto Di Parma, once finished,
- D) exact, Prosciutto Di Parma, once finished,

39. Taylor _____ in the 1860s so the Continental Army could carry a protein without the meat spoiling, grew in popularity in New Jersey and now has a cult-like following.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) ham invented
- B) ham was invented
- C) ham, inventing
- D) ham, invented

40. While one requires oxygen and one does not, aerobic and anaerobic respiration are both forms of cellular _____ they are processes by which cells break down glucose into a usable form of energy.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) respiration – that is,
- B) respiration and
- C) respiration,
- D) respiration, additionally,

41. Aerospace engineer Katherine Lynde is developing propulsion systems at NASA that could potentially allow spacecraft to travel faster and further than current propulsion methods permit. Johnson also prioritizes her role as a _____ proving that reaching for the stars in her professional career is compatible with nurturing a family.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) parent, however;
- B) parent; however,
- C) parent, however,
- D) parent however,

42. Lignan style paintings typically include translucent washes of color, often in shades of green and white, and indicate movement with _____ brushstrokes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) flowing, rather than rigid
- B) flowing, rather than rigid,
- C) flowing; rather than rigid
- D) flowing rather than rigid,

43. In its biflagellate form, *N. fowleri* has multiple whiplike appendages called flagella. Propelled by these flagellum, *N. fowleri* swim through water in a helical, or spiral-like, forward _____ researchers at the University of Oxford discovered that they also swim in polygonal patterns.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) motion, recently; though
- B) motion; recently, though,
- C) motion, recently though,
- D) motion, recently though

44. Many food critics were anxiously waiting their turn to judge the new _____ for themselves.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) chefs menus merits
- B) chef's menus merits
- C) chef's menu's merit
- D) chefs' menus merits

45. New York City residents consider pigeons as little more _____ many days in Central Park by trying to steal snacks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than, "rats with wings" and they ruin
- B) than, "rats with wings," ruining
- C) than "rats with wings," ruining
- D) than "rats with wings." Ruining

46. Because of their potential for more frequent, specific _____ many employers, such as Zappos, have instituted peer-to-peer employee recognition programs that help teams develop richer, more meaningful connections.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) recognition, so
- B) recognition:
- C) recognition, accordingly
- D) recognition,

47. Materials engineer Jason Lowder invented a technique to increase the hardness of aluminum alloys by infusing them with carbon _____ the new alloy's Vickers hardness number (HV) rose from 250 HV to over 400 HV.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) nanotubes; through this modification,
- B) nanotubes through this modification
- C) nanotubes, through this modification;
- D) nanotubes, through this modification,

48. Breeding of golden retrievers with poodles was done for cosmetic reasons, but it also had an unintended side _____ in inherited health issues.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) effect a reduction
- B) effect. A reduction
- C) effect; a reduction
- D) effect – a reduction

Chapter 6: Verbs

Verbs questions test you on two major topics – subject-verb agreement and verb tense. The subject-verb agreement questions are trickier, as at times it can be difficult to find the subject and “hear” which verb is correct. We will learn a few methods in this chapter to correctly answer these questions. For the verb tense questions, the approach is much more straightforward: read for context and go with the answer that sounds correct.

Subject-Verb Agreement

Whenever you see a verbs question on the SAT, **your first job is to find the subject**. The subject, which is the person, place, or thing doing the action, is usually at the beginning of the sentence.

The subject of the sentence must agree with the verb. In other words, if the subject is singular, the verb must be singular, and if the subject is plural, the verb must be plural. In simple sentences when the subject and verbs are right next to each other, it will be easy to select the right verb:

Cats (loves/love) to sit in empty boxes.

My dog (barks/bark) at the mailman every day.

Easy right? Unfortunately, verbs questions will not be this easy on test day. The SAT increases the difficulty by putting distance between the subject and the verb. The farther away the subject is from the verb, the more likely we are to say the verb incorrectly. Remember, **what sounds right is not always right. You cannot trust your ear on subject-verb agreement.**

There are 3 main ways the SAT tries to trick you on subject-verb agreement:

1. Unnecessary information phrases between the subject and verb.

Unnecessary information phrases never contain the subject. Cross out any unnecessary information phrases to find the subject.

Tortoises, known to live to over 150 years old, (is/are) sold at the local pet shop.

The committee, composed of two former CEOs, one politician, three lawyers, and two doctors, (vote/votes) to delay the release of the new product until next quarter.

2. Prepositional phrases between the subject and verb (most common).

Prepositional phrases never contain the subject or the verb. Cross out prepositional phrases to find the subject.

The entire group of students (is/are) organizing a bake sale to raise money.

The pod of dolphins (hunts/hunt) as a team.

3. Group nouns that sound plural but are singular.

Group nouns (class, committee, team) are singular even though the group consists of more than one person/thing.

The sheep herd (waits/wait) to be sheared.

The jury (agrees/agree) that the defendant deserves to be put in jail.

TIP – Read the Subject and Verbs Side-by-side

Once you find the subject and verb, read them next to each other and ignore the information in between. This will help you more easily find which one is correct.

A large percentage of the voters, many of whom are under the age of 30, (prefer/prefers) the new housing proposal.

Cross out any unnecessary information and prepositional phrases.

A large percentage ~~of the voters, many of whom are under the age of 30,~~ (prefer/prefers) the new housing proposal.

The subject is “percentage.” Put the subject and verb next to each other and ignore the rest of the sentence.

Correct: A percentage **prefers** the new housing proposal.

Practice:

1. The entire class of first graders (cheer/cheers) when the ice cream truck arrives.
2. The proposal for planting a new grove of orange trees (requires/require) an approval of 80% to pass.
3. With the budget finally approved, the new system for payroll, scheduling, and human resources that took three years to build (is/are) finally going live next month.

The “Plug-In” Trick

Sometimes, it is be difficult to “hear” which verb correctly matches with the subject. **For singular words, plug in “he,” “she,” or “it” for the subject, and for plural words plug in “they” for the subject.** With this trick, you will be able to easily hear which verb properly agrees with the subject.

The exact time for the meeting with the softball coach and location for the showcase (has/have) not been finalized.

If we read the sentence as is, it is difficult to tell which verb fits. After crossing out the prepositional phrases, the sentence looks like this:

The exact time ~~for the meeting with the softball coach~~ and location ~~for the showcase~~ (has/have) not been finalized.

The subjects are “time” and “location,” so the subject is plural. Replace the subjects with “they.”

They (has/have) not been finalized.

Now it’s easy...you can tell that “have” is correct.

Try this tip with these examples below:

Each of the runners who complete the marathon (wins/win) a medal.

The complex designs and intricate needlework (makes/make) Julia’s carpets the most popular in the entire art market.

Subject(s) After the Verb (Advanced Topic)

As we have seen so far, the subject(s) usually appear near the front of the sentence and before the verb. However, there are a few tricky cases when the subject(s) come after the verb. **If a sentence starts with the word “there” or “here,” the subject(s) comes after the verb.** Also, **if a sentence begins with a word that ends in “ing” or “ed,” the subject(s) come after the verb.**

There (is/are) one proven method for making a perfectly poached egg.

Here (is/are) the buckets that are filled with the dog’s toys and bones.

Tucked away in Jimmy’s wallet (was/were) a photograph of his son and a gift card.

Running across the street (was/were) a mother duck and seven ducklings.

As you just learned from these examples, you cannot trust your ear! We say these incorrectly all the time, so you need to make sure that you find the subject(s) before selecting the verb.

*There is one exception to the rule. A word ending in “ing” can be the subject of the sentence if it is used as a noun.

Running is one of my favorite types of exercise. Swimming is my least favorite.

In the sentences above, “running” and “swimming” are used as nouns and are the subjects.

Hidden Subjects (Advanced Topic)

For other advanced subject-verb agreement questions, the sentence can have multiple subjects and multiple verbs. For hidden subject questions, you have to identify the correct subject to match with the verb. There are 4 common ways the SAT tests you on hidden subjects:

1. **“Which” phrases:** A “which” phrase in the middle or end of a sentence can include a verb that refers to a word other than the subject of the sentence.

The company decreased the number of employees with three rounds of layoffs, which (was/were) not announced publicly until this week.

2. **“That” phrases:** A “that” phrase in the middle or end of a sentence often includes its own subject and verb.

The teachers are unaware that the student (refuse/refuses) to complete homework assignments over the weekend.

3. **Commas + FANBOYS:** A comma + FANBOYS joins 2 independent clauses, so there are 2 sets of subjects and verbs (1 for each sentence).

Lions and tigers are often believed to live in the same country, but the lion, which can weigh up to 500 pounds, (live/lives) in Africa while the tiger, which can weigh over 600 pounds, is found in habitats across Southeast Asia, China, and Eastern Russia.

4. **Dependent, Independent:** A sentence with the Dependent, Independent structure has 2 sets of subjects and verbs. The first subject-verb pair is in the dependent clause, and the second subject-verb pair is in the independent clause.

While the cutting boards at the farmer’s market with a blue sticker (is/are) on sale, the one with a white sticker has already been sold.

Subject-Verb Agreement Practice:

1. The stable hand hired by the farm owners (groom/grooms) the horses every morning.
2. Both of the apartments (is/are) never vacant during the summer.
3. Ned, the winner of the gold medal in the 200-meter breaststroke, and Claire, the bronze medal winner of the 1000-meter freestyle, (was/were) featured on the cover of the swimming magazine.
4. Gold coins and silver bars, all once thought to be lost forever, (was/were) found in the sunken pirate ship.
5. The espresso beans that we purchased online with a 10% discount code (is/are) great for making soymilk lattes, but the deluxe vanilla powder (overpower/overpowers) the rest of the drink.
6. Each of the girl scouts (sells/sell) delicious Thin Mint cookies that my brother and mother (claims is/claim are) best when frozen.
7. After the new fast chargers were installed, there finally (was/were) two locations to charge my electric car within five miles of my house.
8. The cast of the award-winning show (takes/take) a bow after the show ends.
9. Killer whales, which are the top predators in the ocean, (have/has) been documented hunting great white sharks.
10. The overall rating from the reviewers of the new restaurant, which (is/are) scored on categories including the food quality and the ambiance, (is/are) worse than before the renovation and reopening.
11. To help raise money to save the farm, Janet donates her old clothes, Mike organizes a bake sale, and Chloe and Bill (has/have) a yard sale.
12. One of the recipes for chocolate chip cookies in the cookbooks (call/calls) for brown sugar.
13. Flamingos, famous for their bright pink feathers, actually (get/gets) their color from a diet that (consist/consists) of shrimp and algae.
14. Dropping out of the race due to cramps that (was starting/were starting) to get worse (was/were) two of the favorites.
15. The entire group of seagulls (is/are) following the child and his brother who (keep/keeps) dropping their french fries.
16. One of the symptoms (make/makes) Dr. Smith think that Andy just has the common cold.
17. Freediving, a very unique and uncommon sport, (require/requires) divers to hold their breath for long periods of time.
18. With the current high interest rates, there (is/are) no feasible ways for someone with my salary to become a homeowner in this city.

Verb Tense

For questions on verb tense, trust your ear. If you are a native English speaker, **you will know what sounds right or wrong in the sentence as long as you read for context**. To find which tense is correct, **read the previous sentence(s) and look for other verbs**. Make sure to match the tense in the rest of the paragraph.

On the SAT, do not pick a complicated tense (has run, had ran, had been running, would have run, etc.) when a simple tense works.

Last year, Margot (designs/designed/will design) a new line of summer dresses.

Before he votes tomorrow, Dale (researches/research/will research) each candidate's positions on the major issues.

The referee stopped the fight after the boxers (refuses/refused/will refuse) to follow the rules.

In English, we use the perfect tense when there are multiple timelines in a sentence. The perfect tense is when you say "has" or "have" or "had" with the verb. If you read for context and read the entire sentence, you should be able to just "hear" when you need to use the perfect tense.

Many surfers enjoy paddling out, but few (rode/have ridden) waves over ten feet tall.

While the group of entrepreneurs claimed to all be successful, only a few (will start/have started) their own businesses.

The bison (ate/had been eating) when the lions began their attack.

By the beginning of next year, the doctors (finish/finished/will have finished) their preliminary research on lung cancer.

The conditional tense describes what would or could happen in the future. The kind of verb conjugation that we need depends on how likely the outcome is to actually happen (probable, improbable, impossible). Again, the key here is to trust your ear and go with what sounds right to you.

If I make the free throw, we (will win/would win/would have won) the game.

If I made the free throw, we (will win/would win/would have won) the game.

If I had made the free throw, we (will win/would win/would have won) the game.

The SAT may also test you on irregular verbs. For these verbs, just trust your gut and go with what sounds correct to you.

Before the show (began/begun), the lights were dimmed.

The deliveryman had (rang/rung) the doorbell before dropping off the package.

By the time the meal was over, the boy had (ate/eaten) an entire bag of popcorn and had (drank/drank) a liter of cola.

TIP – Irregular Verbs – “a” vs. “u” versions

For many of the most difficult irregular verbs, there is an “a” version (ex: swam) and a “u” version (ex: swum). We use these verbs incorrectly all of the time, so using your ear and trying to hear which one sounds correct is difficult. All you need to do is remember the simple rules below:

With “has”, “have” or “had” → Use the “u” version (perfect tense)

Correct: Before you arrived, I had swum some laps.

With no “has”, “have” or “had” → Use the “a” version (past tense)

Correct: I swam some laps this morning.

The most commonly tested irregular verbs following this pattern are below.

<u>Verb</u>	<u>Past Tense</u>	<u>Past Perfect Tense</u>
begin	began	has/have/had begun
drink	drank	has/have/had drunk
sink	sank	has/have/had sunk
swim	swam	has/have/had swum
run	ran	has/have/had run
sing	sang	has/have/had sung

Verb Tense Practice:

1. The car accident on the freeway delayed my commute and (causes/caused) me to be late for the job interview.
2. After playing basketball for two hours, Jimmy (devours/devoured) a carnitas burrito and two fish tacos.
3. It is impossible to believe that Andrew (tells/told) his parents what really happened.
4. Before I woke up, Chris had already (swam/swum) twenty laps.
5. If you had ordered the tickets last week, they (would arrive/would have arrived) by now.
6. The sign asked that you (be/are) polite to the waiters and tip well.
7. The dance competition (began/begins) at 10am, and the awards ceremony then starts at 4pm.
8. If I finish all of my homework, I (will get/get/would get) to go to the new Star Wars movie.
9. The local pizza parlor (closes/closed) its doors for good last year.
10. Mary went to the mall and (buys/bought/buyed) a new outfit for her graduation party.
11. The ship had already been (sank/sunk) before the battle was finished.
12. If the rebels had won the war, the world would (of/have) been a very different place.

TIP – How to Spot Subject-Verb Agreement vs. Verb Tense Questions

Spotting verbs questions in general is easy: the answer choices will have different forms of the same verb. Knowing you are dealing with a verbs question is a good start, but to answer the question correctly, you need to know if you are being tested on subject-verb agreement or verb tense.

Subject-verb agreement questions always have one defining characteristic:

- 1. Verbs in the answer choices have singular and plural versions of the same verb in the same tense. Look for “is” vs. “are,” “has” vs. “have,” “was” vs. “were,” and any other verbs with a singular, like “runs” vs. a plural, like “run.”** Anytime you see verbs that have singular and plural versions in the answer choices, the question is testing you on subject-verb agreement!

The addition of solar panels to the roof of a house in Nevada _____ the house on average 20% more energy efficient.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) make
- B) makes
- C) have made
- D) were making

In this example, B is correct because the subject “addition” is singular. The only verb that matches with “addition” is “makes.” Even though there are different tenses in the answer choices, we only need to use subject-verb agreement to find the correct answer.

Verb tense questions will always have one defining characteristic:

- 1. Verbs in the answer choices are in different tenses.** For example, if “requires,” “required,” and “will require” are in the answer choices, the question is testing you on tense.

The girl scouts are hosting a bake sale tomorrow to raise money. To get ready, Adya _____ to bake two trays of blondies and a box of donut holes.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would need
- B) was needing
- C) needed
- D) needs

In this example, D is correct because the verb must be present tense. In the previous sentence, the verb “are” is present tense, so we know this sentence should also be in present tense. Answer choices A, B, and C are in the wrong tense.

“Odd One Out” Trick

For subject-verb questions, the answer choices most commonly have 1 answer choice that is singular and 3 that are plural or 1 answer choice that is plural and 3 that are singular. Whenever you spot this pattern, **the “odd one out” (the 1 answer choice that is singular or plural) is almost always correct.**

To show you how this works, let’s revisit the sentence we just covered.

The addition of solar panels to the roof of a house in Nevada _____ the house on average 20% more energy efficient.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) make → plural
- B) makes → singular (odd one out)
- C) have made → plural
- D) were making → plural

In this example, we have one singular verb and 3 plural verbs. The one singular verb, the odd one out, is the correct answer. Next, let’s look at an example with one plural verb and 3 singular verbs.

The 15% increase in Spotify advertisements that the new sales teams _____ to launch this week is projected to have a 7% decrease in customer satisfaction ratings.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has planned → singular
- B) plans → singular
- C) are planning → plural (odd one out)
- D) is planning → singular

Here, we have one plural verb and 3 singular verbs. The one plural verb, the odd one out, is the correct answer.

While the “odd one out” trick almost always works, we recommend that you still try to find the subject(s) to make sure you answer the question correctly. However, finding the subject can be hard for many students, so if you struggle to find the subject or are unsure of what the subject is on a challenging subject-verb agreement question, use the “odd one out” trick!

***Important Note:** We can only use the “odd one out” trick when the answer choices have 3 singular verbs and 1 plural verb or 3 plural verbs and 1 singular verbs. If the answer choices may have 2 singular verbs and 2 plural verbs in different tenses, we cannot use the “odd one out” trick. When you see answer choices with 2 singular verbs and 2 plural verbs in different tenses, the question is testing you on both tense and subject-verb agreement; you will need to apply both the subject-verb agreement rules and tense rules we have learned in this chapter.

Chapter 6 Practice:

1. In-n-Out, known for its animal style burgers, and _____ the annual list of best burgers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Five Guys always tops
- B) Five Guys, always topping
- C) Five Guys always top
- D) Five Guys, always top

2. The first row of the townhouses for sale in my _____ the best view of the beach.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) neighborhood has
- B) neighborhood, having
- C) neighborhood have
- D) neighborhood would have

3. Astrophysicist Aarav Singh, working at the European Southern Observatory, _____ images of distant galaxies when he uncovered something unexpected: the orbit of a large groups of stars that hinted at the existence of a previously undetected black hole.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reviews
- B) was reviewing
- C) will review
- D) has been reviewing

4. The treehouse construction is almost completed. Anna _____ two more pieces of plywood and a few more screws.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would just need
- B) just needed
- C) just needs
- D) is in needing of just

5. As part of an effort to increase the average spend of each tourist, the Bethany Beach community board is organizing nightly shows on Thursdays and Fridays during the summer. The most popular so far has been the magic show, which is an action-packed show featuring many animals. In last night's show, _____ one rabbit, two ducks, and ten doves.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) there was
- B) there are
- C) there were
- D) there is

6. Dr. Ben Augustus is a world-renowned expert on the use of artificial intelligence in education. Dr. Augustus _____ that artificial intelligence, given its exceptional advances over the past decade, will likely eventually be utilized in classrooms to provide a more personalized curriculum to students.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) foresees
- B) is foreseeing
- C) had foreseen
- D) could be foreseeing

7. Loïs Maloui Jones painting *Dahomey* is a product of Sudanese, Keyan, and Senegalese influences. The influences are represented in different sections of the painting by stylized animals, zigzagging lines, and rich colors. The sections are separated by the zigzagging yellow lines, and the animals _____ decorated with geometric designs.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had been
- B) were
- C) are
- D) would be

8. The list of upgrades that the school board promised, new chalkboards, a new swimming pool, and a renovated teacher's _____ over the summer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) lounge, were completed
- B) lounge, was completed
- C) lounge were completed
- D) lounge was completed

9. While Olivia was excited for Frederick's promotion, she had mixed feelings: the great weather in California certainly beats the cold Minnesota winters, but packing up the entire house and moving across the _____ such a hassle.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) country are
- B) country, are
- C) country is
- D) country, is

10. The innovative team at Apple, the company that revolutionized the way that we listen to _____ to release their newest device next month.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) music, are planning
- B) music, is planning
- C) music, planned
- D) music are planning

11. The entire flock of _____ at the pond in my backyard during their migration south.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) geese, usually well over 100 birds, stop
- B) geese, usually well over 100 birds, stops
- C) geese, usually well over 100 birds stop
- D) geese, usually well over 100 birds stopping

12. Before penning *The Enchanted Garden* (2022), author Emily Turner found inspiration in her own childhood adventures. Although her latest novel marked her tenth publication, her storytelling talent _____ recognized early on. As a precocious writer, she won her first poetry competition at the tender age of nine.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) were
- C) was
- D) have been

13. Chanel, Shiovan, and Earl were frustrated with Thomas's constant procrastination. If Thomas _____ with the project already.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would have finished his part by now, we would of been done
- B) finishes his part by now, we would be done
- C) had finished his part by now, we would have been done
- D) finished his part by now, would be done

14. Edward R. Murrow was an American broadcast journalist and war correspondent for CBS during World War II. Sharing the first-hand accounts and reflections of not only American soldiers but also their families _____ of particular importance to Murrow.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) are
- B) were
- C) have been
- D) was

15. Although foxes prefer high-calorie, fatty foods, the prey animals they pursue have developed strategies to minimize their fat content. A recent research study _____ why: fat storage is energetically costly for prey species, and it is evolutionarily advantageous for them to maintain lower fat levels to increase their chances of survival against predation by foxes."

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) explains
- B) to explain
- C) explaining
- D) having explained

16. The pictures on the mantelpiece contain the only photo from the holidays that _____ the entire family together.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) show
- B) showed
- C) had shown
- D) shows

17. Onion bagels and chive cream cheese, often served together on a breakfast sandwich called _____ part of the daily specials at the Beachside Diner.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) "Chonion," is
- B) "Chonion" is
- C) "Chonion," are
- D) "Chonion" are

18. Before starting the 100-mile bike _____ over twenty miles.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) ride, the triathlon participants already running
- B) ride, the triathlon participants had already ran
- C) ride, the triathlon participants had already run
- D) ride, the triathlon participants already run

19. In 1816, Britain gave "asylum" to many of the Parthenon's beautiful marble sculptures that were being sold to wealthy tourists. Officials from the British Museum, where the sculptures are housed, have maintained that the expertise of their curators _____ the marble sculptures from ending up damaged like many of those that were not brought to Britain.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) were protecting
- B) have protected
- C) are protecting
- D) has protected

20. Conny Plank was a highly influential German record producer and sound engineer, renowned for his pioneering work in experimental music during the 1970s and 1980s and his work with Duke Ellington. The recording with Ellington – which was lost for over 30 years, discovered when his son found them, and released in 2015 – _____ of Plank's prowess as a producer.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) are proof
- B) have been proof
- C) is proof
- D) were proof

21. Playing poker with Grandpa is always an adventure. His weathered hands shuffle the cards with a rhythm that speaks of years spent mastering the game. _____ with us, nobody can tell when he is bluffing or when he is telling the truth.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) When my grandfather played poker
- B) When my grandfather plays poker
- C) Having played poker
- D) When my grandfather was playing poker,

22. To survive dry spells of the savanna, spadefoot toad tadpoles _____ their development. This rapid development allows them to reach maturity before their temporary ponds evaporate, outpacing the developmental timeline of other amphibian species.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had accelerated
- B) accelerate
- C) to accelerate
- D) accelerating

23. Photosynthesis, the process by which plants turn sunlight into energy, and cellular respiration, the process by which humans turn sugars into usable energy, _____ to the 8th grade class.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has continued to be confusing
- B) was confusing
- C) would of been confusing
- D) were confusing

24. In order to cook a perfect steak, harmony of temperature and time _____ necessary to master. Timing becomes an art: a dance between heat and readiness. Patience is also key as the steak rests at room temperature, allowing its fibers to relax.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) are
- B) have been
- C) were
- D) is

25. While there are many crucial elements to running a successful business – proper management, effective marketing, and a well-crafted product – the passion and drive of the CEO _____ the most important.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) is
- B) was
- C) has been
- D) are

26. Crafted through the delicate alchemy of sweetened tea and a living SCOBY, kombucha has been enjoyed across continents and cultures. The tangy, fizzy concoction holds within it the wisdom of generations. Incredibly, as one of my food scientist colleagues _____, kombucha has been brewed for thousands of years, a testament to its enduring popularity and healthful properties.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) mentions
- B) mention
- C) have mentioned
- D) are mentioning

27. While communities near nuclear power plants often worry about the effects of nuclear radiation, the encapsulation of the radioactive materials _____ the surrounding area safe.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) make
- B) have made
- C) are making
- D) makes

28. Of the estimated 7,000 spoken languages in the world, linguists say nearly half are likely to disappear in this century. In fact, they _____ out of use at a rate of about one every two weeks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) fell
- B) would of fallen
- C) are falling
- D) had fallen

29. Government officials in Nepal have maintained that the expertise of the Sherpas _____ many hikers from serious injuries or worse on Mount Everest.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) has protected
- B) have protected
- C) are protecting
- D) were protecting

30. Volkov Prirochki is an architect from Moldova. Prirochki's Prague School of Management in Kutna Hora in the Czech Republic features a two story, 150-meter-wide circular base, on top of which _____ four differently sized rectangular prisms tiled in uneven herringbone patterns of transparent and colored glass panels.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) there is
- B) is placed
- C) is
- D) are

31. Though many features of the film (such as the color grading) _____ the viewer's experience, the audio is a bit choppy, which makes the film painful to watch from beginning to end.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) enhances
- B) has enhanced
- C) was enhancing
- D) enhance

Chapter 7: Pronouns

Pronouns are words that stand in for a person, place, or thing. On the SAT, you need to know how to select the proper pronoun based on case (“he” vs. “him” or “who” vs. “whom”), make sure that a pronoun agrees with the word it is replacing, and spot and fix ambiguous pronouns.

Pronoun Case

To get started, let’s work on pronoun case. Pronouns have two cases: subject and object. The pronoun’s role in the sentence (subject or object) dictates which type of pronoun will be correct.

Subject	
Singular	Plural
I	We
You	You
He/She/It	They
Who	Who

Object	
Singular	Plural
Me	Us
You	You
Him/Her/It	Them
Whom	Whom

For simple pronoun case questions, it is easy to tell which pronoun is correct. Just trust your ear!

(They/them) went to the street festival on Saturday afternoon.

The man handed (we/us) a stack of flyers.

One type of more advanced pronouns question occurs when the pronoun in a list. Since we often say these incorrectly, you may no longer be able to simply “hear” which pronoun is correct. For a pronoun in a list, **ignore the other items in the list and just read the pronoun to tell which is correct.**

The policeman asked to speak to my friends and (me/I).

My friends and (me/I) went to the hockey game.

The entire gang and (they/them) are responsible for this.

At times, pronouns can also be included in a prepositional phrase. **Pronouns in prepositional phrases always are in the object case.** Remember this rule, as it can be difficult to tell which one is correct by just using your ear.

The bet between Joe and (I/me) was for just five dollars.

To (who/whom) was the award given to?

Jerry claims that a great rivalry exists among Tim, Scott, and (he/him).

Who vs. Whom

You need to know the difference between “who” and “whom.” Technically, “who” is the subject of the sentence, and “whom” is the object. But knowing that is not very helpful. Here’s the trick you need to memorize:

If you can replace the word with “he,” “she,” or “they,” use “who.”

If you can replace the word with “him,” “her,” or “them,” use “whom.”

You may need to rearrange the sentence a bit, but this trick will work for any who vs. whom question.

Try with the examples below:

(Who/whom) stole the apple off the teacher's desk?

To (who/whom) should I address this letter?

(Who/whom) do you want to win the Bachelor?

TIP - Who vs. Whom in Phrases

On more difficult questions, who/whom can also be used to introduce a phrase describing a person. Using our normal "he/him" trick does not work if we look at the entire sentence. However, if we just look at the phrase on its own, then the trick still works.

The child (who/whom) I invited to the party was very noisy.

The child (who/whom) was running down the street was very noisy.

If we plug in "he" or "him" to the entire sentence, neither sounds correct. **To tell if it is "who" or "whom," only look at the phrase**, which is in the brackets below.

The child [(who/whom) I invited to the party] was very noisy.

The child [(who/whom) was running down the street] was very noisy.

If we just look at the phrase, can we say, "he I invited to the party?" No, but we could say, "I invited him to the party," so the first one must be "whom." If we look at the second example, you can say, "he was running down the street," so "who" is correct.

The Next Word(s) Trick for Who vs. Whom

The second trick involves looking at the next word(s) after "who" or "whom." **If the word(s) right after is a verb, use "who." If the word(s) right after is a noun, use "whom."** In the first example, "I" is a noun, so we use "whom." In the second example, "was" is a verb, so we use "who."

1. On my way to the farmer's market, I ran into my childhood best friend, (who/whom) I had not seen in years.
2. I could not believe how much the florists (who/whom) opened up a shop down the street charge for their roses.
3. After the investigation, the owner fired the employee (who/whom) the private investigator identified as the one responsible for stealing over \$5,000 of company funds.

Phrases with "Who" or "Whom"

When talking about a person, we must always use "who" or "whom" to start the phrase. We can never use "that" to describe a person. "Who" or "whom" can act like a "that" or a "which" phrase, so we can use "who" and "whom" with no commas (like a "that" phrase) if the information is necessary and with commas (like a "which" phrase) if the information is unnecessary.

Incorrect: The children that were playing soccer did not notice the ice cream truck.

Correct: The children who were playing soccer did not notice the ice cream truck.

Incorrect: Dr. Roberts, which was my childhood doctor, waved to me at the supermarket.

Correct: Dr. Roberts, who was my childhood doctor, waved to me at the supermarket.

TIP – Reflexive Pronouns

Reflexive pronouns, which use the “-self” ending (myself, yourself, himself...), can only be used when the pronoun is referring back to a person earlier in the sentence.

Correct: I grabbed three donuts and put them in a box for myself.

Correct: I asked my coworker to put three donuts in a box for me.

Possessive Pronouns

Possessive pronouns are used to show possession. These pronouns must match with the word(s) that are being replaced (we will cover this more on Pronouns Agreement).

Possessive Nouns	
Singular	Plural
Mine	Ours
Yours	Yours
His/Hers/Its	Theirs

Possessive Adjectives	
Singular	Plural
My	Our
Your	Your
His/Her/Its	Their

Incorrect: The entire team went on stage to pick up their trophy.

Correct: The entire team went on stage to pick up its trophy.

The pronoun here is referring back to “team,” which is singular. In order to match correctly, we must use the singular pronoun “its.” Try with the examples below:

Emmanuel and James came back home after forgetting (his/their) phones.

Thousands of tourists travel to Egypt each year to see (its/their) ancient pyramids.

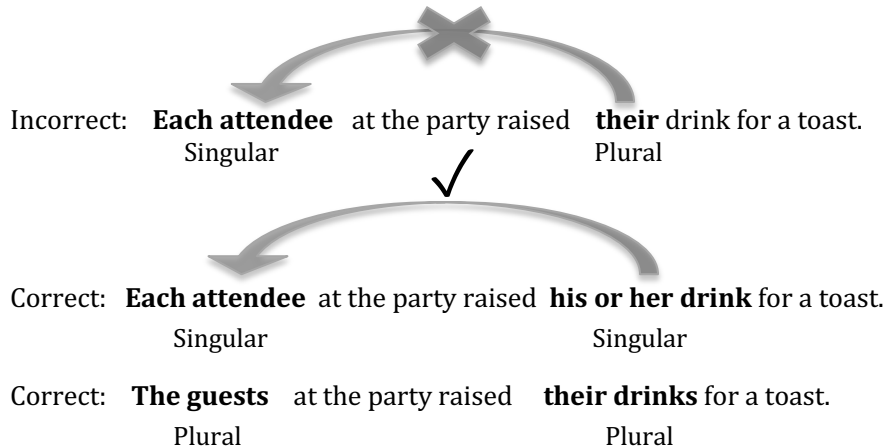
Pronoun Case Practice:

- Before jumping in the pool, please ask (I/me/myself) for permission.
- According to Mary, the three-act play was directed by John and (she/her).
- The restaurant manager asked that just an order of spaghetti and meatballs be set aside for (him/himself) after he put some of his favorite cheese on a plate for (him/himself).
- In order to lift the table, my mother asked Eric, Rich, and (me/I) for help.
- (Who/whom) is the best chess player in the world right now?
- People often travel to casinos in Las Vegas to test (their/they're/your) luck at the blackjack tables and to see (its/their) famous skyline.
- After pouring (me/myself) a glass of lemonade, I went out to sit by the pool.
- The painting, which was completed by Rachel and (she/her/herself), was praised by critics for (its/it's/its') shading.
- Terry, (who/whom) is the top ranked basketball recruit in the city, always dominates the player (who/whom) he is guarded by.
- The team captain, the coaches, and (they/them) all gathered together for a team photo.
- We were all wondering (who/whom) had pulled the senior class prank and (who/whom) the principal had called to his office.

Pronoun Agreement

Pronouns must agree with the antecedent, which is the noun that the pronoun is replacing. **Whenever you see a pronoun on the SAT, you must find exactly who or what it is referring to.** The antecedent can be in the same sentence as the pronoun or in a preceding sentence. The antecedent can also be anywhere in the sentence (unnecessary information, prepositional phrases, etc).

Pronouns must match the antecedent in terms of plurality and gender. A singular antecedent must have a singular pronoun; a plural antecedent must have a plural pronoun. A male antecedent must have a male pronoun; a female antecedent must have a female pronoun.



Pronouns Agreement Practice:

1. Ben or Tom will give (his/their) presentation to the class today.
2. The popularity of food trucks can be credited to (its/their) convenience and unique menu items.
3. Each member of the women's track team improved (her/their) time and helped the team win (her/its/their) first state title.
4. Jane and Sarah, after a long conversation with another group of hikers on the trail, said (she/they) were too tired to go any farther today.
5. Please remind each student to bring in (his or her/their) signed participation form for tomorrow's field trip and turn (it/them) into the teacher before boarding the bus.
6. The puppy lost (its/it's/its') ball in the ocean.
7. A person (who/whom) is committed to (their/his or her) dreams can achieve (it/them).
8. The writers soon found that all of (his or her/their) writing skills and fantastic stories were useless unless (he or she/they) could get signed by a publishing company.
9. The leaf cutter ant, which is native to Central and South America, is best known for (its/their) methodical cutting of small pieces of leaves and carrying (it/them) to the nest.
10. If you plan to give a presentation on the importance of accurate data, (one/you) should check (one's/your) facts first.

Ambiguous Pronouns

For a pronoun to be correct, we must know exactly who or what it is referring to. **If we do not know exactly who or what a pronoun is referring to, the pronoun is ambiguous and is always incorrect.**

Incorrect: Stephen smiled at his father as he threw the ball.

We do not know if “he” is referring to Stephen or his father, so “he” is ambiguous and incorrect.

Correct: Stephen smiled at his father as his father threw the ball.

Even though it may seem redundant, replacing “he” with “his father” fixes the ambiguous pronoun error.

Incorrect: Even though the order had not yet shown up, the librarian insisted that she had ordered some.

We have no idea what “some” is referring to in this sentence.

Correct: Even though the order had not yet shown up, the librarian insisted that she had ordered four copies of the new book.

Now, we know that the librarian is referring to “four copies of the new book,” so there is no longer an ambiguous pronoun.

TIP – Spotting Ambiguous Pronouns Questions

Anytime you see a pronoun in the answer choices, check to see if the pronoun is ambiguous. Here are all of the pronouns you should keep an eye out for: **he, him, his, she, her, hers, they, them, their, it, its, this, that, these, those, some, none.**

On the SAT, ambiguous pronouns questions will look something like this:

Of the 2020 inductees to the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame, which include Biggie Smalls, Nine Inch Nails and its lead singer Trent Reznor, and the Doobie Brothers, it is widely agreed that _____ the most famous.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) he is
- B) they are
- C) Biggie is
- D) it is

Ted sat down with his dinner: three pulled pork sliders with a side of french fries. James, Ted’s younger brother, immediately asked for _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) one
- B) a slider
- C) one of them
- D) some

In the first example, the answer is C because we need to specify who is the most famous. “He,” “they,” or “it” could be referring to multiple people or things, so answer choices A, B, and D are all ambiguous. The only answer choice that is specific is C.

In the second example, the answer is B since it specifies what James is asking for. If we just say James asked for “one” or “one of them” or “some,” we do not know if James wants a slider or a French fry.

Ambiguous Pronouns Practice:

1. When the owner of Pizza Port greets _____. The friendly interaction is one of the reasons Pizza Port has become a local hangout.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a customer, he always smiles
- B) a customer, the owner always smiles
- C) a customer, she always smiles
- D) a customers, always smiling

2. After the student handed in the overdue homework assignment to _____ away angrily.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the teacher, she walked
- B) the teacher, walking
- C) the teacher, the teacher walks
- D) the teacher, the student walked

3. Not long after Chris and Andrew got a \$15,000 loan from the bank for their restaurant, _____ went bankrupt.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) it
- B) he
- C) one
- D) the restaurant

4. A friend of mine recently had a conversation with a _____ on the war.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) marine that changed his view
- B) marine that changed my friend's view
- C) marine, who changed her view
- D) marine, changing his view

5. The human brain is not good at calculating probabilities or handling uncertainty. When we see stocks decreasing in value compared to other investments in our portfolio, we want to sell _____ immediately, but that is often the wrong decision.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) them
- B) those
- C) the stocks
- D) it

6. Could there be an evolutionary origin to risk aversion? It can be argued that thousands of years of evolution has made the human brain genetically wired for risk aversion: the humans who took less risk survived and passed down their genes, while the ones who took greater risks did not. Over time, this preference for caution might have been reinforced through societal structures that valued stability, further solidifying _____ as an advantageous trait.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) this
- B) risk aversion
- C) it
- D) some

Chapter 7 Practice:

1. Most classic guitars are handmade, molded from mahogany, ash, or maple wood. _____ all wood except for the strings, tuning keys, and the bridge.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) It is
- B) Which are
- C) They are
- D) One is

2. Fascinated by folklore and enchanted stories, Andrew eagerly searched the library shelves, hoping to uncover a collection of fairy tales. One of the books in the library was full of old Irish fairy tales, but Andrew could not find _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) them
- B) those.
- C) his own.
- D) it.

3. I was in shock after the vote was _____ Richard to be the captain of our debate team?

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) over. Who selected
- B) over; whom selected
- C) over, who selected
- D) over: whom selected

4. After grabbing a stack of menus, the hostess at Jerry's Southern BBQ _____ to our table.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) leads Eli, Billy, and I
- B) leads Eli, Billy, and me
- C) led Eli, Billy, and me
- D) led Eli, Billy, and I

5. During the day, San Diego bustles with visitors, but even after a long day on the town, people gather at _____ famous beaches to watch sunset.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they're
- B) their
- C) it's
- D) its

6. The Iditarod, called "the last great race on Earth" by many Alaskans, is a long, grueling race across nearly 1,000 miles of the Alaskan wilderness. Last year's winner Dallas _____ has won the race four times, set a new record at 8 days, 11 hours, 20 minutes, and 16 seconds.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Seavey, whom
- B) Seavey who
- C) Seavey, who
- D) Seavey

7. Paleontologist David Hume used advanced 3-D laser scanning to reconstruct a model of the now extinct dodo's (*R. cucullatus*) skeletal structure. Hume noted that the robust kneecaps of *R. cucullatus*, along with its thick leg bones and broad pelvis would have provided _____ with the strength and maneuverability to easily navigate the rocky and densely forested landscape of its homeland, Mauritius.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) them
- B) these
- C) that
- D) it

8. In the garden, the rose bushes bloomed beautifully, but they overshadowed the plants nearby. Gardeners wanted to trim _____ for a more balanced landscape.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) them
- B) those
- C) the flowers
- D) it

9. The new song by Lady Gaga and Ariana Grande is enormously popular; _____ lyrics are just so catchy!

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) its
- B) it's
- C) their
- D) her

10. Due to changes in local gravity fields, the accuracy of pendulum clocks, which use harmonic motion to keep time, will depend on the altitude at which _____ located.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) it's
- B) they are
- C) its
- D) one is

11. The chef insists that using gelatin packets is the best way to give the right consistency to _____ meatloaf slices. He maintains that these are the reason he won first prize at this year's competition.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) his
- B) her
- C) their
- D) there

12. Southern alligator lizards near the coast, where the ground is much sandier, are much lighter – by a large margin – _____ inland cousins.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) then their
- B) than its
- C) than their
- D) than

13. Despite the passage of time and the evolution of their surroundings, the enduring traits of loyalty, gentleness, and boundless enthusiasm have remained steadfast in the golden retriever lineage. Today, a golden retriever behaves much in the same way as _____ ancestors did over one hundred years ago.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) their
- B) its
- C) our
- D) they're

14. The track coach accepted Elizabeth's explanation for why she was so late to practice. My friends and _____ found Elizabeth's explanation hard to believe and questioned her about the details.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) I, although,
- B) me, although,
- C) I although
- D) me, although

15. One of the telltale signs of a black hole is the unusual bending of light around _____. This phenomenon occurs due to the immense gravitational pull exerted by these celestial entities. As light passes near a black hole, its trajectory is curved, creating a striking visual effect known as gravitational lensing.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) them
- B) these.
- C) one of those black holes.
- D) it.

16. Animal domestication – the process of breeding tame animals over time to be more docile and suitable for human care and use – results in animals that are behaviorally different from their wild counterparts; _____ also produces animals with an array of physical differences, including white patches in the fur, floppy ears, and diminished snout size.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they
- B) these animals
- C) it
- D) those

17. Species throughout time have been shaped by divergent evolution, in which a population becomes more distinct from the rest of its species as _____ to a habitat. Biologists Daniel Bolnick and William Stutz are using sticklebacks for a study on divergent evolution.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they adapt
- B) those adapt
- C) it adapts
- D) these adapt

18. The Great Wall of China stands as an awe-inspiring testament to human engineering and perseverance. Stretching across thousands of miles, this architectural marvel was a monumental undertaking.

_____ commonly thought that the Great Wall of China was constructed in the early second century BCE, during the reign of Emperor Qin Shi Huang. However, recent archaeological findings and scholarly debates have suggested a more nuanced timeline, proposing that several walls and fortifications were built and rebuilt across different dynasties.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Its
- B) Among historians, its
- C) It's
- D) Its'

19. The construction workers chased away the _____ often snuck into the construction site and climbed on the scaffolding.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) children whom
- B) children; whom
- C) children that
- D) children who

20. Gamification, or the application of game-like rules and reward to nongame contexts, has become increasingly popular with employers like Dewitt. Idea street designed a game to motivate Dewitt employees to collaborate on idea development. Employees and their ideas were rewarded with points. Selection of a particular idea for implementation meant that _____ stakeholders additional points.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they increased in value, earning their
- B) they increased in value, earning its
- C) it increased in value, earning its
- D) it increased in value, earning their

21. Since graduating high school and moving to Prague, Andrea has not seen any of the _____ she went to high school with.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) people that
- B) people who
- C) people whom
- D) people, where

22. The melting snow and ice caused a variety of problems. After re-freezing overnight, _____ slick roads, many accidents, and huge traffic jams.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) it causes
- B) it caused
- C) they caused
- D) causing

23. Located in New York City's SoHo neighborhood and surrounded by other established bakeries, Dominique Ansel Bakery sought a breakthrough to combat declining sales. The struggling bakery finally became popular when _____ invented a brand new baked good: the cronut.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they
- B) he
- C) themselves
- D) it

24. Ari convinced Mary Kate, a cashier _____ he hired to work mornings, to come in on Saturday to close.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they
- B) whom
- C) which
- D) who

25. Anne Stine Ingstad is an archaeologist who recently discovered a site in Newfoundland, Canada, that was once inhabited by Vikings. The artifacts that Ingstad found led her to conclude that more than one hundred Vikings had lived at the site for several years, using _____ as a base to explore other parts of the coastline.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) it
- B) each of these
- C) those
- D) them

26. After seeing the bees and beehive at the farm and tasting the jars of fresh honey, Aaron decided to order _____ for himself.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) some
- B) some of them
- C) those
- D) some bees

27. To create a building that is aesthetic, innovative, and functional, the architect must work carefully to turn her idealized design concepts into a practical structure. To accomplish this, the architect provides a detailed design to _____ construction manager. This blueprint serves as the backbone of the entire construction process, carefully outlining the precise specifications, dimensions, and materials necessary to achieve the architect's vision.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) his
- B) her
- C) their
- D) its

Chapter 8: Misplaced Modifiers

A misplaced modifier is a word, phrase, or clause that is improperly separated from the noun that it modifies. A misplaced modifier leads to a sentence that has an incorrect or unintended meaning. Misplaced modifiers are hard to spot because we usually know what the sentence is really supposed to be saying.

Incorrect: Consistently erupting, Jack loves taking pictures of the Old Faithful geyser at Yellowstone National Park.

So what's wrong here? The modifier "consistently erupting" is supposed to be modifying the geyser, but instead it is modifying Jack! Let's hope Jack is not consistently erupting. When a sentence begins with a modifying phrase, the phrase must modify the very first noun that follows the comma. There are two ways to fix this error:

Correct: Consistently erupting, the Old Faithful geyser at Yellowstone National Park is one of Jack's favorite things to take pictures of.

Correct: Since it is consistently erupting, Jack loves taking pictures of the Old Faithful geyser at Yellowstone National Park.

In the first correct version, the modifier "consistently erupting" is right next to and correctly modifying the Old Faithful geyser. In the second correct version, we added a pronoun "it" to change the modifier from a phrase to a dependent clause, so we now know that the geyser is erupting. When we get to "Jack," there is no longer any confusion about who or what is erupting.

TIP – "Next-door Neighbor Rule"

For a modifier to be properly placed, it must be right "next-door" to the noun it is describing. Modifiers can be at the beginning, middle, or end of a sentence.

If the modifier is at the beginning of the sentence, the first noun after must be the word being modified.



Running from the police, Eric hopped the fence and hid underneath a car.

If the modifier is in the middle or end of the sentence, it must be modifying the noun directly before it.

Dr. Anderson, a world-renown surgeon, fixed my broken leg.



Front of the Sentence Modifiers with a Comma

On the SAT, **most misplaced modifiers questions have a modifier at the front of the sentence separated by a comma.** For this type of question, consider who or what the modifier is describing and then make sure that person, place, or thing is the first noun in the rest of the sentence.

Incorrect: Not popular since the early 1980s, the documentary about mullets explored the origins of the wildly popular hairstyle.

Correct: Not popular since the early 1980s, mullets were the topic of a recently released documentary.

The modifier is “not popular since the early 1980s,” so the next noun must be whoever or whatever the modifier is describing. In the incorrect version, the next noun “documentaries” is not what we are supposed to be describing. The correct version puts the described word “mullets” right next to the modifier at the beginning of the sentence.

Practice:

- The unusual crime, which was committed in a wealthy and usually safe small mountain town, captivated national media attention. Addressing the group of reporters gathered outside of the police station, _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - there was no indication that the police chief knew if the suspect was in custody or not
 - the police chief said he did not know if the suspect was in custody or not.
 - no indication of whether or not the suspect was in custody was given by the police chief.
 - the police chief’s report gave no indication of whether the suspect was in custody or not.
- The competition for designing the museum was won by a local: Laura Saunders. _____ , she created a modern art museum that is an architectural marvel.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - Designed for beauty and symmetry
 - Both beautiful and symmetric
 - By designing it for beauty and symmetry
 - A design with beauty and symmetry
- To meet growing demand for automobiles, Henry Ford created an innovative system that completely transformed how his factories built cars. A brand new approach to automobile manufacturing, _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

 - Henry Ford and Ford Motor Company installed the first moving assembly line in 1913
 - the Ford Motor Company, owned by Henry Ford, installed the first moving assembly line in 1913.
 - the first moving assembly line was installed by Henry Ford and Ford Motor Company in 1913.
 - 1913 was the first year that Henry Ford and the Ford Motor Company installed the moving assembly line.

Middle or the End of the Sentence Modifier with Commas

A modifier in the middle or at the end of the sentence must be directly after whoever or whatever it is modifying.

Incorrect: The research team, which arrived at their nesting grounds early this year, tracked the movements of the blue storks.

Correct: The research team tracked the movements of the blue storks, which arrived at their nesting grounds early this year.

Correct: The research team, which tracked the movement of the blue storks, noted that the birds arrived at their nesting grounds early.

In the incorrect example, the modifier “which arrived at their nesting grounds early this year” was incorrectly modifying the research team. However, this modifier should be modifying the blue storks, so the first correct example moves the modifier to the end of the sentence right “next-door” to the blue storks. We could also fix the incorrect sentence by changing the modifier in the middle as is displayed in the second correct example. The new modifier “which tracked the movement of the blue storks” now properly modifies the research team.

Practice:

1. “The fish and chips is now a mainstay on the menu and one of our top selling items,” says Chef Paulo Benin. There is little doubt that the new deep frying technique developed by the chef, the modified recipe for battering the fish, and the choice to use cod, _____, results in a best-selling dish.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a fish whose flavor and flakey texture makes it perfect for the dish
- B) one that requires frying the fish twice
- C) using hotter oil and smaller pieces of fish
- D) which uses less oil and panko breadcrumbs

2. While it may seem simple, crafting a wooden chair takes expertise that requires years of woodworking experience and a sound knowledge of the human form and spine. To create a chair that is both pleasant to sit in and ergonomically sound, most high-end designers choose _____, a type of wood known for its resilience and rich grain patterns.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) oak to construct both the legs and the back
- B) oak as the wood for constructing the legs and the back
- C) to construct both the legs and back out of oak
- D) for the legs and back oak during construction

Modifiers without Commas

On more difficult questions, the modifier will not be separated by any commas. These are the hardest to spot, but the “next-door neighbor” rule still applies. Keep an eye out for phrases starting with “that” or words ending in “-ing” and “-ed.”

Incorrect: A tarantula bit one of my coworkers that had a huge, hairy body.

Correct: A tarantula that had a huge, hairy body bit one of my coworkers.

The incorrect sentence has the modifier “that had a huge, hairy body” describing the coworker and not the tarantula. By moving the modifier right next to the tarantula in the correct sentence, we describe the tarantula as having a huge, hairy body.

Practice:

1. With the paperwork signed and the merger finalized, it was time to step outside onto the balcony, enjoy the view, and celebrate four years of hard work. The three lead partners ____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) talked on the corner of the balcony smoking cigars to celebrate the deal.
- B) celebrating the deal talked on the corner of the balcony smoking cigars.
- C) smoking cigars talked to celebrate the deal on the corner of the balcony.
- D) smoking cigars to celebrate the deal talked on the corner of the balcony.

Prepositional Phrases as Modifiers

Prepositional phrases can also act as modifiers and must be placed in the correct position to have the intended meaning. These occur less commonly on the test and are often difficult to spot.

Incorrect: Paul and his father talked about the baseball game in the stands.

Correct: In the stands, Paul and his father talked about the baseball game.

In the first sentence, the baseball game is in the stands. We know that’s not the case, so we need to move the prepositional phrase “in the stands” to the beginning of the sentence, so it is now describing Paul and his father as being in the stands.

Practice:

1. Lexus was the first car manufacturer to offer an automatic parallel parking feature, setting off a consumer and media frenzy when the self-parking LS 460 sedan was unveiled at the 2005 Detroit International Auto Show. As a result, dealerships sold over 19,000 LS 460s sedans ____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) in 2006 with automatic parallel parking to buyers wanting a new car.
- B) to buyers with automatic parallel parking in 2006 wanting a new car.
- C) with automatic parallel parking to buyers in 2006 wanting a new car.
- D) to buyers in 2006 with automatic parallel parking wanting a new car.

Modifiers in Parentheses

Modifiers that are set apart in parentheses must be placed directly “next-door” to whoever or whatever they are modifying. Phrases in parentheses will always be in the middle or end of the sentence, so the word being described must be right before the parentheses. This type of misplaced modifier is not too common on the SAT.

Incorrect: The scientists tried to develop a new method to make their self-pollination study (where pollen from the same plant arrives at the stigma of the flower) completely free of pollen contamination from other plants.

Correct: The scientists tried to develop a new method to study self-pollination (where pollen from the same plant arrives at the stigma of the flower) completely free of pollen contamination from other plants.

The modifier in the parentheses is defining what self-pollination is, so self-pollination must be directly before the parentheses, as it is in the correct sentence. In the incorrect sentence, the word study is directly before the parentheses, so the modifier in parentheses is incorrectly describing the self-pollination study.

Practice:

1. Plant the roses in a sunny spot in the backyard and be sure to water them every day just after sunrise, _____(who had been growing and selling his own roses for the past two decades).

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the expert gardener recommended
- B) recommended the expert gardener
- C) was the expert gardener’s recommendation
- D) the gardener, who was an expert, recommended

TIP – How to Spot Misplaced Modifiers Questions

The hardest part about misplaced modifiers questions is spotting them! **Most students think these questions are about phrasing or flow and never realize what they are actually being tested on.**

Misplaced modifiers questions always have at least one and, very often, both of the following defining characteristics:

- 1. All 4 answer choices are similar in length, and the answer choices have the same words scrambled in different orders.** Anytime you see 4 long answer choices that are all saying the same general thing in different orders, you are very likely looking at a misplaced modifiers question.
- 2. The first word varies in the answer choices.** If the first word or group of words is different in 3 or 4 of the answer choices, the question is most likely testing you on misplaced modifiers.

On the SAT, misplaced modifiers questions look like this:

Over the past decade, advances in underwater cameras have allowed researchers to view a previously hidden world filled with vibrant colors and patterns. This revelation sparked the team at Scripps San Diego to examine why these patterns exist. Analyzing the ultraviolet camera footage, _____ This breakthrough reshaped our understanding of marine life and highlighted communication beyond outerspectrum of vision.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) scientists discovered that fish communicate using UV coloration and signaling.
- B) fish were found to communicate using UV coloration and signaling.
- C) it was discovered by scientists that fish communicate using UV coloration and signaling.
- D) UV coloration and signaling were discovered as a way fish communicate.

Whenever you spot a misplaced modifiers question, identify the modifier and ask yourself, “who or what is the modifier describing?” In this example, the modifier is “analyzing the ultraviolet camera footage.” Who or what is analyzing the camera footage? The scientists! Since “the scientists” must be right next-door, the answer is A.

Chapter 8 Practice:

1. Johannes Kepler (1571-1630) was a mathematician and physicist who not only observed but also sought to explain the celestial dance above. Observing that the planets move in elliptical paths around the sun, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Kepler's first law (the law of ellipses) was formulated in 1609.
- B) 1609 was when Kepler formulated his first law (the law of ellipses).
- C) Kepler formulated his first law (the law of ellipses).
- D) a formulation came to Kepler that resulted in his first law (the law of ellipses).

2. _____, many American historians regard Christopher John Boye as one of the biggest traitors in history.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Since they betrayed the country and sold secrets to the Soviet Union
- B) Since he betrayed his country and sold secrets to the Soviet Union,
- C) Betraying the country and selling secrets to the Soviet Union,
- D) Known for the famous betrayal,

3. In 1920, the Innez laboratory was studying an animal that was not yet known to migrate: the monarch butterfly. _____ south for their winter migration, the researchers determined that the butterflies had an innate sense of direction.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Flying
- B) When the butterflies flew
- C) When they flew
- D) By flying

4. The truck transporting animals to the Michigan Zoo was accidentally left unlocked, so all the animals escaped into the city and chaos ensued. The red-tailed monkeys climbed up the nearest tree, the tortoise almost got hit by a car, and the lemurs took off down the street. In hot pursuit on a bicycle, _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the escaped lemurs were chased by animal control.
- B) the escaped lemurs were running away from animal control.
- C) animal control chased the escaped lemurs.
- D) chasing the lemurs was animal control.

5. Mrs. Tamara James – the founder of the all-female fashion company Pretty Her that specializes in dresses for women over fifty – will make _____ if the request is made at least three weeks ahead of time.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) evening gowns for special customers with sequins
- B) evening gowns with sequins for special customers
- C) sequins with evening gowns for special customers
- D) special customers with sequins evening gowns

6. England's transition from a monarchy to a Democratic Republic vastly shifted the power structure of the government. The _____ decisions for the nation.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) greatly decreased Queen and King had an amount of power in making
- B) Queen and King had a greatly decreased amount of power in making
- C) Queen and King had an amount of greatly decreased power in making
- D) Queen and King had an amount of power in making greatly decreased

7. Since the old pipes of Mexico City were leaching heavy metals and contaminating the water supply, the city tasked its best engineers with designing a way to make the water potable. In designing a new water filtration system, _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) common strategies were combined with revolutionary, new ideas.
- B) revolutionary, new ideas were combined with common strategies.
- C) engineers' borrowing of common strategies were combined with revolutionary, new ideas.
- D) engineers combined common strategies with new, revolutionary ideas.

8. Alaskan Huskies are one of the most popular dog breeds for sled dogs thanks to their demeanor and physical abilities. Highly energetic and intelligent, _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) they are friendly to everyone
- B) Alaskan Huskies are friendly to everyone
- C) many owners know that Alaskan Huskies are friendly to everyone
- D) everyone is treated as a friend by Alaskan Huskies

9. When visiting Bermuda, Bub's Burgers is a can't miss lunch spot. Covered with license plates from around the world, _____, and the ceiling is covered with bills in over sixty different currencies.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the walls at Bub's Burgers are always a popular photo op for tourists
- B) tourists love to take pictures of the walls at Bub's Burgers.
- C) photos in front of the walls at Bub's Burgers are very popular for tourists.
- D) Bub's Burgers is a popular photo op for tourists.

10. Former professional surfer Enzo Rivas now lives a quiet life in a small town by the ocean. Working in his shop in Encinitas, _____. On occasion, locals see Enzo surfing, but he is now more commonly seen on his road bike.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) surfboards are carefully handcrafted by shaper Enzo Rivas
- B) shaper Enzo Rivas carefully handcrafts surfboards
- C) there are surfboards being carefully handcrafted by shaper Enzo Rivas
- D) Enzo Riva's surfboards are carefully handcrafted

11. Using a piping hot pan with oil glistening, _____. This technique is a simple and effective way to prevent oil splatter.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the steak must be carefully laid away from the cook to prevent getting burned
- B) the cook must carefully lay the steak away from himself to prevent getting burned
- C) the cook's steak must carefully be laid away from the cook to prevent getting burned
- D) prevent getting burned by carefully laying the steak away

12. Different types of ants have defined roles that help the colony survive. _____, the worker ants (mostly females) are responsible for building and maintaining the nest while the bigger queen ant is responsible for the future generations of the colony.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Spending her entire life laying eggs,
- B) Carrying up to fifty times their body weights,
- C) Since it can carry up to fifty times its body weight,
- D) Monitoring how her nest functions on a day-to-day basis,

13. The legend of Old Tom, the killer whale that helped sailors catch fish, is likely just that – a legend. The story says that in the 1920s, while swimming in the freezing cold waters off Australia, _____; however, with no proof of this beyond the stories of old sailors, it is impossible to determine if it ever really happened.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) Old Tom, the orca whale, successfully hunted large schools of fish with sailors
- B) sailors successfully hunted large schools of fish with Old Tom, the orca whale
- C) it was large schools of fish that were successfully hunted by Old Tom, the orca whale, and sailors
- D) sailors with the help of Old Tom, the orca whale, successfully hunted large schools of fish.

14. The four members of the panel were each asked who they thought was the best men's soccer player of all time. _____ (who was chosen as the athlete of the century by the International Olympic Committee in 1999).

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) The Brazilian soccer analyst decided that the best player of all time was Pele
- B) Pele was chosen by the Brazilian soccer analyst as the best player of all time
- C) Pele was named the best player of all time by the Brazilian soccer analyst
- D) The best player of all time was Pele, the Brazilian soccer analyst decided

15. The first-generation Roomba, a mobile robot for vacuuming floors, was initially sold in 2002. Now in widespread use across many homes, and a top-10 selling infomercial product of the 2010s, _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a 60 Minutes segment featured the Roomba
- B) the Roomba was featured on 60 Minutes.
- C) the Roomba's segment was featured on 60 Minutes.
- D) 60 Minutes featured the Roomba.

16. Graywolf Books, a publisher in Canada, focuses on bringing historical stories of the indigenous communities of the country to mainstream audiences. Commenting on Graywolf's mission, _____ her publishing house was "born with the intention of telling untold histories the Canadian people need to know."

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of standard English?

- A) cofounder Eden Whitehead says
- B) cofounder Eden Whitehead says,
- C) which cofounder Eden Whitehead says,
- D) when cofounder Eden Whitehead says,

Chapter 9: Parallel Structure

Parallel structure is the repetition of a chosen grammatical form within a sentence as items are listed or compared. The items in a list can be words, phrases, or clauses. Whenever you see items in a list or a comparison between items, you must make sure the items are parallel.

Parallel Structure and Lists

The items in any list must be written with the same grammatical forms. Items must be all nouns, all verbs, and so on. When lists are written with proper parallel structure, the sentence will flow more smoothly and will sound better. As a result, many students can “hear” which answer choice is the correct without even realizing they are being tested on parallel structure.

Incorrect: To protect her fragile hands, Julia will not rake the leaves, wash the dishes, and has decided she will not take out the trash.

Correct: To protect her fragile hands, Julia will not rake the leaves, wash the dishes, or take out the trash.

Incorrect: Elon Musk is known for self-driving cars and pioneering the SpaceX program.

Correct: Elon Musk is known for self-driving cars and the SpaceX program.

Correct: Elon Musk is known for manufacturing self-driving cars and pioneering the SpaceX program.

Incorrect: After calling in sick to school, Charlie’s day consisted of getting excused from class, receiving an extension on his homework assignment, and to spend the afternoon watching movies at home.

Correct: After calling in sick to school, Charlie’s day consisted of getting excused from class, receiving an extension on his homework assignment, and spending the afternoon watching movies at home.

No matter how simple or complex the items in the list are, they must be parallel. Lists of 3 or more items are easier to spot, and you will be able to more obviously “hear” which answer choice is correct or incorrect. Lists of 2, however, are more difficult to spot and can often sound good to us even if they are not parallel. **Be aware of parallel structure anytime you see a list of 2 on the SAT**, as this is a topic that tricks many students when it appears on test day.

Parallel Structure and Lists Practice: Correct the parallel structure errors in the sentences below:

1. Theresa was expecting a visit from her mother, so she made her bed, cleaning the shelves of the refrigerator, and swept the kitchen floor.
2. Attempting to sneak out of the house, Janice grabbed her phone, her purse, and wallet and then was climbing out the back window.
3. Chevy, our golden retriever, chews on the furniture, he barks at the neighbors, and thinks his shadow is real.
4. It’s harder to lift the couch by myself than lifting it with some friends.
5. I would rather get free music with commercials than paying for music with no commercials.

Special Cases for Parallel Structure

In addition to lists, there are also certain other special cases for parallel structure. These special cases, which are officially called correlative conjunctions, must have the same grammatical structure for both parts of the conjunctions.

Keep an eye out for these ones on the SAT:

Neither ___ nor ___ Either ___ or ___ Not only ___ but also ___ Both ___ and ___

In all of these special cases, the “blanks” must be parallel. For example:

Incorrect: My mother not only took away my keys but also she locked them in the safe.

Correct: My mother not only took away my keys but also locked them in the safe.

In the incorrect example, “took away my keys” is not parallel with “she locked them in the safe.” Since the “she” is not in the first part, it cannot be in the second part. In the corrected version, “took away my keys” is parallel with “locked them in the safe.”

Special Cases for Parallel Structure Practice: Correct the parallel structure errors.

1. Both a scholar and quite athletic, Sylvia got a scholarship to row crew in college.
2. The news report is neither accurate nor written fairly.
3. Neither scolding the child nor attempts to bribe him helped to calm him down.
4. The haunted house not only required participants to sign a waiver before entering but also asking them to turn their phones off for the entire experience.
5. Forms of payment accepted are either cash or sending payment with Venmo.

TIP – How to Spot Parallel Structure and Lists Questions

Parallel structure and lists questions always have the following defining characteristics:

1. **The sentence includes a list of two or more items.** Anytime there is a list, we will need to consider parallel structure. Keep an eye out for list of two, as these can be difficult to notice errors with parallel structure.

On the SAT, parallel structure and lists questions look like this:

The responsibilities of the coffee packer position included packing the coffee beans, which have been roasted, and _____ the work area around the machine clean and orderly.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) keeping
- B) to keep
- C) kept
- D) having kept

In the example above, the answer is A. The list of two responsibilities, “packing the beans” and “keeping the work area around the machine clean and orderly” must be parallel. “Packing” and “keeping” match and have correct parallel structure.

Logical Comparisons (Parallel Comparisons)

For any comparisons, the items being compared must be parallel. Comparing without proper parallel structure can lead to unintended or incorrect comparisons. In other words, make sure you are comparing apples to apples and not apples to oranges. A common fix to parallel structure mistakes is to add “those of” or “that of” or other similar variations before the second item in the comparison.

If you ever see “those of” or “that of” or a similar variation in a question, the question is testing you on logical comparisons.

If you see any commonly used comparison words such as “more,” “less,” “better,” “worse,” and “than,” there is a comparison, and you need to consider logical comparisons.

Incorrect: The fried chicken at Chick-fil-A is much better than Crispy Cluck.

Correct: The fried chicken at Chick-fil-A is better than the fried chicken at Crispy Cluck.

Correct: The fried chicken at Chick-fil-A is better than Crispy Cluck’s fried chicken.

Correct: The fried chicken at Chick-fil-A is better than that at Crispy Cluck.

Parallel Structure and Comparisons Practice: Correct the parallel structure errors.

1. Unlike Mr. Rodriguez, Mr. Allen’s math exams are curved, so everyone gets a better grade.
2. There was no mystery greater than the left shoe thief at my high school.
3. Walter stands by his claim that Michael Jordan’s shoes are better than all current NBA players.
4. Unlike the 2014 World Cup in Brazil, the teams at the 2010 World Cup in South Africa had to deal with the constant noise from the vuvuzela horns.

TIP – How to Spot Parallel Structure and Comparisons Questions

Parallel structure and comparison questions always have at least one of the following defining characteristics:

1. **A commonly used comparison word such as “more,” “less,” “better,” “worse,” and “than” is in the answer choices or in the sentence.** Anytime there is a comparison, we need to keep an eye out for parallel structure.
2. **The phrase “that of” or “those of” or a similar variation (“that in,” “those at,” etc.) is in any of the answer choices.**

On the SAT, parallel structure and comparisons questions look like this:

Victoria concluded that the juiciness of fuji apples is a better indicator for the flavor _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than for a bosc pear
- B) than of bosc pears.
- C) than for that of bosc pears.
- D) then bosc pears.

Whenever you see a comparison, make sure you know exactly what we are comparing. In this example, the comparison is between “the juiciness of fuji apples” and “the juiciness of bosc pears.” We must compare the juiciness of the fuji apple to the juiciness of the bosc pears and not to the pear itself. The only answer that does this is C, where “that of bosc pears” is short for “the juiciness of bosc pears.”

Chapter 9 Practice:

1. Studies have shown that the secrets to achieving true happiness are strengthening your closest relationship and _____ care of yourself mentally and physically.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) take
- B) if you take
- C) taking
- D) to take

2. At birth, baby birds get all of their nutrients by staying in the nest _____ directly from their parents' mouths.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) and they eat
- B) which they eat
- C) and eating
- D) that eat

3. Manny not only overcame his fear of standing in front of large crowds but _____ the best public speaker in his entire school.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) also became
- B) he also became
- C) he also had become
- D) also becoming

4. During the field trip to the beach, my classmates ignore the warning signs, climbing over the dunes and _____ to the dangerous polluted water.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) exposing themselves
- B) the exposure to
- C) were exposing themselves
- D) expose themselves

5. To predict the efficacy of an antibiotic using a computer model, scientists predicted the reduction of bacteria in a petri dish using two separate models: model X and model Y. After 3 days, the predictions based on model X were better _____ and continued to be significantly more accurate 5 days later.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than model Y
- B) than those based on model Y
- C) than compared with model Y
- D) than model Y's predictions

6. The orchestra conductor can raise the volume by lifting his arms up higher and _____ the volume by moving his hands closer together.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) lowering
- B) lower
- C) lowered
- D) has lowered

7. To enhance the survival rate of young salmon in hatcheries, fisheries expert David Park has proposed the introduction of controlled flow environments that mimic natural river conditions. This adaptation is strengthening the salmon's instinctual behaviors and better _____ them for their eventual release into the wild.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) preparing
- B) to prepare
- C) prepare
- D) prepared

8. Ancient artifacts such as the Rosetta Stone should be in the hands of people who know how to _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) properly repair, care for, and permanently protect them
- B) properly repair, while caring for and permanently protecting them.
- C) properly repairing, care for, and permanently protect them.
- D) to properly repair care for, permanently protecting them.

9. The doctor was a specialist in cardiovascular surgery and _____ during his successful career in medicine.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had invented the cardiac stint
- B) the cardiac stint inventor
- C) the inventor of the cardiac stint
- D) invented the cardiac stint

10. As sustainability becomes more essential, businesses across different sectors are acknowledging the importance of environmentally responsible practices. A 2019 study from Georgetown University found that the benefits of environmental initiatives were actually higher for companies in the business-to-business sector _____ companies in the business-to-consumer sector.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than those of
- B) than for
- C) than the benefits of
- D) than

11. According to most doctors, _____ is just as important as exercise for the mind.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) exercising the body
- B) giving the body exercise
- C) exercise for the body
- D) body exercise

12. I often still find myself struggling to properly season beverages, as their flavor profile is much more nuanced _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than cooked dishes.
- B) than these.
- C) then cooked dishes.
- D) than that of cooked dishes.

13. The relocation of the gray wolf to Yellowstone National Park in 1995 was a significant event for the species and the park itself. In Yellowstone, the wolves caused a trophic cascade of ecological change – rebalancing elk, deer, and beaver populations – and _____ tourism to the park.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) increasing
- B) increased
- C) to increase
- D) having increased

14. After traveling halfway around the world to Bali, Svetlana was disappointed that the swing at the rice fields was not _____ the pictures made it seem.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) as exciting a place to visit as
- B) an exciting place to visit
- C) a place to visit that was exciting
- D) excited to visit the place

15. Lucky visitors to the arctic circle might see the aurora borealis in the sky, an arctic fox in the snow, or _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) a beluga whale.
- B) beluga whales.
- C) a beluga whale in the sea.
- D) a swimming beluga whale.

16. A recent study has identified a possible connection between the bioluminescent glow of jellyfish and the shimmering bioluminescence exhibited by fireflies. The study suggests the blue-green glow of a midwater jellyfish in the deep sea might indeed be a mating mechanism, just like _____ in terrestrial environments.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the yellow-orange glow of a firefly
- B) those of fireflies
- C) fireflies
- D) that of fireflies

17. In his most recent public appearance, Dr. Rodriguez gave a speech about his autobiography, detailing his research in the field of cancer _____ his career achievements.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) immunotherapy and describing
- B) immunotherapy, and describes
- C) immunotherapy and described
- D) immunotherapy, after which he described

18. David relied on his own experience _____ the meat thermometer to tell when the turkey was done.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) rather than on
- B) rather than
- C) other than
- D) rather then on

19. The hunting habits of killer whales, which hunt together in pods of up to ten whales, are even more advanced _____ white sharks.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than great
- B) than the hunting habit's of great
- C) then great
- D) than those of great

20. The table, which was built entirely out of redwood, provides a space for my father to complete his puzzle and _____ .

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) my hobby of building model airplanes
- B) me building model airplanes
- C) for me to build model airplanes
- D) to allow me to build model airplanes

21. It has long been assumed that the domestic dog (*Canis familiaris*) has a better sense of smell than humans. A 2012 study from Auburn university has confirmed that the domestic dog has olfactory capabilities more acute than _____

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) the average human's.
- B) the average human.
- C) those of the average humans.
- D) that of the average human.

22. The goal of observing the dietary habits of the Galapagos tortoises was not only to identify the primary items the tortoises preferred to _____ if there is any correlation between food intake and behavior.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) eat but it was also to examine
- B) eat but also to examine
- C) eat, and to examine
- D) eat but also examining

23. Many of the skills required for hockey – hand-eye coordination, strength, and agility – are similar to _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) basketball and lacrosse
- B) basketball and lacrosse players
- C) the games of basketball and lacrosse
- D) those for basketball and lacrosse

24. By the end of the week, the team _____ ten new computers that came with two-year protection plans to cover any accidental damage and had ordered a new industrial printer capable of printing 10,000 pages per day.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) had purchased
- B) purchasing
- C) will purchase
- D) purchased

25. One way to increase the output of wind farms in the Anzo Borrego desert is to create new turbines that have longer rotor blades. In 2023, the rotor diameter of newly installed turbines in the Anzo Borrego desert reached 140 meters, several times _____.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) that of turbines installed in 2012
- B) turbines installed in 2012
- C) those of turbines installed in 2012
- D) the number of installed turbines in 2012

Chapter 10: Other Miscellaneous Topics

There are a variety of other miscellaneous grammar topics that appear on the conventions of Standard English questions. We will cover these topics in this chapter.

Commonly Confused Words

The SAT tests you on many commonly confused words. The most common one of these is “affect” vs. “effect.”

Affect vs. Effect

“Affect” is a verb, meaning to act on or produce a change in. “Effect” is a noun, meaning the result of a change. As long as you remember this rule, “affect” vs. “effect” questions should be easy!

Correct: Sunshine and palm trees affect my mood positively.

Correct: Sunshine and palms trees have a positive effect on my mood.

Many of the other most commonly confused words that appear on the SAT are below. There are many more beyond the ones listed. If you ever see a word choice question and are unsure, just go with your gut...most of the time you will be correct!

Advice – an opinion or recommendation (noun)	Conscience – sense of right or wrong	Lie – to lie down
Advise – to recommend or give information (verb)	Conscious – awake	Lay – to place
Accept – to receive	Council – a group that advises	Lose – to misplace or not win
Except – to take or leave out	Counsel – to advice	Loose – to not be tight
Allusion – an indirect reference	Complement – something that completes	Indifferent – not caring
Illusion – a false perception of reality	Compliment – to praise	Not different – the same
Allowed – permitted to happen	Desert – dry, sandy region	Passed – to have moved beyond
Aloud – out loud	Dessert – a sweet course at the end of a meal	Past – gone by in time
Ascent - climb	Dual – having two parts	Precede – to come before
Assent - agreement	Duel – a fight between 2 people	Proceed – to go forward
Assure – to remove doubt	Elicit – to draw or bring out	Principle – a rule
Ensure – to make certain a thing will or won’t happen	Illicit – illegal	Principal – head of a school
Insure – to get insurance	Emit – to send out, to throw off	Their – possessive pronoun
Beside – next to	Omit – to leave out	There – indicates location
Besides – in addition	Eminent – famous, respected	They’re – they are
Breath – inhalation/exhalation of air	Immanent – inherent or intrinsic	Through – into or out of, continuing in time
Breathe – to inhale or exhale	Imminent – ready to take place	Threw – past tense of throw
Cite – to quote or document	Farther – refers to physical distance	Thorough – careful or complete
Sight - vision	Further – moreover	Though – however
Site – position or place	Lead – a type of metal	Thru – abbreviated form of through
	Led – past tense of lead	To - toward
		Too – also
		Two – 2

Than vs. Then

“Than” is only used for comparisons. “Then” has multiple meanings: it can be used when dealing with time, to mean “in addition to,” or with “if/then” statements. When you see “then” and “than” on the test, just remember use this quick rule: **if it is a comparison, use “than.” Otherwise, use “then.”**

Incorrect: I think that chocolate with almonds is much better then ice cream.

Correct: I think that chocolate with almonds is much better than ice cream.

Incorrect: I need to call my mother, and than we can leave.

Correct: I need to call my mother, and then we can leave.

Have vs. Of

Many people often mistakenly use “could of” or “would of.” This is always incorrect! To be correct, we need to use “could have” or “would have.” **The words “could,” “should,” “would,” and “might” should always be followed by “have” not “of.”** The reason we often make this mistake is the contraction “could’ve,” which is short for “could have,” is often pronounced like “could of.”

Incorrect: If we left the show earlier, we could of avoided the traffic in the parking lot.

Correct: If we left the show earlier, we could have avoided the traffic in the parking lot.

Countable vs. Non-countable Adjectives

A countable noun is something that you can count, such as hours or bottles of milk. A noncountable noun is something that cannot be expressed in a plural form, such as time or respect. Certain adjectives, shown in the table below, can only be used to modify countable or non-countable nouns.

Countable	Non-Countable
number	amount
many	much
fewer	less
few	little

Correct: The amount of time to make lunch depends on the number of ingredients in the dish.

Correct: I do not place much significance on how many trophies an athlete has won.

Correct: Skim milk has fewer calories than whole milk, so I drink less whole milk than skim milk.

Correct: I can spare only a little time for this. I need to leave in a few minutes.

Active Voice vs. Passive Voice

Active voice means that the subject of the sentence is performing the verb's action. On the other hand, passive voice means that the subject is acted on by the verb. On the SAT, **never select an answer choice that is in passive voice; active voice is always better than passive voice.**

Active Voice: I picked up the pencil.

Passive Voice: The pencil was picked up by me.

Active Voice: The police chief announced the list of suspects.

Passive Voice: The list of suspects was announced by the police chief.

Commas and "While"

The word "while" has multiple meanings. **While can mean "during a time that," "although," or "whereas."** Depending on which meaning is intended, we may or may not need a comma before "while."

Rule #1: If "while" is used to mean "during a time that," we do not use a comma.

Example: It is required to wear a hard hat while visiting the caves.

Example: Padma critiqued the food while wearing a beautiful dress.

Rule #2: If "while" is used to mean "although" or "whereas," we use a comma. If there is a contrast, we add a comma before "while."

Example: Herbivores survive by only eating plants, while omnivores eat both plants and animals.

Example: The CEO is obsessed with analytics, while the rest of the team is more concerned with customer reviews.

Prepositional Idioms

In the English language, idioms are expressions that are stated in a certain way because it is a widely accepted practice. Certain words must be paired with certain prepositions to be correct.

Incorrect: Bobby was afraid by the dark

Correct: Bobby was afraid of the dark.

These questions are not really common on the SAT (usually once a test), and you should not study this topic unless you have mastered all other chapters in this course. When prepositional idioms do appear on the SAT, **read the entire sentence and rely on what sounds best to you.** To help you, below is a list of some prepositional idioms that may appear on the SAT.

You should not try to memorize this entire list! It is not the best use of your study time. If you do struggle on these, study the list below and hopefully it will help you better know what sounds best if you do face any questions on this on test day.

Advise against
Argue against
Decide against
Defend against
Rebel against
Go against
Guard against

Celebrate as
Known as/to be
Recognized as
Regard as
See as
Serve as
View as

Aim at
Arrive at
Effective at
Look at
Laugh at
Point at
Succeed at

Anxious about
Ask about
Be curious about
Bring about
Complain about
Think about
Wonder about
Worry about

Accompanied by
Amazed by
Assisted by
Confused by
Encouraged by
Followed by
Impressed by
Shocked by
Surprised by
Struck by
Puzzled by

Admire for
Advocate for
Ask for
Blame for
Celebrated for
Compensate for
Criticize for
Endure for
Famous for
Known for
Last for
Look for
Meant for
Named for/after
Necessary for
Prized for
Responsible for
Recognize for
Strive for
Tolerance for
Strive for
Wait for
Watch for
Abstain from
Across from
Defend from/against
Different from
Discourage from
Excused from

Protect from/against
Refrain from

Adept in/at
Confident in
Engage in/with
Interested in
Involved in
Success in/at
Take pride in

Based on
Depend on
Draw on
Focus on
Impose on
Insist on
Modeled on
Reflect on
Rely on

Accuse of
Appreciation of
Approve of
Capable of
Certain of
Composed of
Comprised of
Consist of
Cure of
Deprive of
Family of
In recognition of
In hope of
(in)capable of
Independent of
Knowledge of
A means of
A model of
Mastery of
A native of
An offer of
Principles of
Proponent of
Remind of
Source of
Take advantage of
Understanding of
Use of
A wealth of

Argue over
Control over
Talk over
Think over

Enter into
Look into
Inquire into
Insight into
Read into

Able to
Accustomed to
Adapt to
Admit to
Agree to
Belong to
Central to
Conform to
Come to
Critical to
Devoted to
Exposed to
Listen to
Native to
Object to
Obvious to
Opposed to
Point to
Prefer __ to __
Recommend __ to __
Relate to
Reluctant to
Reply to
Similar to
Threaten to
Unique to

Biased toward
Have a tendency toward

Agree with
Contrast with
Correlate with
Consistent with
Familiar with
Identify with
Interfere with
Occupied with
Sympathize with
Trust with

Chapter 10 Practice:

1. Because he is very protective, Ralph stepped in to prevent his brother, who was only 8 years old, _____ fighting the older students.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) at
- B) to
- C) from
- D) with

2. After stepping onto the porch, the entire family was _____ seeing a bear in the backyard.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) startled with
- B) startled by
- C) surprised in
- D) surprised with

3. The treatment was administered and then patients were asked to return the next day since the _____ of the treatment, if there were any, do not appear for 24 hours.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) affects
- B) affect
- C) effect
- D) effects

4. Before the story about the financials became public, Aura System, an electric battery company, _____ gone public, but now there is no chance of that happening.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) would of
- B) could of
- C) might have
- D) possibly to have

5. Research performed on the hummingbird population indicated that more time spent searching for food _____ a longer lifespan.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) correlates with
- B) correlates to
- C) points for
- D) insists on

6. The invention of barcodes made cashiers' jobs so much easier, as it substantially _____ of minutes that it took to calculate the total price of a customer's purchase.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) reduced the amount
- B) lowered the amount
- C) decreased the number
- D) deducted the number

7. After turning in my paper, my teacher reminded me that I needed to _____ all of my sources.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) sight
- B) site
- C) cite
- D) recite

8. For Donations Unlimited, donated clothes that are in fair to good condition are much easier to resell _____ used household items, such as pans, cutlery, or rice cookers.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) than
- B) then
- C) when compared on
- D) contrasted to

9. Selecting the right marketing team and publishing strategy directly _____ the success – or failure – of the book launch.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) effects
- B) effect
- C) affect
- D) affects

10. Clear glass windows were installed in the house _____ letting in more natural light.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) as a means to
- B) as a means of
- C) as a virtue of
- D) as a virtue to

11. Before finalizing her decision to buy, Sarah did _____ research on the property values in the neighborhood to make sure that buying the house was a good financial decision.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) through
- B) thorough
- C) thru
- D) though

12. Some mycologists prefer studying fungi in a laboratory _____ others prefer to do field work and attempt to identify new species of mushrooms in the wild.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) setting while
- B) setting, while
- C) setting, meanwhile,
- D) setting so that

13. The five-star hotel lived up to its promise of excellent service: the staff were amazingly efficient, provided fantastic recommendations for the best restaurants and attractions in the city, and assisted in booking all of our transportations to _____ that we enjoyed our stay.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) ensure
- B) assure
- C) insure
- D) make an assurance

14. If I had a nickel for every time that I saw a dog ride a _____ broke long ago.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

- A) bike, I would have been
- B) bike, I have been
- C) bike, I would of been
- D) bike, I was

Part 2:

Transitions

On each SAT Reading and Writing Test, there are 4-7 transitions questions. For transitions questions, you need to be able to select the correct transition based on the context in the passage.

In Part 2 of this course, we will teach you the most effective strategy for how to approach transitions questions and the details to look for in the passage to consistently select the most logical transition.

Chapter 12: Transitions

The SAT tests your reading skills by asking you to select the correct transition. For these questions, you are being tested on your ability to read for context and knowledge of transitions. On the Digital SAT, Transitions questions always look like this:

From the lookout on the mountain, which is about 2 miles from the coast, the ocean looked quite calm today even though a large winter storm had arrived last night. _____ the scene was much more chaotic with big waves and strong riptides.

1. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
A) Under the circumstances,
B) For instance,
C) Up close,
D) For example,

For transitions questions, all the answer choices have the same punctuation, so you do NOT need to worry about grammar. Your only focus here is to determine the relationship between the sentences and select the most logical transition.

How To Approach Transitions Questions

When answering transitions questions, you should use the following approach:

1. **Read the entire paragraph. As you read, skip the blank portion.** Do not start plugging in the answer choices during your first read through of the paragraph.
2. **Determine the relationship between the 1st part (before the blank space) and 2nd part of the paragraph (after the blank space).** Is there a contrast? Do the parts before and after agree and argue the same point? Is the 2nd part an example? Or is the 2nd part providing additional information? Use your reading comprehension skills to try to determine the type of transition that is needed.
3. **Look at the answer choices and select the transition that correctly relates the ideas.** If you can determine the relationship between the 1st part and 2nd part correctly, selecting the most logical transition is much easier.
4. **If you cannot determine the relationship between the 1st part and 2nd part of the paragraph on your own, read the answer choices and then reread the paragraph.** After you read the answer choices, you will know the 4 transitions that could be correct. As you reread the paragraph, it should be easier to look for clues in the passage, determine the relationship between the 1st and 2nd part of the paragraph, and select the transition that logically completes the paragraph.
5. **If you still cannot determine the relationship between the 1st and 2nd part of the paragraph, plug the answer choices in and reread the passage.** Select the answer choices that sounds best to you and makes the most sense in the context. Note that this is our last resort for questions that we are really stumped on.

The key to success on transitions questions is using your reading comprehension skills as much as possible! This will help ensure that you are selecting a transition that logically completes the paragraph and not just the transition that sounds/feels best to you.

How NOT To Approach Transitions Questions – 3 Mistakes to Avoid

Want to know the most common mistake students make on transitions questions? They plug the answer choices into the paragraph, read quickly for context (but do not read the entire paragraph), and then select the answer choice that sounds/feels best. This is WRONG for so many reasons.

Mistake #1: Plugging the answers back into the passage right away!

You are smarter than the test! Read the passage, use your comprehension abilities, and determine the type of transition needed. Remember, you are being tested on your reading comprehension skills, so if you do not read, you are much more likely to answer transitions questions incorrectly.

Okay, let's say you assume that you avoid Mistake #1. You read the entire paragraph and determine the relationship. Where else do students go wrong?

Mistake #2: Selecting transitions that you are comfortable with.

Students often make the mistake of selecting transitions that they are comfortable with using because they sound better to them. When answering transitions questions, it is important to **be very picky when selecting the most logical transition**. You need to make sure that you are selecting the transition that actually completes the paragraph, not just the one that you are most comfortable with using.

Mistake #3: Not selecting transitions that you would not use in your writing.

Students often avoid selecting transitions like “thus” or “indeed” or “whereas” because these transitions are less commonly used and sound funny to them. However, these less commonly used transitions can be (and often are) correct on the SAT. We will learn how to properly use these less commonly used transitions in the rest of this chapter.

To see how mistakes #2 and #3 can occur, let's consider the example below:

Why do families in Florida continue buying real Christmas trees when fake trees are much more affordable? Tradition plays the largest role, according to psychologists. For many, the process of going to the tree farm, picking out the perfect tree, and bringing the natural scent into their homes is an irreplaceable holiday tradition. _____ the environmental impact is a consideration for some, as real trees are biodegradable, which can be seen as a sustainable choice compared to the purchase of a fake, plastic tree.

1. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?
- A) After all,
- B) For example,
- C) However,
- D) Further,

For this question, the 1st part of the paragraph is discussing why families continue to buy real Christmas trees. The sentence before the transition gives a reason why families choose a real tree. The sentence after the transition also provides an additional reason why families choose a real tree, so we need an additive transition that provides additional support. The only additive transition is “further,” so the answer is D. Many students are not comfortable with using “further” (since it is not a commonly used transition) and instead select one of the other answer choices.

Categories of Transitions

Below, we have listed the most common transitions. We have divided these transitions into categories based on the type of relationship between the ideas of the connected sentences.

Additive Transitions – providing additional support or evidence:

additionally	further	moreover
again	furthermore	of course
also	in addition	then
as well	indeed	what is more
besides	in fact	

Resulting Transitions – connecting an issue to the consequences:

accordingly	for that reason	therefore
as a result	hence	then
because	in order to	thus
consequently	since	to this/that end

Contrasting Transitions – connecting two things by focusing on their differences:

after all	however	otherwise
although	in contrast	rather
at the same time	in spite of	regardless
besides	instead	still
but	meanwhile	though
by contrast	nevertheless	yet
conversely	nonetheless	whereas
despite this	on the contrary	
even so	on the other hand	

Agreement/Similar Transitions – connecting two things by focusing on their similarities:

also	in fact	likewise
by the same token	indeed	of course
correspondingly	just as	similarly

Summary Transitions – providing a summary of the ideas in the previous sentence(s):

after all	in other words	thus
briefly	in short	to conclude
finally	in sum	to summarize
in conclusion	in the end	ultimately

Example Transitions – linking a general idea to a specific example of this idea:

for example	in this case	specifically
for instance	namely	

Sequential Transitions – connecting sentences based on when events occur:

after	finally	recently
at last	first	so far
before	following	soon
currently	later	subsequently
during	meanwhile	then
earlier	now	today
eventually	next	while

Emphasis Transitions – providing additional emphasis on what the previous sentence(s) said:

above all	in fact	truly
clearly	of course	
indeed	obviously	

Clarification Transitions – providing clarification on what the previous sentence(s) claimed:

especially	particularly	that is
in other words	specifically	

Chapter 12 Practice:

1. The torrential downpours from last night soaked the soccer fields. _____, the tournament was rescheduled for next weekend with hopes that the fields will dry in time.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) However,
- B) Alternatively,
- C) Consequently,
- D) In addition,

2. Many species of predatory fish have developed a long, sleek body to cut through the water. _____ many species of eagles can tuck their wings to become very aerodynamic and dart through the air.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) At the same time,
- B) For instance,
- C) In contrast,
- D) Similarly,

3. Certain tech companies go to extremes to ensure that employees enjoy being at the workplace. _____ Google provides workers with free meals, a full gym, and e-bikes.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Therefore,
- B) For instance,
- C) In spite of this,
- D) More generally,

4. I used to think that there were no hummingbirds in New York. When my mother put out a hummingbird feeder, _____ I was immediately proven wrong, as hummingbirds arrived the next day to start feeding on the sugar water.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) however,
- B) as a result,
- C) meanwhile,
- D) on the other hand,

5. Dialect coaches help actors design the voice and speech of a character for film. Leith McPherson, the supervising dialect coach on "The Lord of the Rings: The Rings of Power," always starts his training with vowels. _____ McPherson teaches his clients how to move on to conquering what he calls "the connection between words," those nonlinguistic utterances, such as "ah" and "um," in which native accents can inadvertently surface.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Specifically,
- B) In summary,
- C) Accordingly,
- D) Later,

6. Duke Ellington was an American jazz pianist, composer, and leader of his eponymous jazz orchestra for over 50 years. Ellington wrote or collaborated on more than one thousand compositions and is considered the most influential jazz musician of all time. _____ Ellington has two prominent arts schools named after him and was the first African American to appear by himself on a circulating coin.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Actually,
- B) Moreover,
- C) Regardless,
- D) Similarly,

7. The Nineteenth Amendment to the US Constitution, ratified in 1920, granted women the right to vote. This landmark amendment marked a significant milestone in the fight for gender equality and the suffrage movement. _____ this amendment led to women being elected to political offices.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Instead,
- B) Specifically,
- C) For example,
- D) Ultimately,

8. The city of Milan, Italy underwent a significant expansion of their public transportation system with the addition of two new metro lines recently in 2022. _____ the public transportation system will likely need to undertake further additions as the city's population increases and new neighborhoods develop.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Still,
- B) Namely,
- C) After all,
- D) Instead,

9. College graduates who work for Teach For America, which places top college graduates in high-need schools and communities, earn less than their classmates who graduate and take jobs in consulting or banking, but the Teach For America experience is very rewarding in other ways. Teach For America allows graduates to make significant impacts in communities and schools. _____ Teach For America provides free professional development opportunities for their teachers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) However,
- B) To that end,
- C) Nevertheless,
- D) What's more,

10. When creating sculptures, renowned artist Michael Stevens typically sculpts each piece by hand, meticulously shaping and refining the details. _____ for his large-scale public installation, he opted to use 3D printing technology to replicate the sculptures, resulting in a loss of the unique craftsmanship and imperfections that often give his works a distinctive character.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Thus,
- B) Nevertheless,
- C) Likewise,
- D) In addition,

11. In an attempt to save the restaurant, Richard launched a new promotion for free samples every Thursday. His goal was to get new customers. _____ he would change the free sample theme to keep people coming back and attract new customers each week.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) To this end,
- B) In fact,
- C) For a time,
- D) Surprisingly,

12. Outside of a zoo, seeing a leopard is very rare. Leopards are reclusive creatures that commonly hunt in the cover of darkness and are most active at night and, as zoologist Martha Winmore says, "if there is a leopard nearby, the leopard can see you but you can't see it." _____ humans see leopards in the wild, but these sightings usually last just a few moments.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Occasionally,
- B) Sparsely,
- C) To this point,
- D) Eventually,

13. Jessica Florenstein, a paleontologist at the Natural History Museum in Washington D.C., has worked to dispel many of the myths around the scientific community's understanding of the dodo. _____ the dodo has been depicted as a physically incapable bird with no brains and barely functioning wings, but Florenstein has shown that the dodo was far more capable than those depictions would suggest.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) For that reason,
- B) Traditionally,
- C) In fact,
- D) Instead,

14. Application testing simply cannot keep pace with market demand for new applications. _____ companies are faced with a dilemma: go to market with abbreviated testing and risk a poor product or complete comprehensive testing and risk being too late to market.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) More specifically,
- B) In short,
- C) Thus,
- D) Despite this,

15. If bugs in software are found early in the design phase, engineers do not need to waste time combing through thousands of lines of code looking for the sources of the errors. _____ engineers can quickly isolate and fix any existing issues and more consistently meet deadlines for their projects.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) As a result,
- B) At last,
- C) Further,
- D) In spite of this,

16. Scientists had long considered the Andes to be the longest mountain range on earth, measuring 5,530 miles long. _____ in 2003, scientists discovered the mid-ocean ridge system, a mountain range that stretches for an incredible 40,000 miles across the sea floor.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Moreover,
- B) However,
- C) Consequently,
- D) Furthermore,

17. Betta fish are known as one of the prettiest and easiest fish to take care of. _____ these fish can breathe oxygen directly from the air above the bowl and can live happily in very small tanks.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Indeed,
- B) Next,
- C) Lately,
- D) For instance,

18. Jeremy Bentham and other proponents of Utilitarianism, an ethical theory that prioritizes decisions that maximize the overall happiness, or utility, for the greatest number of people, argue that the wellbeing of an individual is unimportant. _____ critics argue that utilitarianism overlooks individual rights and considerations of justice, as it focuses solely on aggregate welfare.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Additionally,
- B) Yet,
- C) By the same token,
- D) Specifically,

19. Archeologists have long debated how the Easter Island's giant statues were moved across the island. In the 1960s, the accepted theory was that the statues "walked" as workers swiveled and rocked them back and forth. _____ the theory is the statues were moved by a complex system of wooden rollers and supports after a recent archeological discovery was made.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Still,
- B) Conversely,
- C) Currently,
- D) In comparison,

20. Golf enthusiast and writer Jon Sherman admits his ambitions were not very high when he first started his website Practical Golf, which was created as a fun side project to provide an honest, statistically backed resource for everyday golfers trying to improve. Every golf professional has their own site or social media page. _____ his site has become an essential resource for many professional coaches looking to learn more about statistically supported methods of improvement.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Therefore,
- B) Finally,
- C) Nevertheless,
- D) Additionally,

21. The word “robot” was first used to denote a fictional humanoid in a 1920 Czech-language play R.U.R (Rossumovi Univerzalni Robiti) by Karel Capek; _____ it was Karel’s brother Josef Capek who was the word’s true inventor.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) ultimately,
- B) though,
- C) therefore,
- D) at last,

22. When observing the towering Mount Fuji in Japan from a distance, you can easily notice its distinct cone-shaped peak rising high into the sky. _____ Mount Fuji belongs to the category known as stratovolcanoes, characterized by their steep sides and conical structures, which result from alternating layers of volcanic ash, lava, and pyroclastic material.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Fittingly,
- B) However,
- C) Second,
- D) Regardless,

23. Paleontologists study ancient fossils to understand how life, landscapes, and the climate have changed over time. However, many fossils are fragile and susceptible to degradation when exposed to air or handled improperly. _____ paleontologists like Dr. Alpheus Hyatt are developing techniques such as freeze-drying and encapsulation to better preserve fossils.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Specifically,
- B) Likewise,
- C) Hence,
- D) Meanwhile,

24. During an expedition in the Sahara Desert in 1817, Dr. Anders Frost made a remarkable discovery. As he sifted through the layers of sand, he found glassy tubes. These tubes were formed when lightning struck the ground, generating an intense surge of heat that instantly melted the surrounding sand. _____ the cooled sand fused together, creating peculiar glass structures.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Subsequently,
- B) Therefore,
- C) Additionally,
- D) Meanwhile,

25. Many plant species have developed ingenious mechanisms to survive in arid environments. The resurrection plant (*Selaginella lepidophylla*), _____ can enter a state of desiccation tolerance, curling up into a tight ball when water is scarce. In this state, the plant can survive for years without water, only to revive and resume growth when moisture becomes available.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) for instance,
- B) in contrast,
- C) accordingly,
- D) however,

26. Traditionally, medical breakthroughs were often the work of lone heroes, but an intriguing trend has emerged – a shift towards collaboration. _____ co-authored medical publications have been observed, indicating a profound transformation in the way medical professionals now approach their work.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Increasingly,
- B) Accordingly,
- C) Furthermore,
- D) Similarly,

27. The Egyptian Pharaoh Ramses II reigned for over 60 years and left an indelible mark on the history of ancient Egypt. He led numerous military campaigns, expanding Egyptian territory and fortifying its borders. Today, _____ he is mainly remembered for his architectural endeavors, most notably the Ramessuem and the temples of Abu Simbel.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) though,
- B) of course,
- C) for example,
- D) consequently,

28. The head chef of the world's #1 restaurant in 2023, Virgilio Martínez Véliz, creates a dining experience based on the different ecosystems throughout Peru. He considers the trips he takes to the different ecosystems for research to be their own reward. _____ Martínez Véliz admits to finding the research phase of his work just as gratifying as the execution of the dishes in his restaurant.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) In contrast,
- B) Besides,
- C) In fact,
- D) Subsequently,

29. In 1928, British bacteriologist Alexander Fleming discovered that a mold called *Penicillium notatum* could kill bacteria, an observation that would forever change the field of medicine. _____ it was widely believed that there were no effective means to combat bacterial infections.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) After all,
- B) Thus,
- C) Previously,
- D) Similarly,

30. Ernest Hemingway (1899-1961) varied his narrative techniques based on the literary form he was producing. In his novels, he used a sparse style to focus on the narrative; in his short stories, _____ he often explored more verbose structures to delve into the complexities of the human experience.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) moreover,
- B) instead,
- C) consequently,
- D) specifically,

31. Janet Cho, a marine biologist, found that sharks and other predators decreasing in number results in implications that reverberate through the food chain. _____ the prey of those predators are flourishing and according to Cho this is resulting in a tragic cascade of effects throughout their ecosystems.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) However,
- B) Specifically,
- C) Likewise,
- D) Rather,

32. In a contentious debate in astrophysics, the community is split between two competing explanations of cosmological behavior: dark matter theory and modified gravity. _____ there are those who assert that the presence of unseen dark matter is the key to explaining the gravitational anomalies observed in the universe and those who contend that these anomalies can be better explained by modifications to Newtonian gravity and General Relativity.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) That is,
- B) Contrastingly,
- C) Likewise,
- D) Additionally,

33. During the Renaissance, artists in Italy began to adopt more realistic and human-centered approaches to their artwork, focusing on naturalism and individual expression. _____ French Renaissance artists continued to incorporate significant religious symbolism and detailed textures in their paintings.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Consequently,
- B) Later,
- C) Furthermore,
- D) Meanwhile,

34. In her novel "Beloved," Toni Morrison intertwines personal stories with historical events. Morrison portrays Sethe's journey from slavery to freedom in the aftermath of the Civil War, integrating it with the broader context of the abolitionist movement. _____ author Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie in her novel "Half of a Yellow Sun" connects the stories of her characters struggles to the events of the Nigerian-Biafran war.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Regardless,
- B) Particularly,
- C) Likewise,
- D) Hence,

35. In the field of medicine, when a patient's heart experiences irregular electrical activity, one treatment option is to implant an artificial pacemaker, which delivers electrical pulses to regulate its beats, ensuring proper function. _____ medication can be prescribed to control the heart's electrical activity and restore normal rhythm, providing a non-invasive approach to managing the condition.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A) Alternatively,
- B) Consequently,
- C) Furthermore,
- D) For example,

Part 3:

Notes

On each SAT Reading and Writing Test, there are 3-8 Notes questions. For notes questions, you are given a series of notes and asked to select which answer choice accomplishes a certain goal the student want to achieve.

In Part 3 of this course, we will teach you how to effectively approach notes questions, so you can quickly and confidently answer these questions correctly.

Chapter 13: Notes

Notes questions give you notes that a student has taken while researching a topic and ask you to select a sentence that accomplishes a certain goal. While notes questions look intimidating at first, they are actually very straightforward to answer correctly once you learn how to approach them. On the Digital SAT, notes questions always look like this:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Iris Scott is an American artist and professional finger painter.
- In 2010, she recognized her fingers could scoop paint better than brushes and committed to painting with only her fingers.
- Scott now exclusively works as an oil finger painter.
- In 2019, her show *Ritual in Pairing* displayed ten of her paintings.
- One of her paintings in the show *Wychwood* depicts a tree.

The student wants to describe why Iris Scott decided to become a finger painter. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. After recognizing that her fingers could scoop paint better than brushes, American artist Iris Scott decided to work exclusively as an oil finger painter.
- B. Professional finger painter Iris Scott displayed ten of her oil finger paintings in her 2019 show *Ritual in Pairing*.
- C. In 2019, Iris Scott displayed ten of her finger paintings, including *Wychwood*, which depicts a tree, in her show *Ritual in Pairing*.
- D. American artist and professional finger painter Iris Scott paints work exclusively as an oil finger painter.

How To Approach Notes Questions

For notes questions, you should use one of the 2 approaches below. You should try both approaches and find which one works best for you.

Approach #1 – The Shortcut Method

1. **Read the first sentence of the question and identify exactly WHAT the question is asking you.** This is always clearly stated in the first sentence. You do not need to read the second sentence, as the second sentence always reads “which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal.”
2. **Read the answer choices.** As you read each answer choice, ask yourself, “does this sentence accomplish the goal the question is asking for?” **Always make sure that you read all 4 answer choices.**
3. **Eliminate answer choices that are clearly incorrect.** At this point, you will likely know what answer choice is correct or will have narrowed it down to two answer choices. If you are unsure of which answer choice is correct, we can reassess the answer choices after step 4.
4. **Read the student’s notes to confirm your answer is correct.** If you already knew which answer choice was correct in step 3, reading the notes will help you be even more confident that you have found the correct answer. If you were unsure of which answer choice is correct in step 3, you can reassess the answer choices after reading the notes.
5. **If you are in a rush, you can skip step 4 when you feel confident in your answer.** We always recommend reading the notes, but if you are tight on time, you can skip this step if you feel confident that you already know which answer choice is correct in step 3.

Overall, the shortcut method is most effective for students who can do a great job in step 1. If you can effectively identify exactly WHAT the question is asking you, determining why answer choices are correct or incorrect becomes easy.

Approach #2 – The Notes Reader

1. **Read the first sentence of the question and identify exactly WHAT the question is asking you.** This is always clearly stated in the first sentence. You do not need to read the second sentence, as the second sentence always reads “which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal.”
2. **Read the student’s notes. Identify the notes that are related to the goal that you are being asked to accomplish.** You should also identify notes that are not related to the goal that you are being asked to accomplish. Of course, the notes that are related should be included in the correct answer, while the notes that are not related should not be included.
3. **Reread the question to make sure you know exactly WHAT the question is asking.** We know this step is repetitive, but it is important to make sure that you are 100% clear on what you are looking for as you assess each answer choice. It is easy to forget exactly what the question is asking after reading all the student’s notes.
4. **Read the answer choices.** As you read each answer choice, ask yourself, “does this sentence accomplish the goal the question is asking for?” If the answer choice does not accomplish the goal, eliminate it and move on. If you are confident in your answer choice, select your answer and move on. **Always make sure that you read all 4 answer choices.**
5. **If you are unsure which answer choice is correct, reread the notes and reread the question.** After rereading the notes and question, reassess the answer choices and select the answer choice you think is correct.

What Notes Questions Are NOT Testing You On

As you are starting to see, notes questions are very straightforward. **Your job on these questions is to identify exactly what the question is asking you and select the answer choice that does that.** However, with all the information that is included in notes questions, students love to make these questions more complicated than they are.

When answering Notes questions, it is important to make sure that you the following 2 principles:

1. **You are NOT being tested on grammar.** Never consider grammar rules as you assess the answer choices on notes questions.
2. **You do NOT need to check if the answer choices match the notes.** The answer choices always correctly include the information included in the notes. You do not need to waste time fact checking each answer choice to see if it matches the information provided in the student’s notes.

TIP – Don’t Overthink It. Just Answer the Question!

For notes questions, your job is only to answer the question that the SAT is asking. It’s that simple! We cannot stress this enough. As long as you approach these questions correctly, they should be easy.

This is particularly important for the questions about specific details. For example, if the questions says, “the student wants to emphasize the colors of autumn,” pick the answer choice that emphasizes the colors of autumn. For the majority of the notes questions, it’s really that easy!

The 6 Common Types of Notes Questions

Now that we know how to approach notes questions, we are going to learn about the 6 common goals that you will be asked to accomplish in notes questions. The 6 types of notes questions are listed below:

1. **Accomplish a Specific Goal**
2. **Emphasize a Difference/Similarity**
3. **Present a Study**
4. **Already Familiar With**
5. **Unfamiliar With/New Audience**
6. **Generalization**

For all 6 types of notes question, we use the same approach. In the rest of this chapter, we will learn some more tips that you can apply for each type to make sure you answer them correctly on test day.

Accomplish a Specific Goal

The most common type of notes question asks you to accomplish a specific goal. For these questions, the first sentence most often begins with one of the following phrases in bold below:

- The student **wants to emphasize** the role of color in parrotfish's social structure.
- The student **wants to describe** how the machine creates a perfect sphere.
- The student **wants to identify** why Panama stopped exporting bananas.
- The student **wants to specify** the reason why Motocross was created.
- The student **wants to explain** the inspiration for the art exhibition's name.
- The student **wants to provide** a quote from Severo Ochoa to explain how he discovered tRNA.

As you can see with the examples above, the phrase is followed by the specific goal the student wants to accomplish. In general, **accomplish a specific goal notes questions are usually easier.** Let's try one of these questions with the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Iridium is a rare and expensive metal.
- It is used in spark plugs because of its high melting point.
- Spark plugs usually require a large amount of iridium to be effective.
- Researcher Nabiha Sharma created a new spark plug that combines iridium with osmium.
- Sharma's new spark plug was highly effective and required small amounts of iridium (9.1% of the atoms in the mixture).

The student wants to explain an advantage of the new spark plug developed by Nabiha Sharma. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. Like other spark plugs, the new spark plug requires a particular amount of iridium to be effective.
- B. While still highly effective, the new spark plug requires far less of the rare and expensive metal than do normal spark plugs.
- C. Researcher Nabiha Sharma created a new spark plug that combines iridium, a rare and expensive metal, with osmium.
- D. Iridium is a rare and expensive metal that is used in spark plugs; however, normal spark plugs typically require a large amount of iridium to be effective.

Emphasize a Difference/Similarity

Notes questions commonly ask you to select the answer choice which emphasizes a difference or similarity between two things in the notes. Again, these questions should be easy as long as you make sure to look for a difference/similarity as you read the answer choices.

To see how notes questions ask you to emphasize a difference/similarity, let's consider the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Lava flows are streams of molten rock that pour or ooze from an erupting vent.
- Pāhoehoe lava flow has a smooth, billowy, or ropy surface.
- It has lower viscosity and is less common.
- 'A'ā lava flow has rough and jagged surface.
- It has a higher viscosity and is the most common type of lava flow.

The student wants to emphasize a difference between the two lava flows. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. Pāhoehoe lava flow and 'A'ā lava flow are two different types of lava flows.
- B. Pāhoehoe lava flow is less common and has a lower viscosity, while 'A'ā lava flow is more common and has a higher viscosity.
- C. Lava flows can have a variety of surface textures, ranging from a smooth, billowy surface to a rough, jagged surface.
- D. 'A'ā lava flow, which has a higher viscosity and a rough, jagged surface, is the most common type of lava flow.

Present a Study

Notes questions often include notes from a study. For these questions, it is important to identify what aspects of the study the question wants you to include. Some common first sentences for "Present a Study" notes questions are below:

1. The student wants to present **the primary aim of the research study**.
2. The student wants to present **the study and its findings/conclusions**.
3. The student wants to present **the study's results**.
4. The student wants to present **the study's design**.
5. The student wants to present **the study's methods**.

Of course, there are many more goals the SAT can ask you to accomplish when dealing with notes from a study. What is important is that you identify the right part(s) of the study when answering the question.

If the question asks for the study's results, we must include the results in the answer choice. Any answer choices that do not include the results are wrong. If the question instead asks for the primary aim, select the answer choice that include the aim. It's that simple!

To see how “Present a Study” notes questions work, try the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- From 2008-2013, Francesca Reinero and Emilio Sperone studied bait-attracted great white sharks at South Africa’s Dyer Island Nature Reserve.
- The study was designed to find out if great white sharks were most strongly attracted to tuna bait or a seal-shaped decoy.
- They simultaneously dragged tuna bait and a seal-shaped decoy behind a boat in known great white shark feeding areas and recorded which one sharks attacked.
- With calm sea conditions, sharks chose the energetically richer prey, the seal-shaped decoy, over the tuna bait.
- With poor sea conditions, sharks were less likely to select the seal-shaped decoy over the tuna bait.

The student wants to present the study’s design. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. Great white sharks in the study selected the seal-shaped decoy more often with calm sea conditions and less often with poor sea conditions.
- B. From 2008-2013, researchers studied bait-attracted great white sharks to determine if the sharks had a preference between tuna bait and a seal-shaped decoy.
- C. To determine the great white shark’s preference between a seal-shaped decoy and tuna bait, researchers dragged both items behind a boat and recorded which one the sharks attacked.
- D. In calm sea conditions, sharks were more likely to attack the seal-shaped decoy, since seals are more energy rich, when both a seal-shaped decoy and tuna bait were dragged behind the boat.

Advanced Notes Questions

For the first 3 types of notes questions, your job is pretty simple: answer the question that the SAT is asking. The next 3 types of notes questions are more advanced and require a bit more thinking.

Already Familiar With

“Already Familiar With” notes questions ask you to accomplish a certain goal with an audience familiar with a certain topic. For example, the first sentence for these questions can look like this:

1. The student wants to explain the bottle design to an audience familiar with Will Plank. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

For this example, we want to select the answer choice that explains the bottle design but does NOT explain who Will Plank is because the question tells us the audience is already familiar with Will Plank. Any answer choice that explains who Will Plank is incorrect.

For “Already Familiar With” notes questions, **the correct answer will not include detailed information about the topic that the audience is familiar with.** Since the audience is already familiar with the topic, we do not need any explanation that defines who or what the topic is.

To see how “Already Familiar With” notes questions work, try the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Carbon-14 dating is a scientific method that can accurately determine the age of organic materials.
- Organic materials are matter that has come from living organisms.
- By measuring how much carbon-14 remains in an object, archaeologists can estimate the age of remains of humans and animals.
- Dr. Albert Jenks used carbon-14 dating on the remains of a skeleton discovered in Minnesota in 1976.
- He concluded the remains were about 8,000 years old, making the skeleton the oldest known human remains discovered in the United States.

The student wants to summarize the findings to an audience familiar with carbon-14 dating. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. Carbon-14 dating can be used to determine the age of organic materials, which are made up of matter from living organisms.
- B. Dr. Albert Jenks used carbon-14 dating to conclude that a skeleton discovered in Minnesota in 1976 was approximately 8,000 years old.
- C. Using Carbon-14 dating, a scientific method that measures carbon-14 remains in an object to determine the age of organic materials, Dr. Albert Jenks concluded that the skeleton discovered in Minnesota was about 8,000 years old.
- D. An analysis of the remaining carbon-14 can be used to accurately determine the age of organic material whose age is otherwise difficult to estimate, such as human remains.

Unfamiliar With/New Audience

“Unfamiliar With/New Audience” notes questions ask you to accomplish a certain goal with an audience unfamiliar with a certain topic or to a new audience. For example, the first sentence for these questions can look like this:

1. The student wants to describe why the team selects aluminum wire to an audience unfamiliar with conductivity. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

For this example, we want to select the answer choice that explains why the team selects aluminum wire AND what conductivity is because the question tells us the audience is unfamiliar with conductivity. Any answer choice that assumes the reader understands conductivity is incorrect.

For “Unfamiliar With/New Audience” notes questions, **the correct answer must include detailed information about the topic that the audience is unfamiliar with.** Since the audience is unfamiliar with the topic, we need to select an answer choice that includes a definition for who or what the topic is.

To see how “Unfamiliar With/New Audience” notes questions work, try the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Biologist Emily Choy studies the ecological impacts of glacial melt.
- Glacial melt is the water that flows from glaciers as they melt.
- This water delivers nutrients to lakes, rivers, and oceans.
- These nutrients drive blooms of phytoplankton, the base of the aquatic and marine food chain.
- There are more than 230 species of phytoplankton.

The student wants to introduce the scientist and her field of study to a new audience. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. As Emily Choy knows well, glacial melt drives blooms of phytoplankton, providing the base to the aquatic and marine food chain.
- B. Biologist Emily Choy studies the ecological impacts of glacial melt, nutrient rich water that flows from glaciers as they melt.
- C. Glacial melt, nutrient rich water that flows from glaciers as they melt, delivers essential nutrients to lakes, rivers, and oceans.
- D. With more than 230 species, phytoplankton act as the base of the aquatic and marine food chain.

Generalization

“Generalization” notes questions ask you to make a generalization about a specific topic. For example, the first sentence for these questions can look like this:

1. The student wants to make a generalization about house plants. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

For this example, we want to select the answer choice that makes a broader statement (a generalization) about house plants. Any answer choice that includes specific details or data about house plants is incorrect because generalizations do not include specifics.

For “Generalization” notes questions, **the correct answer choice must be a broader statement.** As you read the answer choices, look for answer choices making broader statements (generalizations). **Any answer choice that includes specific information from the notes will be incorrect,** as a generalization by definition must be general.

To see how “Generalization” notes questions work, try the following example:

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- A triathlon is an endurance race consisting of swimming, cycling, and running in that order.
- The Ironman triathlon consists of a 2.4-mile swim, a 112-mile bicycle ride, and a 22.6 mile run for a total of 137 miles.
- The Olympic triathlon is a 1-mile swim, a 24.8-mile bicycle ride, and a 6.2-mile run, a total of 32 miles.
- A popular triathlon is a sprint triathlon, which is half the length of an Olympic triathlon.

The student wants to make a generalization about triathlons. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from notes to accomplish this goal?

- A. While the Ironman triathlon covers 137 miles, an Olympic triathlon covers 32 miles.
- B. Triathlons range widely in length, from less than 20 total miles to over 125 miles.
- C. Examples of triathlon lengths includes 137-mile Ironman, 32-mile Olympic, and 16-mile sprint.
- D. A sprint triathlon is 16-miles in total, but the Ironman triathlon, at 137-miles, is far longer.

Chapter 13 Practice:

1. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Penicillin was the world's first true antibiotic, discovered by Alexander Fleming in 1928.
- Biochemist Dorothy Hodgkin used X-ray crystallography to determine the molecular structure of penicillin.
- Hodgkin's work was essential to understanding how penicillin works at a molecular level.
- Her detailed analysis enabled chemists to synthesize and mass-produce penicillin.
- The widespread availability of penicillin during World War II saved countless lives.

The student wants to highlight how penicillin was able to be mass produced. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Alexander Fleming's discovery of penicillin in 1928 led to its mass production.
- B) Dorothy' Hodgkins used X-ray crystallography to build upon Alexander Fleming's discovery of penicillin to determine its molecular structure.
- C) Dorothy Hodgkin's discovery of the molecular structure of penicillin enabled chemists to synthesize and mass-produce it.
- D) Alexander Fleming discovered penicillin, the world's first true antibiotic, which saved countless lives.

2. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Early humans from the Neolithic period (roughly 8,000 B.C. to 3,000 B.C.) were suspected to have limited diets.
- Initially, there was uncertainty about whether these humans were predominantly meat-eaters or vegetarians.
- Dr. Emma Richardson's 2019 research used dental calculus to study the diets of humans from 4,000 B.C. in Southwestern Europe.
- Dental calculus uses isotope analysis of calcified dental plaque to identify dietary patterns.
- The analysis revealed a balanced diet, suggesting that humans from the Neolithic period were omnivorous.

The student wants to present the findings of the study to an audience unfamiliar with dental calculus. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Dr. Emma Richardson used dental calculus to conclude that humans from the Neolithic period were omnivorous.
- B) Dr. Emma Richardson's study aimed to identify whether humans from the Neolithic period were predominantly meat-eaters or vegetarians.
- C) Dental calculus is used to trace dietary patterns by analyzing calcified dental plaque.
- D) Dr. Emma Richardson discovered that humans from the Neolithic period were omnivorous by using dental calculus, which uses isotope analysis of calcified plaque to trace dietary patterns.

3. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Manhattan Project was a secret U.S. project during World War II to develop the atomic bomb.
- Physicist J. Robert Oppenheimer was the scientific director of the project.
- Chemist Lise Meitner, although not directly involved, made pivotal contributions to nuclear fission research.
- Oppenheimer led the project's scientific efforts, whereas Meitner's theoretical work laid the groundwork for the project's success.

The student wishes to contrast the specific contributions of Oppenheimer and Meitner to the Manhattan project. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Oppenheimer and Meitner both contributed to the atomic bomb's development, but in different capacities.
- B) While Oppenheimer was the scientific director the Manhattan Project, Meitner's research in nuclear fission was crucial to its underlying science.
- C) J. Robert Oppenheimer and Lise Meitner played key roles in the atomic bomb development, with Oppenheimer leading the project and Meitner providing essential research.
- D) The Manhattan Project benefited from both Oppenheimer's leadership and Meitner's foundational research in nuclear science.

4. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The civil rights movement led to significant changes in the U.S. education system in the 1950s and 1960s.
- Thurgood Marshall, as a lawyer, argued the landmark *Brown v. Board of Education* case, which eliminated segregated schools across the United States.
- Educator and activist Septima Clark developed citizenship schools throughout Charleston County in South Carolina that empowered African Americans through literacy.
- Marshall's legal work fought segregation in courts, while Clark's grassroots education efforts fostered empowerment and activism.

The student wants to emphasize a difference in Marshall and Clark's roles in educational civil rights. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Both Marshall and Clark made vital contributions to education in the civil rights era.
- B) Thurgood Marshall's legal battles and Septima Clark's citizenship schools each played a role in transforming educational rights.
- C) While Marshall challenged educational segregation legally and changed the educational landscape across the country, Clark focused on literacy and empowerment at the community level.
- D) The fight for educational equality required Marshall and Clark to each take on their separate challenges.

5. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The U.S. environmental movement gained momentum in the 1960s and 1970s, leading to significant legislation.
- Senator Gaylord Nelson founded Earth Day in 1970, which raised public awareness about environmental issues.
- Environmentalist Rachel Carson's book "Silent Spring" spurred widespread concern about pesticide use.
- Nelson's Earth Day initiative mobilized public action, while Carson's writings influenced policy change.

The student wants to emphasize a similarity of the impacts of Nelson and Carson on environmental legislation. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Both Nelson and Carson were key figures in the environmental movement, Nelson through Earth Day and Carson through her writing.
- B) Senator Nelson's Earth Day raised public awareness about environmental issues and mobilized public action.
- C) While Nelson's Earth Day brought environmental issues to the public's attention, Carson's work led to legislative change.
- D) Senator Gaylord Nelson's Earth Day and environmentalist Rachel Carson's book "Silent Spring" both increased the public's awareness of environmental issues.

6. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Singapore is renowned for integrating green spaces into its urban landscape.
- One challenge has been the urban heat island effect, where built-up areas are significantly warmer than surrounding rural areas.
- To combat this, the city has implemented extensive rooftop gardens and vertical greenery.
- These green spaces help to absorb heat, reduce energy consumption required for cooling, and improve air quality.
- Singapore's approach has become a model for sustainable urban development in tropical climates.

The student wants to focus on Singapore's efforts to mitigate the urban heat island effect. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Singapore's commitment to green spaces in its urban landscape has enhanced the city's sustainability and livability.
- B) The introduction of rooftop gardens and vertical greenery in Singapore addresses the urban heat island effect by cooling the city and improving air quality.
- C) Singapore's use of green spaces in its urban landscape has become a model for other cities.
- D) The urban heat island effect, where urbanized areas become warmer, requires innovative methods to make cities cooler.

7. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- In the early 20th century, Bessie Coleman broke barriers by becoming the first African American woman to earn a pilot's license.
- Coleman had to travel to France to receive her training, as no flight school in the United States would accept her due to her race and gender.
- Upon her return, she became the first female air show pilot, known for her daring maneuvers.
- Coleman was a pioneering figure in aviation, inspiring many women and African Americans to pursue flying.
- Her legacy as a trailblazer in aviation continues to be celebrated today.

The student aims to highlight Coleman's groundbreaking achievements in aviation. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Coleman traveled to France to learn to fly and became a renowned air show pilot upon her return to the United States.
- B) Bessie Coleman was not only the first African American woman to earn a pilot's license but also the first female air show pilot.
- C) Despite the barriers she faced, Coleman became a celebrated pilot and inspired many women and African Americans to pursue flying.
- D) Coleman's accomplishment as the first African American woman pilot remains an inspiring and celebrated part of aviation history.

8. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Gerty Cori was a biochemist who made a significant contribution to our understanding of carbohydrate metabolism.
- She discovered the process of glycogen breakdown in the body, known as the Cori cycle.
- In 1947, Gerty Cori became the first woman to win the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine.
- The Cori cycle was a foundational discovery in the field of biochemistry and influenced subsequent studies on metabolic diseases.
- Gerty Cori's achievements broke barriers for women in science and continue to inspire future generations.

The student aims to underscore Cori's pioneering contribution to science. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Gerty Cori's research on carbohydrate metabolism earned her a Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine.
- B) Cori's groundbreaking work in biochemistry led to significant advancements in understanding metabolic processes.
- C) As the first woman Nobel laureate in her field, Cori's contributions to biochemistry have had a lasting impact.
- D) Cori's discovery of the Cori cycle, how glycogen is broken down in the body, was a foundational discovery in the field of biochemistry.

9. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Chemical pesticides, widely used in agriculture, can have harmful effects on the environment and human health.
- These pesticides often lead to the development of resistant pest species over time.
- Their use can also negatively impact non-target organisms, like pollinators and beneficial insects.
- Biological control methods, using natural predators or parasites of pests, have been suggested as an alternative.
- These biological methods are more sustainable and can maintain ecological balance without the drawbacks of chemical pesticides.

The student wants to outline the benefits of biological control methods. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Chemical pesticides can have many harmful effects on the environment and human health.
- B) Biological control methods use natural predators to manage pests, avoiding the environmental impact of chemical pesticides.
- C) Unlike chemical pesticides, which can harm beneficial insects and lead to resistant pest species, biological control methods maintain ecological balance by using natural predators and parasites.
- D) To mitigate the negative effects of chemical pesticides, biological control methods have been proposed as a sustainable alternative.

10. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Traditional wind turbines are large structures that require significant space and can impact local wildlife.
- These turbines often face opposition due to noise and visual impact on the landscape.
- Traditional turbines are less effective in areas with low wind speeds.
- Bladeless wind turbines, which are smaller and operate silently, have been developed as an alternative with a much lower impact on local wildlife.
- Bladeless turbines use vibrations to generate electricity and are more adaptable to various environments.

The student wants to highlight the benefits of bladeless wind turbines over traditional wind turbines. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Traditional wind turbines can be large and noisy, but bladeless turbines offer a quieter and more adaptable alternative.
- B) Like traditional wind turbines, bladeless wind turbines can have an impact on local wildlife.
- C) Bladeless wind turbines use vibrations to generate electricity.
- D) Traditional wind turbines are large structures that require significant space and can impact local wildlife

11. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Conventional methods to clean up ocean pollution are often time-consuming and labor-intensive.
- These methods can be ineffective at collecting smaller plastic particles and are limited to surface-level debris.
- Current cleanup methods also have the potential to harm marine life.
- Autonomous ocean drones, designed to collect both surface and subsurface debris, have been produced.
- These drones can operate continuously and are equipped to collect a range of pollutant sizes without harming marine ecosystems.

The student aims to emphasize the advantages of autonomous ocean drones. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Traditional cleanup methods can be harmful to marine life and are often labor-intensive.
- B) Autonomous ocean drones have been proposed to improve the efficiency of ocean cleanup by collecting a wider range of pollutants.
- C) Ocean drones, unlike conventional ocean clean up methods, can continuously collect both surface and subsurface debris effectively without harming marine ecosystems.
- D) Conventional ocean cleanup methods are limited, but autonomous drones could revolutionize the process with their advanced capabilities.

12. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Wind farms are increasingly being used to generate clean energy.
- However, wind turbines can pose a threat to flying wildlife, particularly birds and bats.
- To mitigate this, some wind farms have adopted innovative radar systems to detect the presence of birds and bats.
- These systems can temporarily shut down turbines to prevent collisions, reducing wildlife fatalities.
- The integration of radar technology demonstrates a balance between renewable energy production and wildlife conservation.

The student aims to highlight the innovative solution for wildlife protection at wind farms. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) To address the threat that wind turbines pose to wildlife, some farms now use new radar technology to detect and protect flying animals.
- B) Wind farms have become a popular source of renewable energy, but they can pose risks to local wildlife.
- C) Wind farms are increasingly being used to provide a more renewable source of energy production.
- D) Radar systems can be used to detect the presence of birds and bats.

13. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Maya Angelou was a celebrated African American poet and author, active primarily in the latter half of the 20th century.
- She was influenced by the Civil Rights Movement and her own experiences with racial discrimination.
- Angelou's 1969 autobiography "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings" dealt with themes of racial identity and resilience.
- The book became a tool to help later generations learn what it meant to grow up as a young African American girl in the 1930s and 1940s.
- In 2010, the book was recognized by the National Book Foundation for its significant contribution to American literature.

The student wants to introduce the importance of "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings" by Maya Angelou to an audience unfamiliar with her. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Maya Angelou, an influential poet and author, wrote "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings," a book that reflects her experiences with racial discrimination and resilience.
- B) Angelou's "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings," an autobiography about racial identity, was recognized for its contribution to American literature.
- C) A celebrated poet and author in the late 20th century, Maya Angelou became a significant voice in literature for black women.
- D) Celebrated African American poet and author Maya Angelou wrote "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings," a book that has been used to educate generations on the realities of growing up as an African American girl in a society with racial discrimination.

14. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Ella Fitzgerald (1917-1996) was born in Newport News, Virginia, USA.
- At the age of 15, she moved to Harlem, New York.
- Known as the "First Lady of Song," she was one of the most beloved jazz singers in history.
- Her career spanned six decades, during which she won 13 Grammy awards and sold over 40 million albums.
- In 1934, she started her career singing at Harlem's Apollo Theater and initially performed with big bands.
- Her breakthrough came with solo hits like "A-Tisket, A-Tasket" (1938) and her innovative scat singing.

The student wants to begin a narrative about Ella Fitzgerald's career as a singer. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Ella Fitzgerald's legendary status as the "First Lady of Song" had its roots in her humble beginnings in Newport News, Virginia.
- B) In 1934, Ella Fitzgerald, who eventually became a jazz icon and sold over 40 million albums, started her illustrious career performing in big bands and at Harlem's Apollo Theater.
- C) The year 1938 marked a significant milestone in Ella Fitzgerald's career with the release of her breakthrough hit "A-Tisket, A-Tasket."
- D) Before becoming a jazz legend known for her scat singing, Ella Fitzgerald moved from Newport News, Virginia to Harlem.

15. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Sister cities aim to foster mutual understanding and cultural exchange between different communities.
- This movement gained momentum in the United States during the 1950s as a means of encouraging global cooperation.
- Several cities in Oregon have established such partnerships with counterparts across the globe.
- Portland, Oregon, and Bologna, Italy, established a sister city affiliation in 2003 to promote shared interests in urban planning and the arts.

The student wants emphasizes the longevity and purpose of the sister city relationship between Portland and Bologna? Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) As sister cities, Portland, Oregon, and Bologna, Italy, have engaged in cultural exchange and partnership since 2003.
- B) Sister cities such as Portland, Oregon, and Bologna, Italy, have formed since the 1950s with the aim of fostering mutual understanding and cultural exchange.
- C) Despite their distance from each other, Portland, Oregon, and Bologna, Italy, actively participate in exchanges of knowledge about urban development initiatives and the arts.
- D) Bologna, which in 2003 became a sister city to Portland, Oregon, is located in Italy.

16. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Music by Black Composers (MBC) project is an educational resource that highlights the rich heritage of Black classical composers to inspire new artists.
- Samuel Coleridge-Taylor, an eminent composer of African descent, is featured in the MBC's Historic Composers Directory.
- He was born in 1875 and died in 1912
- He studied at the Royal College of Music from the age of 15 and became a professor at the age of 21 at Crystal Palace School of Music
- After becoming a professor, he began composing his own original pieces.
- His compositions, including "Hiawatha's Wedding Feast," remain influential in classical music circles.

The student wants to give an overview of Coleridge-Taylor's life to an audience that is aware of the MBC Project? Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Samuel Coleridge-Taylor (1875-1912) is commemorated in the MBC project for works like "Hiawatha's Wedding Feast."
- B) As cataloged by the MBC project, an educational resource that highlights the heritage of Black classical composers, Samuel Coleridge-Taylor (1875-1912) began studying music at the age of 15.
- C) The MBC project recognizes Samuel Coleridge-Taylor, an artist, professor, and composer born in 1875 and passing in 1912, for his lasting contributions to classical music.
- D) Featured in the MBC project, Samuel Coleridge-Taylor (1875-1912) composed influential classical music pieces such as "Hiawatha's Wedding Feast."

17. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Bodies of water like rivers and lakes with diverse plant life support a wide variety of fish species.
- In such environments, fish populations tend to display higher resilience to environmental changes due to the availability of varied diets and habitats.
- On average, these ecosystems see a lower mortality rate during seasonal transitions compared to more homogenous environments.
- Conversely, fish populations in areas with less diverse plant life, such as overfished waters or polluted lakes, often experience higher stress and mortality rates.

The student wants to make and support a generalization about the health of fish populations based on ecosystem diversity. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Diverse plant life in water bodies is linked to supporting a wide variety of fish species.
- B) Fish in polluted lakes experience higher stress and mortality rates.
- C) The health of fish populations is correlated with the biodiversity of their habitats.
- D) A varied diet and habitat, as found in rivers and lakes with diverse plant life, are crucial for the survival of fish populations through seasonal changes.

18. While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Social media platforms offer various ways for individuals to connect, share, and communicate online.
- Some platforms, like Twitter, emphasize brevity with a character limit for messages, while others, like YouTube allow creators to pick the length of their content.
- Some YouTube Creators only create Shorts, videos which can be a maximum of 60 seconds long.
- Some YouTube Creators create full length films.

The student wants to make generalization about the content shared on YouTube. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

- A) Social media platforms cater to different communication preferences, from the short messages of Twitter to the longer-form content of YouTube.
- B) While some YouTube Creators produce videos lasting 60 seconds or less, others make lengthy films.
- C) The length of a video on YouTube can vary significantly in its length.
- D) Twitter emphasizes brevity while YouTube lacks constraints on its content.

Answer Key

Chapter 1: Sentence Structure

Clauses vs. Phrases Exercise (p. 7):

1. Phrase
2. Independent Clause
3. Independent Clause
4. Dependent Clause
5. Phrase
6. Independent Clause
7. Dependent Clause
8. Independent
9. Phrase
10. Phrase
11. Independent Clause
12. Independent Clause
13. Dependent Clause
14. Independent Clause
15. Dependent Clause
16. Phrase
17. Phrase
18. Dependent Clause
19. Dependent Clause
20. Independent Clause

Sentence Fragments Practice (pp. 10-11):

1. D
2. B
3. A
4. D
5. B
6. D
7. B

Chapter 1 Practice (pp. 12-13)

1. C
2. A
3. D
4. B
5. D
6. C
7. C
8. A
9. B
10. C
11. C
12. B
13. B
14. D
15. C

Compound Sentences Practice (Page 9):

1. B, C
2. A
3. A, B, C
4. A, C
5. B, C
6. A
7. A
8. A

Chapter 2: Commas – 4 Types of Comas

Names Rule Practice (p. 16):

1. No additional commas needed
2. No additional commas needed
3. Eric's mother, Louisa, cheered from the bleachers.
4. No additional commas needed
5. No additional commas needed
6. The CEO of Tesla, Elon Musk, has revolutionized the car industry.
7. No additional commas needed
8. The oldest Hemsworth brother, Luke Hemsworth, starred in HBO's Westworld.

"ing" and "ed" Phrases Practice (p. 18):

1. C
2. A

Prepositional Phrase Practice (p. 19):

1. Before the race began, the team did a final check on the sparkplugs in the engine.
2. Donations for the campaign in Georgia broke records during the 2020 election.
3. The luxury dog bed with the ornate frame and supportive memory foam seems a bit excessive to me.
4. During the movie, Davonta's mother, after running out of candy, went to the concession stand for some popcorn.
5. At the corner, the host stood with a microphone in her hand.

Punctuation for Transitional Words and Phrases Like "However Practice (p. 21):

1. B
2. B
3. B
4. C
5. C
6. D

Commas Practice (p. 23):

1. Although James demanded pizza for dinner, his mother decided to make grilled chicken and broccoli instead.
2. Mr. Alvin, a very popular teacher among the students, cancelled the final exam.
3. I could not believe that Deadpool was such a popular movie.
4. While my friend Mary thought that dolphins were the fastest animals in water, she was surprised to learn it was actually a sailfish.
5. Owls, notorious for their amazing night vision, have fantastic hearing at night, so they can actually hear their prey from hundreds of feet away even if they cannot see it.
6. On second thought, the real reason that I did not like Scott was his lack of honesty.
7. Some cultures, though, enjoy bizarre foods like bugs or snakes.
8. After graduating, Darren played for the San Diego Padres, where he had a long career as a relief pitcher.
9. Because he was the best in Dallas, award-winning head chef Phillip Small owned multiple very successful restaurants.
10. My favorite author is J.K. Rowling, who is famous for writing the Harry Potter series.
11. The fisherman carrying their catch walked into the Seattle fish market, a place famous for how the vendors throw fish to entertain customers.
12. At first glance, the cuttlefish, which can change colors to blend into its surroundings, looked just like the brain coral behind it, and I did not see it in the picture.
13. Last summer, the local flooding caused by a breach in the Reynolds Dam caused over ten thousand dollars in damage to the children's park.
14. The basil plant, for example, needs full sunlight, but cilantro grows best in partial sunlight.

Adjective List Practice (p. 26):

1. Scientists are trying to determine what animal the newly discovered fossilized bones are from.
2. The white, fluffy clouds floated quickly by in the crisp evening wind.
3. The big sun bear is known for climbing the fence and swimming in the heated community pool in the spring.
4. The cunning, sneaky red foxes got into the chicken coop again last night.
5. The powerful liquid detergent makes my dirty sweaty, clothes smell so much better.
6. My car engine made an annoying rattling sound right before breaking down.
7. The local hot air balloon company specializes in making colorful, creative designs.
8. Laura placed an order for Italian coffee beans and three expensive ceramic coffee mugs.

Listing Commas Practice (p. 27):

1. A, C
2. A, B
3. A
4. A
5. A, B
6. C
7. C

Chapter 2 Practice (pp. 30-34):

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| 1. D | 17. D |
| 2. A | 18. C |
| 3. B | 19. B |
| 4. D | 20. C |
| 5. B | 21. C |
| 6. D | 22. A |
| 7. A | 23. B |
| 8. A | 24. C |
| 9. A | 25. D |
| 10. A | 26. D |
| 11. A | 27. C |
| 12. C | 28. D |
| 13. D | 29. A |
| 14. A | 30. C |
| 15. D | 31. D |
| 16. C | 32. B |

Chapter 3: Semicolons, Colons, Dashes, Apostrophes, and Quotation Marks

Semicolons Practice (p. 35):

1. ;
2. ,
3. ,
4. ;
5. , ,
6. , , ;
7. ; ,
8. , ;

Semicolons and Lists Practice (p. 37)

1. D
2. C
3. B
4. C
5. A
6. A

Semicolons, Colons, and Commas Practice (p. 39):

1. :
2. :
3. ,
4. ; or :
5. ;
6. :
7. :
8. , : ,
9. , : or ;

Colons Practice (p. 40):

1. B
2. D
3. C
4. C
5. C
6. D

Dashes Practice (p. 42):

1. C
2. D
3. C
4. C
5. C
6. A

Apostrophes Practice (p. 43):

1. witch's
2. kids'
3. doors
4. client's
5. eagles'

Advanced Singular vs. Plural Possession Practice (p. 44):

1. painting's
2. bottles'
3. townhouse's

Possession with Multiple Items in a List Practice (p. 44):

1. Theodora and Melody's
2. Michaelangelo's and Rafael's
3. Lemon's and Lime's

Apostrophes Practice (p. 45):

1. B
2. A
3. C
4. C
5. C
6. D

Possessive Pronouns and Contractions (p. 46):

it's
its
your
you're
their
they're
whose
who's

Quotation Marks Practice (p. 47):

1. B
2. A

Question Marks Practice (p. 48):

1. D
2. A

Chapter 3 Practice (pp. 49-53):

1. A
2. D
3. B
4. B
5. C
6. B
7. A
8. B
9. C
10. C
11. B
12. B
13. A
14. D
15. C
16. B
17. A
18. D
19. C
20. D
21. A
22. B
23. C
24. D
25. B
26. B
27. D
28. D
29. B

Chapter 4: Advanced Sentence Structure and Punctuation:

Chapter 4 Practice (pp. 57-59):

- | | |
|------|-------|
| 1. C | 10. D |
| 2. A | 11. C |
| 3. A | 12. C |
| 4. B | 13. C |
| 5. A | 14. A |
| 6. A | 15. D |
| 7. D | 16. B |
| 8. D | 17. B |
| 9. B | 18. C |

Chapter 5: Punctuation & Sentence Structure Problem Set (pp. 60-66):

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| 1. B | 26. C |
| 2. C | 27. C |
| 3. A | 28. C |
| 4. D | 29. C |
| 5. B | 30. A |
| 6. A | 31. A |
| 7. B | 32. A |
| 8. D | 33. D |
| 9. D | 34. A |
| 10. A | 35. C |
| 11. D | 36. A |
| 12. B | 37. A |
| 13. B | 38. D |
| 14. D | 39. D |
| 15. A | 40. A |
| 16. B | 41. C |
| 17. D | 42. B |
| 18. C | 43. B |
| 19. A | 44. C |
| 20. C | 45. C |
| 21. A | 46. D |
| 22. D | 47. A |
| 23. A | 48. D |
| 24. C | |
| 25. D | |

Chapter 6: Verbs

Practice (p. 68):

1. cheers
 2. requires
 3. is
- wins
make

Subject Verb Agreement Practice (p. 70):

1. grooms
2. are
3. were
4. were
5. are / overpowers
6. sells / claim are
7. were
8. takes
9. have
10. is / is
11. have
12. calls
13. get / consists
14. were starting / were
15. is / keep
16. makes
17. requires
18. are

Verb Tense Practice (p. 72):

1. caused
2. devoured
3. told
4. swum
5. would have arrived
6. be
7. begins
8. will get
9. closed
10. bought
11. sunk
12. have

Chapter 7: Pronouns

Pronoun Case Practice (p. 82):

1. me
2. her
3. him himself
4. me
5. who
6. their its
7. myself
8. her its
9. who whom
10. they
11. who whom

Chapter 6 Practice (pp. 75-79):

1. C
2. A
3. B
4. C
5. C
6. A
7. C
8. B
9. A
10. B
11. B
12. C
13. C
14. D
15. A
16. D
17. C
18. C
19. D
20. C
21. B
22. B
23. D
24. D
25. D
26. A
27. D
28. C
29. A
30. D
31. D

Pronoun Agreement Practice (p. 83):

1. his
2. their
3. her its
4. they
5. his or her it
6. its
7. who his or her them
8. their they
9. its them
10. you your

Ambiguous Pronouns Practice (p. 85):

- | | |
|------|------|
| 1. B | 4. B |
| 2. D | 5. C |
| 3. D | 6. B |

Chapter 7 Practice (p. 86-89):

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| 1. C | 15. D |
| 2. D | 16. C |
| 3. A | 17. C |
| 4. C | 18. C |
| 5. D | 19. D |
| 6. C | 20. C |
| 7. D | 21. C |
| 8. C | 22. C |
| 9. A | 23. D |
| 10. B | 24. B |
| 11. A | 25. A |
| 12. C | 26. D |
| 13. A | 27. B |
| 14. A | |

Chapter 8: Misplaced Modifiers

Front of the Sentence Modifiers with a Comma (p. 91):

1. B
2. C
3. C

Middle or the End of the Sentence Modifier with Commas (p. 92)

1. A
2. C

Modifiers without Commas (p. 93)

1. D

Prepositional Phrases as Modifiers (p. 93)

1. C

Modifiers in Parentheses (p. 94)

1. B

Chapter 8 Practice (Pages 96-98):

- | | |
|------|-------|
| 1. C | 9. A |
| 2. B | 10. B |
| 3. B | 11. B |
| 4. C | 12. B |
| 5. B | 13. A |
| 6. B | 14. A |
| 7. D | 15. B |
| 8. B | 16. A |

Chapter 9: Parallel Structure

Parallel Structure and Lists Practice (p. 99):

1. Theresa was expecting a visit from her mother, so she made her bed, cleaned the shelves of the refrigerator, and swept the kitchen floor.
2. Attempting to sneak out of the house, Janice grabbed her phone, her purse, and her wallet and then climbed out the back window
3. Chevy, our golden retriever, chews on the furniture, barks at the neighbors, and thinks his shadow is real.
4. It's harder to lift the couch by myself than to lift it with some friends
5. I would rather get free music with commercials than pay for music with no commercials.

Special Cases for Parallel Structure Practice (p. 100):

1. Both a scholar and an athlete, Sylvia got a scholarship to row crew in college.
2. The news report is neither accurate nor fair.
3. Neither scolding the child nor attempting to bribe him helped to calm him down.
4. The haunted house not only required participants to sign a waiver before entering but also asked them to turn their phones off for the entire experience.
5. Forms of payment accepted are either cash or Venmo.

Parallel Structure and Comparisons Practice (p. 101):

1. Unlike those of Mr. Rodriguez, Mr. Allen's math exams are curved, so everyone gets a better grade.
2. There was no mystery greater than that of the left shoe thief at my high school.
3. Walter stands by his bold claim that Michael Jordan's shoes are better than those of all current NBA players.
4. Unlike those at the 2014 World Cup in Brazil, the teams at the 2010 World Cup in South Africa had to deal with the constant noise from the vuvuzela horns.

Chapter 9 Practice (pp. 102-105):

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| 1. C | 14. A |
| 2. C | 15. C |
| 3. A | 16. A |
| 4. A | 17. A |
| 5. B | 18. A |
| 6. B | 19. D |
| 7. A | 20. C |
| 8. A | 21. A |
| 9. C | 22. B |
| 10. B | 23. D |
| 11. C | 24. A |
| 12. D | 25. A |
| 13. B | |

Chapter 10: Other Miscellaneous Topics

Chapter 8 Practice (pp. 110-111):

- | | |
|------|-------|
| 1. C | 8. A |
| 2. B | 9. D |
| 3. D | 10. B |
| 4. C | 11. B |
| 5. A | 12. B |
| 6. C | 13. A |
| 7. C | 14. A |

Chapter 11: Grammar Review (coming soon)

Chapter 12: Transitions

Chapter 12 Practice (pp. 117-122)

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| 1. C | 19. C |
| 2. D | 20. C |
| 3. B | 21. B |
| 4. A | 22. A |
| 5. D | 23. C |
| 6. B | 24. A |
| 7. D | 25. A |
| 8. A | 26. A |
| 9. D | 27. A |
| 10. B | 28. C |
| 11. A | 29. C |
| 12. A | 30. B |
| 13. B | 31. B |
| 14. C | 32. A |
| 15. A | 33. D |
| 16. B | 34. C |
| 17. A | 35. A |
| 18. B | |

Chapter 13: Notes

Chapter 13 Practice (pp. 131-139)

- | | |
|------|-------|
| 1. C | 10. A |
| 2. D | 11. C |
| 3. B | 12. A |
| 4. C | 13. D |
| 5. D | 14. B |
| 6. B | 15. A |
| 7. B | 16. C |
| 8. D | 17. C |
| 9. C | 18. C |